

THE HOLY R3UP



The 90-Day Rebuild

JOURNAL · STANDING · COMING HOME · WORKBOOK ·
VOLUME II

You survived. Now we rebuild.

Four pages a day for ninety days,
with the whole reference library behind them

THE HOLY R3UP
BANDO TO VINEYARD

THE HOLY R3UP

The 90-Day Rebuild



ONE BOOK, FIVE VOICES
WRITE THE TRUTH. UNDERSTAND IT. STAND. GO TO
HER. THEN GO DEEPER.

*For Brandi Renee – and for the little girl who was not
protected, and the woman who is standing now.*

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The 90-Day Rebuild — The Journal, Standing, Coming Home, the Workbook, and Volume II in One Book

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PLEASE READ

This book is a faith-based companion for reflection and practice. It is not medical, mental-health, legal, or addiction-treatment advice, and it does not replace a doctor, therapist, counselor, pastor, or emergency services. The author is not a licensed clinician. Prayer belongs beside — not in place of — treatment, medication, safe housing, and safety planning.

YOUR SAFETY COMES FIRST

If you are in danger, call 911 (or your local emergency number). If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (U.S.). If you are physically dependent on alcohol, benzodiazepines, or barbiturates, do not stop suddenly without medical supervision — withdrawal can be dangerous. The resource page at the back of the book lists additional help. Phone numbers and services change; please confirm them before you rely on them.

ABOUT THE STORIES AND IDEAS

Personal testimony is shared as lived experience, not as a formula or a promise of any outcome. Interpretations of Scripture are labeled as interpretation and offered for you to test against the Bible and with wise, trusted people. Nothing in this book guarantees healing, deliverance, income, or any particular result.

SCRIPTURE

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IN MEMORY

In Memory of Brandi Renee — 12787–121721

You survived. Now we rebuild.

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to Read This Book

I am not a doctor, therapist, or pastor. I am a survivor who is still building, reaching back with what I have learned, what Scripture actually teaches, and something practical you can use. Four kinds of writing share these pages, and I want you to know which is which:

WHAT SCRIPTURE SAYS

Verses are quoted or cited by reference and read in context. Unless noted, quotations are from the ESV. When the Bible is clear, these pages say so plainly.

MY TESTIMONY

Places where I am sharing what I lived and what I am still learning. It is one woman's experience — not a rule for yours, and not a finished recovery story.

INTERPRETATION AND PRACTICE

Pictures like doors, contracts, stages, and seasons are ways of seeing and tools to practice with. Christians hold different views on some of them. Test them; keep what helps.

SYMBOL AND IMAGE

Broken chains, vineyards, anchors, and re-ups are pictures of freedom and renewal. A page of writing can help you practice something new. It does not, by itself, break a curse or change God's mind.

A FEW HONEST GROUND RULES

- You can skip any exercise. You can keep your eyes open. You can use a different anchor — a cold glass of water, your feet on the floor, a hand on a pet. You never have to relive something to complete a page.
- Prayers here are conversations with God, not formulas. Saying words out loud helps many people mean them; it does not force anything.
- Not every struggle is spiritual, and not every hard day is an attack. Sleep, food, pain, grief, and old wounds are real too. Sort them out with people who know you.
- Forgiving someone is not the same as trusting them again. Boundaries protect; they are not punishment. A relapse does not make you disposable.
- If a page opens more than you can carry, stop. Reach for a safe person or one of the numbers at the back. The page will wait.

How This Book Works

Five books became one so that every day lines up. For each of the ninety days you get **four pages in a row**, always in this order:

1

THE JOURNAL PAGE · WRITE THE TRUTH

A short teaching, a verse, a question to write on the lines, and a declaration to say out loud.

2

STANDING, LEFT PAGE · UNDERSTAND

Optional grounding, Scripture, and what it means: spiritual warfare, your mother, your father, your addiction, and ending the cycle.

3

STANDING, RIGHT PAGE · STAND

Three reflection prompts, one soft action, a prayer, and a declaration.

4

COMING HOME PAGE · GO TO HER

One step toward the child you were, a prayer, an affirmation, a challenge, and room to write what she said.

After the ninety days come the Challenge Jar (cut-out cards to draw at random), the three letters for Day 90, a final reflection, a certificate, and the help page. Then the **Reference Library**: the Workbook and Volume II, whole, for when a day says *Go deeper*. Every Reference section is listed with its page number in the Contents.

PACE YOURSELF

- Do all four pages in one sitting, or spread them across the day: Journal in the morning, Standing at midday, Coming Home at night. Both work.
- You can do only one page on a hard day. Missing a day is not failure. Pick the page back up.
- Stop whenever it is too much. Reach for a safe person or the numbers at the back.

THE WHOLE MAP

Your 90-Day Path

Each arc has one theme, seen four ways. The last two columns tell you where to read more in the Reference Library when a day says *Go deeper*. (Workbook numbers are section numbers such as 2.4; Volume II numbers are chapters. Look them up in the Contents.)

Days	Journal arc	Standing focus	Coming Home stage	Workbook	Volume II
1–10	Telling the Truth	The war underneath: childhood, body, secrecy, a date	Build Her a Safe Place	Part I · Part V Steps 1–3	Ch. 1, 10, 17 · Steps 1–2
11–20	The Lies and the Names	Lies, names, and the moral injury of surviving	Meet Her at the Doorway	1.5–1.6 · 4.3–4.4	Ch. 10, 12, 48 · Step 31
21–30	The Realm and Your Authority	Warfare, plainly: sorting, standing, forgiving	Stand Guard for Her	Part II	Ch. 1, 11, 15, 17 · Steps 8–10
31–45	The Contracts	Vows, words, ties, the cistern, wanting out	Release What She Promised	2.4–2.6	Ch. 2–6 · Steps 13–15
46–55	The Bloodline	Family patterns and ending the cycle	Show Her Her Family Line	Part VI	Ch. 8–9 · Steps 16, 26
56–68	The Playbook and the Structure	Patterns, cravings, daily structure, boundaries, falling	Build Her a House	Part V Steps 4–8	Ch. 12–18 · Steps 23–29
69–76	God	Where He was, honest anger, silence	Where Was Jesus?	3.3 · 7.6	Ch. 19–27
77–84	Brandi and Letting Go	Grief, guilt, children out of reach, release	Say Goodbye and Hello	Part VII	Ch. 38–42 · Step 30
85–90	Becoming Her	Stewarding what you have learned	Meet the New You	Part III	Ch. 28–34, 46–52 · Step 32

READ THIS FIRST

Going Back Safely

This book walks you through a prayerful, imaginative practice: visiting the child you were, comforting her, releasing what she promised to survive, and bringing her home to the woman you are becoming. It is a tool, not a cure, and these are the rules that keep it safe.

What it is

Prayerful imagination and compassion practice anchored in Scripture: God sees and comforts (Psalm 139:12; Isaiah 66:13), and Jesus welcomes children (Mark 10:14). The “room” and the “doorway” are pictures. They are not visions, and they are not literal memories.

What it is not

It is not memory recovery. You never hunt for memories, and you never try to reconstruct what you do not already know. It is not a ritual that frees anyone by itself, and it does not replace therapy, medicine, or safety planning. Imagining something does not make it true history.

Your rules

- You choose the pace. A stop word, a ten-minute timer, and a landing (warm drink, walk, a text to someone) are part of every visit.
- Visit from the doorway. You never have to go into a scene.
- Use only what you already know. If nothing comes, nothing is required.
- Jesus is central. If you cannot picture Him, pray His words aloud instead.
- If you feel far away, numb, flooded, or have flashbacks, stop, open your eyes, find the date and the exit, and do your landing.

DO THIS WITH A TRAINED TRAUMA THERAPIST IF

- your history includes severe or ongoing abuse, trafficking, or ritual abuse
- you lose time, dissociate, or feel like parts of you are separate
- visits leave you worse for more than a day

If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text **988**. If you are in danger, call 911.

Spiritual Warfare, Plainly

I want to be careful with this language, because it has been used on people who needed help, not hype. So here is what I stand on.

What Scripture says

There is a real adversary: a liar, an accuser, a thief (John 10:10; Revelation 12:10; 1 Peter 5:8). He is a created being, limited by God (Job 1–2), and already defeated at the cross (Colossians 2:15; 1 John 3:8). Our part is to submit to God, resist the devil, stand firm in the armor God gives, answer lies with what is written (as Jesus did in Matthew 4), and pray (James 4:7; Ephesians 6:10–18).

What Scripture does not say

It does not hand us a formula. In Acts 19:13–16, men tried to use Jesus’ name like a tool and were beaten. It does not say every problem is demonic. It does not say we should shout or boast about authority; Jesus told His disciples to rejoice not that spirits submit to them but that their names are written in heaven (Luke 10:20), and even the archangel Michael did not presume to rebuke the devil on his own (Jude 9). It does not say a child’s struggle is a spirit, or that words on a page break a curse.

How this book uses the word “warfare”

Here, warfare means refusing to agree with lies, standing in Christ, and doing the ordinary faithful things together with practical care: sleep, food, doctors, counselors, safety, honest friends, and prayer. Test every spirit (1 John 4:1). If something makes you more ashamed, more isolated, or more afraid, it is not from Him.

Where I offer a picture (doors, agreements, stages) it is interpretation. Scripture is the authority; the pictures are tools.

A Word About Your Mother

This book was rewritten for you: a daughter whose mother carried her own trauma and addiction, and who allowed your father to abuse you when you were a baby; a woman in recovery from her own addiction; a woman who is not a mother and does not want to carry any of this on. If that is not your story, read it as the nearest true thing.

What I will not do

I will not ask you to remember. You were six months old; you cannot, and you do not need to. I will not tell you your mother was only a monster or only a victim; people are often both, and you can hold that without excusing her. I will not tell you your addiction is her fault, or that it is only yours. I will not tell you that you are destined to repeat it, or that you are cursed. I will not use guilt, and I will not tell you that forgiving means going back.

What I will do

Explain, plainly and without claiming certainty, how a baby who was not protected can grow into a woman whose body reaches for relief and whose heart struggles to trust (Days 5, 6, 39, 40). Name the grief for the mother you needed. Walk you through forgiving at your own pace, setting boundaries, and releasing what is not yours. Show you concrete ways to stop the pattern with you: recovery, therapy, safe people, new habits, and a line of faith and honesty you start now, with or without children.

Right now

If you are in danger, call 911. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988. If a child is at risk near the person who harmed you, Childhelp: 1-800-422-4453. SAMHSA Helpline (substance use): 1-800-662-4357. (Please confirm numbers before relying on them.)

The Prayer Over This Book

Say it again any day you need it.

PRAYER

Father, I come to You through Jesus Christ, who died for me and rose again. I am not coming to You cleaned up. I am coming to You honest.

You already know every page of this. You know what was done to me, what I did afterward, what I have never said out loud, and what I am still afraid is true about me. Nothing in these ninety days is going to surprise You.

So I am asking: come into it. Do not let me do this alone and do not let me do it in my own strength, because my own strength is what got me this far and this far is not far enough.

Show me the truth even where it costs me. Show me the doors I left open. Show me the words I agreed with. Show me what is mine to carry and what I have been carrying that was never mine. Give me the courage to write it down instead of managing it for one more year.

Where I am about to find shame, bring light. Where I am about to find grief, sit with me in it and do not rush me out. Where I am about to find rage, let me bring it to You instead of holding it against You.

Release me from every agreement I made in pain. Loosen every vow I made to survive. Close every door I opened and never knew how to shut. Let the pattern in my family stop with me. And fill every room that empties, because I am not willing to be a house standing open again.

For my sister Brandi Renee — I put her in Your hands, not mine. I am not paying a debt with my life. I am carrying her name because I loved her.

And when these ninety days are done, let me be who You made me before anybody ever hurt me. Let somebody else get out because I did. In Jesus' name. Amen.

ARC 1 · DAYS 1-10

Telling the Truth

The Journal: Telling the Truth. Standing: The war underneath: childhood, body, secrecy, a date. Coming Home: Build Her a Safe Place.

THE HOLY R3UP · 10 DAYS · 40 PAGES

You Are Not Crazy

"The LORD is near to the brokenhearted and saves the crushed in spirit."

PSALM 34:18 · ESV

Before anything else: what happened to you was real. You did not imagine it, exaggerate it, or invite it. The reason it still runs your life is not that you are weak — it is that nobody ever helped you finish it. Ninety days from now you may be standing somewhere you cannot see yet. Today all you have to do is start.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What is the one thing I have never said out loud?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not crazy. I am not cursed beyond reach. I am not too far in.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The War Started Before You Had Words

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.1 · 2.1 | Vol. II Ch. 1, 11**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the cosmic powers over this present darkness, against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly places."

EPHESIANS 6:12 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

You have told me that your father abused you when you were six months old, and that your mother, who carried her own trauma and addiction, allowed it. You had no words, no memory, and no defense. Scripture says the struggle is real and bigger than flesh and blood, and Jesus names the thief's work: to steal, kill, and destroy. What was done to you was never God's will. You are not crazy for living with effects you cannot explain, and you do not need a single memory to be believed here.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I already know about my beginning, and how do I know it?

2. How does it feel to hear that I do not need to remember it?

3. What would it mean to stand against it instead of just surviving it?

SOFT ACTION

Write one sentence that starts, "What happened to me was wrong because..." Say it aloud once.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, I did not choose the war I was born into. Stand with me in it. Name the harm as harm, and be near me while I look. Amen.

What was done to me was wrong, and God was never on its side.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.1 · 2.1 | Vol. II Ch. 1, 11

Before you go anywhere near the past, build a place in the present. Choose a real or imagined room: where is it, what is the light like, what is on the walls, what is soft, what can she hear? Write five details. Nothing from the past comes into this room today. You are only building it.

Lord, make this room real enough to rest in. Be the first one in it.

I am safe enough to begin, and I can stop whenever I need to.

☐ Put one comforting object (a blanket, a candle, a smooth stone) where you will see it every day this week.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

"Confess your sins to one another and pray for one another, that you may be healed."

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I never said out loud about my father or my mother?

2. Who has earned the right to hear the unedited version?

3. What do I need from them when I say it?

SOFT ACTION

Name your one person and choose a day this week. Start with one true sentence. You do not have to tell it all.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I have kept this in the dark to survive. Give me one safe person and the courage to say one true thing. Amen.

I do not have to carry this alone, and I do not have to carry it in secret.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 1 | Vol. II Step 1

Write on a card the names of who stands with her: Jesus, one safe person, a counselor if you have one, and a companion you love (Big Boy, if you want him there). Tell one of them today that you are beginning something tender and ask if you can check in this week.

Father, You do not send me anywhere alone. Put people around her and me.

She does not have to be alone this time.

□ Send one text: "I am starting something hard. Can I check in with you this week?"

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Two Hands

"If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness."

1 JOHN 1:9 · ESV

Some of what happened was not your fault, and some of what you did afterward was. Both are true at once. Holding only the first makes you a permanent victim. Holding only the second makes you your own warden. You need both hands to carry this.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Column one: what was done to me. Column two: what I did.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I set down what was never mine. I own what was, and I am forgiven for it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Both Hands: What Was Done and What You Did

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.6 · 4.4 | Vol. II Ch. 10

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"For I do not understand my own actions. For I do not do what I want, but I do the very thing I hate."

ROMANS 7:15 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

A baby has zero responsibility for what happens to her. None. And later, in your own addiction, some of what you did was your own doing, and some of it hurt people. Both are true at once. Holding only the first makes you a permanent victim. Holding only the second makes you your own warden. Your mother had both hands too: she was hurt, and she failed you. You can see that without excusing it. You need both hands to carry this, and God carries the rest.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What was done to me that was never mine to carry?

2. What did I do that was mine to own?

3. What would it be like to see my mother with both hands without excusing her?

SOFT ACTION

Make two columns: "Done to me" and "My part." Fill one line each. Stop there.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, give me honest hands, one to set down what was never mine, one to own what was. Hold the rest. Amen.

I can tell the truth about what was done to me and what I did, and still be held.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.6 · 4.4 | Vol. II Ch. 10

No stories today. On two lines write: "What was done to her:" and "What she did to survive:" Fill each with just a few words. Remind her that she is allowed to have both and that nobody here is judging her.

Jesus, hold both of these with me. Let her be honest without being ashamed.

*I can hold what was done to me and what
I did, and still be loved.*

□ Say one kind sentence out loud to a child you see today, or to a photo of one.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Shame or Repentance

"There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

ROMANS 8:1 · ESV

Shame says I am bad. Repentance says I did bad, and I am not staying there. One drowns you; the other gives you a door. God convicts with a specific thing and a way out. The accuser condemns your whole self with no exit. Learn the difference and it will save you years.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Where have I been calling condemnation 'conviction'?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Conviction points me to a door. Condemnation is not from God.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



The Accuser Says It Was Your Fault

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.3 | Vol. II Ch. 15**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.**"...for the accuser of our brothers has been thrown down, who accuses them day and night before our God."*

REVELATION 12:10 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Children, even tiny ones, take blame. When the people who should protect you do not, a child concludes that she must not be worth protecting. The accuser loves that conclusion and says it in your own voice: you were the problem, you are too much, no one would help. Conviction names one specific thing with a way out. Condemnation names your whole self with no door. A baby cannot be guilty of what was done to her, and God does not condemn the one who was harmed.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What does the accuser say about why this happened to me?

2. Is it specific with a way out, or sweeping with no door?

3. What would Jesus say to that sentence?

SOFT ACTION

When the sentence shows up today, answer it once with Romans 8:1 and move on. Do not debate it.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You stand with the harmed. Silence the voice that blames the baby. Amen.

Conviction gives me a door. Condemnation is not from God.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.3 | Vol. II Ch. 15

Find a photo of yourself as a child, or picture her at an age you already know about. Finish her sentence: "She is ashamed that..." Then answer as the adult you are now: "That was never yours." If there is no photo, draw a simple figure and write beside it.

God, lift the shame off her. Let her see my face
with Yours behind it.

The shame she carried was never hers to carry.

□ Drink a full glass of water while you look at her photo or drawing.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

"You keep count of my tossings; you put my tears in your bottle."

Fight, flight, freeze, and fawn were not choices or character flaws. They were survival strategies your nervous system ran without consulting you, and they worked — you are reading this. They just never got turned off.

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

This kept me alive. It is no longer the only thing I have.

A decorative horizontal line consisting of a series of small, colored dots. The dots are arranged in a single row, with a mix of colors including teal, light blue, and white. The colors transition from teal on the left to light blue and then to white on the right.

CHILDHOOD · ADDICTION

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"You have kept count of my tossings; put my tears in your bottle. Are they not in your book?"

PSALM 56:8 · ESV

Your body learned things before you had words: that the world is not safe, that the people meant to protect you may not, that relief has to be found. Those lessons live in the nervous system, not in stories, which is why you can feel them without remembering anything. Fight, flight, freeze, and fawn were survival strategies, and a body that learned them that early may reach for relief quickly. That is not weak faith. It is a body doing a job it learned young. God keeps count of every tear.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which survival response is my default?

2. How does it show up in my cravings, my relationships, my sleep?

3. What did it save me from?

SOFT ACTION

Put a hand where your body holds it most. Say, "You kept me alive. You can rest now."

SUPPLICATION

God, You saw every tear. Thank You for the body that kept me alive. Teach it that it does not stand watch alone. Amen.

My body is not broken. It is remembering, and it can learn a new rhythm.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.2 · 1.4 | Vol. II Ch. 17

Place a hand where your body holds the most tension. Say to it, quietly: "You kept her alive. We are safe now. You can rest." Stay for ten slow breaths. If that spot is numb, put your hand on your chest instead.

Father, thank You for the body that stood watch.
Teach it it is not on duty alone.

*My body is not broken. It remembers, and
it can learn rest.*

Stretch for two minutes: reach up, roll your shoulders, shake out your hands.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Where It Lives

"O LORD, heal me, for my bones are troubled."

PSALM 6:2 · ESV

Trauma is stored in the body, which is why talking alone never finished it. Find the spot — the throat that closes, the chest that tightens, the stomach that drops. Ask it what it would say if it could talk, and notice how old it sounds. That is who you are actually working with. Not a disorder. A kid.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Where does it live in my body, and how old does it sound?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

My body is not malfunctioning. It is remembering.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Where the Baby Lives

CHILDHOOD · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.4 (body map) | Vol. II Ch. 5**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.**"As one whom his mother comforts, so I will comfort you; you shall be comforted in Jerusalem."*

ISAIAH 66:13 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Trauma has an age, and for you the youngest part may be pre-verbal. You cannot interview a baby; you can only hold her. That is what comfort is: warmth, rocking, a steady voice, a blanket, a hand on the chest. You do not have to dig for anything. You only have to give the youngest part of you what she needed and did not get. God promised to comfort like a mother comforts, and He means the kind of mother who stays.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where in my body does the oldest fear live?

2. What does she need that is simple: warmth, quiet, being held?

3. What would it feel like to give it?

SOFT ACTION

Wrap yourself in a blanket for three minutes. Say, "I am here. I will not leave you."

SUPPLICATION

Father, You comfort like a mother who stays. Come to the youngest part of me and hold her. Amen.

I can comfort her without going back into what hurt her.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.4 (body map) | Vol. II Ch. 5

Notice how old the fear feels today. Not what happened, only the age. Write the number. Say hello to that age: "I see you. I am the grown-up now. I am here." Do not go further than hello today.

Lord, You know every age of me. Come to the one who is waiting.

*I can say hello to her without going back
into the fire.*

□ Make yourself a warm drink and drink it slowly, sitting down.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Six Resets

"He leads me beside still waters. He restores my soul."

PSALM 23:2-3 · ESV

Learn these before the hard pages. Breathe in four, hold seven, out eight. Name five things you see, four you touch, three you hear. Cold water on the wrists. Look at all four corners of the room until your body sees the door. Push a wall for ten seconds. Say out loud: this is memory, not danger.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Which reset will I practice today, three times, before I need it?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I have tools now. I am not at the mercy of my own alarm.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Six Resets for an Old Alarm

WARFARE · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.4 | Vol. II Ch. 17**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Sit with your back against something solid. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.**"Be still, and know that I am God. I will be exalted among the nations, I will be exalted in the earth!"*

PSALM 46:10 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

A body that was never taught to calm itself will reach for something that does it. Before you ask whether something is spiritual, calm the alarm. Breathe in four, hold seven, out eight. Name five things you see. Cold water on your wrists. Push the wall for ten seconds. Say, "This is memory, not danger." These do not replace prayer. They are what you learn instead of the thing you used, and they are what make prayer possible when your chest is on fire.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which reset helps me most?

2. When is my alarm loudest, and what do I usually reach for?

3. What small change could make the reset easier to reach?

SOFT ACTION

Pick one reset and practice it three times today before you need it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I do not have to fight with a racing heart. Slow me down and be near. Amen.

I have tools. I am not at the mercy of my own alarm.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.4 | Vol. II Ch. 17

Teach her one reset the way you would teach a child. Breath: "smell the flower, blow out the candle," four in, a long breath out. Or press your feet into the floor. Practice three times together, then say, "You can do this any time."

Jesus, give her tools she can carry. Let her calm
come from You.

I am teaching her how to feel safe.

- Do your reset once at a random time today when nothing is wrong.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Inventory

"Search me, O God, and know my heart."

PSALM 139:23 · ESV

You cannot break what you have not named. Write the list — not the stories, just the titles, like chapters. Ten lines. Then circle the one you skipped. That is the one. That is where the work is, and we are coming back to it.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

My list of ten. And the one I skipped.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am naming it, and naming it is the beginning of the end of it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Inventory: Mother, Father, Me

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.3 (Work Page 2) | Vol. II Step 2

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Take a slow sip of water. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"Search me, O God, and know my heart! Try me and know my thoughts! And see if there is any grievous way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting!"

PSALM 139:23-24 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Titles only, no stories. Three lists: what happened to me (what my father did, what my mother did or did not do), what I used and what it did, and the patterns I am afraid of repeating. Ten lines at most. Then circle the one you skipped. That is where the work is, and we are coming back to it slowly. You are allowed to leave a list blank today.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What are the main titles under what happened?

2. What are the titles under what I used?

3. What pattern am I most afraid of repeating?

SOFT ACTION

Write your three lists. Circle the skipped one. Do not write about it yet.

SUPPLICATION

God, search me, not to punish me but to lead me. Show me where to start, and not more than I can hold.
Amen.

Naming it is the beginning of the end of its power over me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.3 (Work Page 2) | Vol. II Step 2

Write only titles, one line each, no details: the main hard things she lived through. When you finish, ask her: "Is there anything you want me to know today?" Write whatever comes in one line. If nothing comes, that is fine.

God, I will go only as far as You and she can bear.
Keep the pace gentle.

Naming is not reliving. I can list without going in.

- Close the notebook and do something with your hands for ten minutes: wash dishes, braid, sort a drawer.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Get the Medical Picture

"Is there no balm in Gilead? Is there no physician there?"

JEREMIAH 8:22 · ESV

Untreated mental health conditions are a common driver of relapse. Get bloodwork, get your sleep assessed, get evaluated honestly. God made doctors too. Deliverance does not cancel dosage, and your medication is not a lack of faith.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What appointment am I making this week, and what have I been ignoring for years?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am treating my body and my spirit at the same time. Both, not either.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Medical Before Mystical

WARFARE · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.2 · Part V Step 2 | Vol. II Ch. 10 (#9, #12)**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"Is there no balm in Gilead? Is there no physician there? Why then has the health of the daughter of my people not been restored?"

JEREMIAH 8:22 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Before you decide something is demonic, ask a doctor. Early trauma changes how the body—handles stress, and addiction changes the brain, so sleep, mood, anxiety, and craving can feel like attack. Look for a therapist trained in trauma (approaches like EMDR or trauma-focused therapy are options), a doctor who understands addiction, and a recovery community. If you are physically dependent on alcohol, benzodiazepines, or barbiturates, withdrawal can be deadly; do not stop alone. Prayer and medicine are not enemies.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I been calling spiritual that might also be physical?

2. What appointment have I been avoiding?

3. Who could go with me?

SOFT ACTION

Make the call or book the appointment today. If you are in crisis, call or text 988.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You made healers. Give me the courage to ask for help and the humility to take it. Amen.

Treating my body is stewardship, not a lack of faith.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.2 · Part V Step 2 | Vol. II Ch. 10 (#9, #12)

Her body is yours to care for now. Make one appointment you have been avoiding: a checkup, bloodwork, a counselor, or a sleep assessment. Tell her: "I am taking care of you." If you are in crisis, call or text 988.

Lord, You made healers. Give me courage to let someone help her.

Caring for her body is faith, not weakness.

- Eat one real meal sitting down, with no phone.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Date

"Choose this day whom you will serve."

JOSHUA 24:15 · ESV

Not someday. A date. Remove every stash and every backup. Delete every number. Tell three people the date. Clear the first seventy-two hours. Stock the house. Decide now where you go if home is not safe. And if you use alcohol, benzodiazepines, or barbiturates, do not stop cold on your own — withdrawal from those can be deadly. Call a doctor or the SAMHSA helpline (1-800-662-4357) before your date. Someday is the enemy's favorite word because it costs him nothing.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

My date is _____. The three people who know are:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not changing someday. I am changing on a date I wrote down.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

A Date, and a Reason Bigger Than Fear

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook Part V Step 3 | Vol. II Step 21, 23

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALHold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.**"Ponder the path of your feet; then all your ways will be sure."*

PROVERBS 4:26 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Someday is a comfortable word. A date is a decision. If you are ready to stop using, pick the date, clear the first seventy-two hours, remove what needs removing, and tell three people. Add the reason: you do not want to carry on what was handed to you. That reason is bigger than fear, and it can hold you when a craving is loud. If medical detox is needed, do it first; call SAMHSA at 1-800-662-4357.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What date am I willing to write down?

2. Who are my three people?

3. What is the reason that is bigger than my fear?

SOFT ACTION

Write the date, three names, and the reason on one card.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I am tired of someday. Give me a date, a plan, people, and a reason that holds. Amen.

I am not waiting for someday. I am choosing a day.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 3 | Vol. II Step 21, 23

Before tomorrow, set three rules in writing: (1) a stop word you can say any time, (2) ten minutes only, with a timer, (3) a landing: warm drink, a walk, and a text to someone after. Also: you will use only what you already know, and you will never hunt for memories. If your history includes severe trauma, dissociation, or ritual abuse, do this with a trained trauma therapist.

Father, set the boundaries of this work with me.
Let nothing go further than I can hold.

I am in charge of the pace, and she can trust that.

□ Prepare a landing kit: tea, a blanket, a playlist, a phone number. Put it where you will do this work.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

ARC 2 · DAYS 11–20

The Lies and the Names

The Journal: The Lies and the Names. Standing: Lies, names, and the moral injury of surviving. Coming Home: Meet Her at the Doorway.

THE HOLY R3UP · 10 DAYS · 40 PAGES

What It Taught You

"You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free."

JOHN 8:32 · ESV

Trauma does not just hurt you. It teaches you. It was my fault. I am too much. Love always costs. Safe is boring. I only matter when I am useful. Those were installed under duress and you have been living by them ever since, like house rules in a house that burned down.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

The three lies I live by most:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I was taught these under duress. I am allowed to unlearn them.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

What Your Mother Taught Without Words

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.5 | Vol. II Ch. 12 (Stage 3)**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.**“...and you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.”*

JOHN 8:32 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Trauma does not only hurt. It teaches. Without a word, you may have learned that love comes with harm, that people who should protect you will not, that you are not worth protecting, and that relief is something you find on your own. Those lessons were installed when you were too small to argue. You may be living by house rules from a house that burned down. The work is not to hate the lessons but to notice them.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What did I learn about love and safety before I could speak?

2. Which lesson shows up in my relationships or my addiction?

3. What would I tell a child who had learned it?

SOFT ACTION

Underline the lesson that frightens you most. Write beside it, "I was taught this. I can unlearn it."

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You are the truth. Show me the lessons I took on, and replace them with what is real. Amen.

I learned it under pressure. I am allowed to unlearn it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.



Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.5 | Vol. II Ch. 12 (Stage 3)

Set a ten-minute timer. In your imagination, stand at the doorway of a room at an age you already know about. Do not go in. Just see her from the door: what is she doing? Do not fix anything. When the timer rings, say, "I will come back," take your landing, and write three words for what you saw. This is prayerful imagination, not a memory test.

Jesus, stand at the door with me. Let me see only
what I can bear.

*I can look at her from the doorway and
come back safe.*

□ After your visit, take a short walk outside and name five colors.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Lie, Evidence, Truth

"We destroy arguments and every lofty opinion raised against the knowledge of God."

2 COR. 10:5 · ESV

Take the loudest lie. Who taught it to you. What evidence you have used to keep believing it. Then make yourself find one piece of evidence against it. Then the truth you are choosing instead. Do not give the Sunday School answer. Give the real one.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Lie one, and the truth I am standing on instead:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not arguing with the lie. I am replacing it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Lie, Evidence, Truth: "I Wasn't Worth Protecting"

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.5 (Work Page 4) | Vol. II Ch. 15**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

"For the weapons of our warfare are not of the flesh but have divine power to destroy strongholds. We destroy arguments and every lofty opinion raised against the knowledge of God, and take every thought captive to obey Christ,"

2 CORINTHIANS 10:4-5 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Paul's weapons are truth, arguments answered, thoughts brought to Christ. Take the lie: I was not worth protecting. Ask who taught it. The evidence you have used is that no one stopped it. But a person's failure to protect you says everything about them and nothing about your worth. Now find one piece of evidence against it, and write the truth you choose instead. God is called the defender of the helpless. Do not give the Sunday School answer. Give the real one.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Lie one, in my own words:

2. One piece of evidence against it:

3. The truth I choose, and where Scripture says it:

SOFT ACTION

Say the truth aloud to the mirror once today. It will feel awkward. Do it anyway.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I bring this thought to You instead of agreeing with it. Teach me what is true. Amen.

I am not arguing with a lie. I am replacing it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.5 (Work Page 4) | Vol. II Ch. 15

Return to the doorway for ten minutes. Ask her gently: "What did you decide about yourself?" Write exactly what she says, in her words, without arguing with it. It is not truth yet. It is what she believed.

Lord, let me hear her without correcting her. Then tell us both what is true.

I can listen to what she believed without believing it myself.

□ Tell one safe person one thing you learned today. Just one.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The False Name

"I have called you by name, you are mine."

ISAIAH 43:1 · ESV

Somebody named you, and you answered. Too much. Not enough. The family's problem. Damaged goods. The enemy's third move is always to assign you a false name, because whatever you answer to is what runs your life.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

The name I have answered to longest is:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I have a name from God and I am going to learn to answer to it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Names You Were Given

CHILDHOOD · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.5 | Vol. II Ch. 12 (Stage 3), Ch. 48**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"But now thus says the LORD, he who created you, O Jacob, he who formed you, O Israel: "Fear not, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by name, you are mine.""

ISAIAH 43:1 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Somebody named you and you answered. Damaged. The addict's daughter. Too much. Not enough. The one who is just like her. A name given in someone's worst moment can follow you for decades, and a family that cannot name its own harm often names the child instead. God gives names in love. Whatever you answer to will run your life, so it is worth asking who gave it to you and whether they had the right.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which name have I answered to longest?

2. Who gave it to me?

3. Does God agree with it?

SOFT ACTION

Write the old name on a slip of paper. Do not tear it up yet. Just see it from the outside.

SUPPLICATION

Father, You called me by name before anyone else did. Help me hear Yours louder than theirs. Amen.

I belong to God. My name is not the worst thing that was said about me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.5 | Vol. II Ch.12 (Stage 3), Ch. 48

Write the names she was called, in the words used. Then read them aloud to her as an adult who is on her side, and say after each: "That was said about you. It was not true of you."

Father, You called me by name before anyone else did. Say it over her.

What was said about me is not who I am.

- Write one name on a slip of paper and put it in a drawer, out of sight.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Trading Names

"Put on then, as God's chosen ones, holy and beloved..."

COLOSSIANS 3:12 · ESV

Not affirmations. Re-installation. Too much becomes chosen and beloved. Damaged goods becomes a new creation. Forgotten becomes engraved on His palms. Cursed becomes redeemed from the curse. Guilty becomes no condemnation. Say the new one out loud every morning for thirty days.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

The name I am choosing instead, and where it is written:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I answer to what God calls me, not what they called me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Trading Names

WARFARE · CHILDHOOD

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 48 (Trading the Names) | Workbook 3.1**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

“...To the one who conquers I will give some of the hidden manna, and I will give him a white stone, with a new name written on the stone that no one knows except the one who receives it.”

REVELATION 2:17 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

God renames people: Abram to Abraham, Jacob to Israel, Simon to Peter. His names point at who you are becoming. Trading names is not positive thinking. It is putting a new truth where the old one lived. Daughter of an addicted mother becomes daughter of God. Damaged goods becomes new creation. Addict becomes a woman in recovery. Cycle-breaker is a name you get to earn, a day at a time. Say the new one out loud each morning for thirty days.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. The name I am putting down:

2. The name I am choosing, and where Scripture says it:

3. Who will help me remember it?

SOFT ACTION

Write the new name where you will see it every morning.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, I give You the old name. Teach me to answer to the one You give. Amen.

I answer to what God calls me, not what they called me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 48 (Trading the Names) | Workbook 3.1

Choose the name God gives her: beloved, chosen, new creation, known. Write it on a card. Put it where you will see it, and say it to her tonight before you sleep.

Jesus, write the new name on her heart. Let it be louder than the old.

She has a name from God, and I can answer to it.

□ Say her new name to yourself in the mirror three times today.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

It Was Not Your Fault

"He will not always chide, nor will he keep his anger forever."

PSALM 103:9 · ESV

A child cannot consent. A person being coerced is not choosing. A person in survival is not strategizing. And your body responding physically was never agreement — shame built a whole city on that one lie. Tear it down today.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What have I been blaming myself for that was never a choice?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am taking my name off a crime I did not commit.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

It Was Not Your Fault. You Were Six Months Old.

CHILDHOOD · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.6 | Vol. II Ch. 10 (#2)

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Sit with your back against something solid. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

“As a father shows compassion to his children, so the LORD shows compassion to those who fear him.”

PSALM 103:13 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

A baby cannot consent, cannot run, cannot tell, cannot choose. A body that responds physically under harm is not agreeing. Shame built a city on that lie. And your mother's failure to stop it was her failure, not yours. Notice how God meets you: not with a lecture but with compassion, the way a father does for his child. Take your name off a crime you did not commit.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What am I still blaming myself for that was never a choice?

2. What do I want to say to a baby who was hurt?

3. What would God say to her?

SOFT ACTION

Say it aloud, as if to a baby you love: "It was not your fault." Then say it to yourself.

SUPPLICATION

Father, You are not angry at the baby I was. Take the blame she picked up and give her compassion. Amen.

I am taking my name off a crime I did not commit.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.6 | Vol. II Ch. 10 (#2)

Go to the doorway. Say to her, three times, slowly: "It was not your fault." If she argues, let her, and say it again. If she cannot hear it today, say it again tomorrow. It may take many times.

Father, take the blame she picked up and give her compassion in its place.

It was not my fault. I was a child.

□ Do one small act of play today: color, hum, jump in a puddle, dance to one song.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Why You Went Back

"He brought me out into a broad place; he rescued me."

PSALM 18:19 · ESV

Because it was familiar, because you had no options, because you loved them, because leaving is the most dangerous moment. Going back is the norm, not the exception. Most people try more than once before they leave for good. You were not slow. You were in a trap that was built to hold.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What do I need to stop prosecuting myself for?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I was in a trap. Leaving late is still leaving.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Why You Went Back

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 4.1 | Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 5), Ch. 10 (#6)**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Take a slow sip of water. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

"Simon, Simon, behold, Satan demanded to have you, that he might sift you like wheat, but I have prayed for you that your faith may not fail. And when you have turned again, strengthen your brothers."

LUKE 22:31-32 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

When the first people in your life were unsafe, unsafe can feel like home. Peter failed and went back, and Jesus had already prayed for him and named what came after: when you have turned again. Why you went back to the substance, to people who hurt you, to your mother or your father: it was familiar, it worked, you had no other options, or you hoped it would be different this time. Most people try more than once. The turning again is the story.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What did I go back to, and what did it give me?

2. What was I hoping would be different?

3. What do I believe Jesus prayed for me?

SOFT ACTION

Write, "I went back because..." with no excuses and no punishment. Then write, "And I am turning again."

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You prayed for Peter before he fell. Pray for me. Strengthen me for the turning. Amen.

I was in a trap built to hold. Leaving late is still leaving.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 4.1 | Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 5), Ch. 10 (#6)

Ask her: "Why did you go back?" Listen for the reasons: it was familiar, she loved them, she had no options. Do not scold. Say, "Thank you for surviving. We are building a way out that does not hurt."

Jesus, You prayed for Peter before he fell. Pray for her. Turn her again.

She was not stupid. She was surviving.

□ Write one thank-you to the part of you that survived.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Why You Miss Them

"The heart is deceitful above all things... I the LORD search the heart."

JER. 17:9-10 · ESV

Cruelty and tenderness delivered on an unpredictable schedule builds a stronger bond than steady kindness does. It is the same mechanism as a slot machine. Missing your abuser is not a character flaw. It is proof the bond was engineered.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What do I actually miss — them, or the relief between the harm?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

What I feel is real. It is not evidence that I should go back.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Missing the Ones Who Hurt You

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 4.3 | Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 5)**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.**"For he satisfies the longing soul, and the hungry soul he fills with good things."*

PSALM 107:9 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

You can miss a mother who did not protect you. You can miss a father who harmed you. You can miss the high. Longing for a parent does not mean the parent was good; it means you were a child who needed one. Cruelty and tenderness on an unpredictable schedule bond people harder than steady kindness. Missing is not evidence you should go back. It is evidence that something in you is still hungry, and God fills the hungry.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I actually miss: them, or what I needed from them?

2. What hunger is under it?

3. What safe thing could feed that hunger today?

SOFT ACTION

When the missing hits, say, "This is hunger, not a sign." Then eat, drink water, and call a safe person.

SUPPLICATION

God, I am hungry and tired of feeding it with what hurts. Fill the place only You can fill. Amen.

What I feel is real. It is not a reason to go back.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 4.3 | Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 5)

Ask her what she misses, whether a person, a feeling, or a place. Let her say it without shame. Then offer one safe thing that gives a small piece of what she is longing for, such as a hug from a friend, a favorite song, or a sunset.

God, You satisfy the longing soul. Give her what is good and safe.

What I long for is not shameful. I can feed it safely.

Give someone a real hug today, or hug a pillow while you breathe.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Memory Gaps

"Even the darkness is not dark to you."

PSALM 139:12 · ESV

Your filing clerk went offline under threat, so the memory never got stamped past. That is why it feels like now. Fragmented memory is common after trauma, and it does not mean you are lying. The gaps are not a character flaw. They are what a mind does when it is trying to survive.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What do I need to stop demanding of my own memory?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I do not need perfect recall to be telling the truth.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

No Memory, No Problem

CHILDHOOD · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.4 | Vol. II Ch. 10 (#19)**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.**"even the darkness is not dark to you; the night is bright as the day, for darkness is as light with you."*

PSALM 139:12 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

You cannot remember being six months old, and you do not need to. You know what you know from what family told you, from your body, from patterns you live with. You are not lying and you are not making it up. Do not push for memory; do not let anyone lead you to "recover" scenes. A trauma-informed counselor can help you work with what the body holds without scripts. God sees the parts you cannot, and the grief of not knowing is real.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I know, and how do I know it?

2. What do I wish I could remember, or wish I could un-know?

3. What would it mean to let "enough" be enough?

SOFT ACTION

Write one line: "I know that ____ I do not need to know more to heal."

SUPPLICATION

Lord, the dark is not dark to You. Hold what I cannot hold. Give me grace for the gaps. Amen.

I do not need perfect memory to tell the truth or to be loved.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 1.4 | Vol. II Ch.10 (#19)

You do not need to remember everything. Do not push for memory. Draw a blank page, and write across it: "Mercy." Tell her: "We do not have to know it all to be free. God sees what we cannot."

Lord, the dark is not dark to You. Hold what I cannot hold.

I do not need perfect memory to tell the truth or to heal.

□ Do something gentle for your mind: a puzzle, a crossword, a slow walk with no phone.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Moral Injury

"I am the foremost of sinners... but I received mercy."

1 TIMOTHY 1:15-16 · ESV

Some of you are not haunted by what was done to you but by what you did while surviving. That was real, and it is not unforgivable. Paul held the coats at a stoning and God commissioned him anyway, and he referenced it constantly. It became his credential for grace.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What I did, who it hurt, and whether I can safely make it right:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I did that. Jesus paid for it. I stop punishing someone He pardoned.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

What You Did While Surviving

ADDICTION · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 4.4 (Work Page 15) | Vol. II Ch. 10 (#3)**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"The saying is trustworthy and deserving of full acceptance, that Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am the foremost."

1 TIMOTHY 1:15 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Some of you are not haunted only by what was done to you. You are haunted by what you did while surviving: the people you hurt, the things you took, the times you were the dangerous one. That is moral injury, and it is real. It is also not unforgivable. Paul called himself the foremost of sinners and God used him anyway. Forgiveness from God is complete. Repair with people is a separate road, and tomorrow takes it up.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What did I do that I cannot reconcile with who I wanted to be?

2. Who did it touch?

3. What part is guilt I can bring to Jesus, and what part is shame that lies?

SOFT ACTION

Write it in one line. Beneath it write, "Jesus came for people like me."

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You came for sinners, and I am one. Take what I cannot carry, and lead me to repair what I can. Amen.

I did that. It was mine. Jesus paid for it. I stop punishing someone He pardoned.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 4.4 (Work Page 15) | Vol. II Ch. 10 (#3)

Some of what she did to survive still weighs on you. Tell her: "You did what you had to do to stay alive." If someone was hurt, write one living amend you can do (not a confession to them, just an act). Say: "Jesus came for people like us."

Jesus, You came for sinners. Take what she cannot carry and lead us to repair what we can.

*I did what I had to do. I am forgiven, and
I can grow.*

- Do one small, anonymous good deed for someone.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Forgiving Yourself

"As far as the east is from the west, so far does he remove our transgressions."

PS. 103:12 · ESV

You cannot walk out of the prison while you are still the warden. Where you cannot make direct amends — because they are gone, or contact is unsafe — you make living amends. You become someone who does not do that anymore, and you serve where that damage lives.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What am I still collecting from myself that God already settled?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I take myself out of my own prison. The debt is paid.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Living Amends, and Forgiving Yourself

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook 4.4 | Vol. II Step 31

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALPut a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"Whoever conceals his transgressions will not prosper, but he who confesses and forsakes them will obtain mercy."

PROVERBS 28:13 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

When you cannot undo the harm, you live differently where the harm lives. Amends are mostly shown: showing up when you said you would, telling the truth, not asking people to take care of your feelings, and not demanding their forgiveness. Where a person is gone or contact is unsafe, serve where that damage lives. And forgive yourself, not because you deserve it but because God decided it. You cannot walk out of the prison while you are still the warden.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who needs repair from me, and what would honest repair look like?

2. Where is repair unsafe, and what could I do instead?

3. What am I still collecting from myself that God already settled?

SOFT ACTION

Choose one promise you can keep this week, however small, and keep it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, make me someone who shows up. Where I cannot repair, use me where the damage lives. Amen.

I make amends by becoming someone who does not do that anymore.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 4.4 | Vol. II Step 31

You can forgive her, and God already has. At the doorway, say: "I forgive you for what you had to do." If you cannot yet, say: "I am willing to be willing." Then write one sentence of what you will do differently, as her protector.

Father, I take myself out of my own prison. Be the judge, and let it be settled.

I forgive her, and God has already forgiven me.

□ Wear or carry something that makes you feel like yourself today.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

ARC 3 · DAYS 21-30

The Realm and Your Authority

The Journal: The Realm and Your Authority. Standing: Warfare, plainly: sorting, standing, forgiving. Coming Home: Stand Guard for Her.

THE HOLY R3UP · 10 DAYS · 40 PAGES

Two Realms

"The things that are seen are transient, but the things that are unseen are eternal."

2 COR. 4:18 · ESV

There is a physical realm you can measure and a spiritual realm that generates it. Ephesians 6:12 says our struggle is not only against flesh and blood — Scripture treats unseen opposition as real, and as limited. Some of what you have been calling "just my personality" may be wound, body, habit, or something spiritual. These pages will help you start telling the difference.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What have I been calling 'just how I am' that might be something else?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not imagining what I have been through. And I am not fighting it alone.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Two Realms, One Family

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.1 | Vol. II Ch. 1, 11**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"...as we look not to the things that are seen but to the things that are unseen. For the things that are seen are transient, but the things that are unseen are eternal."

2 CORINTHIANS 4:18 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Spiritual warfare is not only for conferences. It meets us in a family where addiction, abuse, and silence ran for years: in what you believe about yourself, in cravings, in who you are drawn to. — Scripture treats the unseen opposition as real and limited, and treats ordinary faithfulness as how we stand. You are not imagining what you lived through, and you do not have to make the fight dramatic. You have to show up, tell the truth, and keep Jesus near. People are not demons; the harm done through them was still wrong.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where do I see the fight in ordinary moments?

2. What have I called "just my personality" that might be something else?

3. How could I meet it with something simple?

SOFT ACTION

Pick one ordinary moment today and pray one sentence in it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You are in my ordinary day. Teach me to see what is going on beneath the noise, and to stand there with You. Amen.

I am not imagining what I have been through, and I am not fighting it alone.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.1 | Vol. II Ch. 1, 11

If it feels right, ask Jesus to stand with you at the doorway. This is prayerful imagination anchored in Scripture, not a vision or a memory, and you can skip it. If imagining Him is too hard, simply pray the verse aloud: "even the darkness is not dark to you."

Jesus, I invite You to stand where I stand. Be near her, and near me.

*I do not have to be the only one who is
with her.*

□ Pray one sentence aloud at a moment you would normally rush.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Four Categories

"Test everything; hold fast what is good."

1 THESSALONIANS 5:21 · ESV

Take the thing tormenting you most and sort it. What part is body and chemistry. What part is wound. What part is flesh — your untrained appetite, which needs discipline, not deliverance. What part is spiritual. Now you have four assignments instead of one impossible one.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Sort my loudest problem into the four categories:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Discernment is not doubt. It is how I stop fighting the wrong thing.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Four Categories at 2 a.m.

WARFARE · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.3 (Work Page 6) | Vol. II Ch. 10 (#12)**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Press your palms together, then let go. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.**"but test everything; hold fast what is good."*

1 THESSALONIANS 5:21 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

When something is tormenting you, sort it. What part is body and chemistry (sleep, withdrawal, anxiety)? What part is wound (the old fear)? What part is flesh, your untrained appetite, which needs discipline, not deliverance? What part might be spiritual? Now you have four assignments instead of one impossible one. A craving is usually several at once. Do not label a craving demonic first. Treat the body, tend the wound, build discipline, and bring all of it to God.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What is tormenting me most right now?

2. How would I sort it?

3. Who could help me with each part?

SOFT ACTION

Fill in the four categories for one craving or one fear. Do one small thing under each.

SUPPLICATION

God, give me discernment instead of panic. Teach me to fight the right thing the right way. Amen.

Discernment is not doubt. It is how I stop fighting the wrong thing.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.3 (Work Page 6) | Vol. II Ch. 10 (#12)

Take one fear of hers and sort it: is it body (sleep, chemistry), wound (memory), flesh (habit), or something spiritual? Write one small thing for each part. Do not call it demonic first. Treat the body and the wound with care.

Lord, give us discernment instead of panic. Show us what we are really fighting.

I can tell what kind of thing this is, and I can handle it with help.

- Go to bed thirty minutes earlier than usual.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

What He Cannot Do

"Greater is he who is in you than he who is in the world."

1 JOHN 4:4 · ESV

He cannot read your mind — only God searches hearts. He cannot make you do anything. He cannot be everywhere. He is not God's opposite; he is a created being who lost. He studies patterns and builds hallways. He cannot make your legs walk down one.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Where have I believed I had no choice?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

He can build the hallway. He cannot move my feet.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

What He Cannot Do

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.3 | Vol. II Ch. 11**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Sit with your back against something solid. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

"Little children, you are from God and have overcome them, for he who is in you is greater than he who is in the world."

1 JOHN 4:4 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

The enemy is a created being, not God's opposite. He is not everywhere, he cannot read your mind, he cannot make you do anything, and he cannot snatch you from God's hand. Your biggest fear may be that you are destined to become your mother. Scripture does not say that. Patterns are strong, and they are not destiny. God keeps those who are His, and He does not promise a trouble-free life; He promises you will not face it alone or unprotected.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where has the fear of becoming her been louder than truth?

2. What do I believe about what the enemy can do?

3. What is God asking me to trust Him with?

SOFT ACTION

Write: "I am afraid I will become ____." Then write, "God, this is Yours."

SUPPLICATION

Father, You are greater. I give You the fear I have been carrying like a weapon. Keep what I cannot keep. Amen.

He can build a hallway. He cannot move my feet.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.3 | Vol. II Ch. 11

If it is true that the danger has passed, tell her: "That was then. You are safe here." Look around the room and name three things that show it is now. If you are still in danger, your first step is safety, not this book. Call 1-800-799-7233 or 911.

Father, show her how safe she is now. Let it sink in.

*That was then. I am safe now, or I am
working to be.*

Look at the date on your phone and say it out loud, with your age.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Seated, Not Cowering

"Behold, I have given you authority to tread on serpents and scorpions."

LUKE 10:19 · ESV

Colossians 2:15 says Christ disarmed the rulers and authorities and put them to open shame. Ephesians 2:6 says we are seated with Him in the heavenly places. One way to hold that: you are not praying for a victory that might not come — you are standing on one already won. That is a reading of these verses, not a formula, and it is never a reason to stop getting help.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Where have I been acting like the outcome is still undecided?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not negotiating with fear. I am standing on what Christ has already won.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Standing, Not Cowering

WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.5 | Vol. II Ch. 1

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Take a slow sip of water. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

"Therefore take up the whole armor of God, that you may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand firm."

EPHESIANS 6:13 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Notice the verb in Ephesians 6: stand. Colossians 2:15 says Christ disarmed the rulers and authorities and put them to open shame. Authority is not volume or a formula. It is standing where Jesus has already won, and it lets you rest. It is also never a reason to skip a doctor, a counselor, a meeting, or a safety plan. Cowering and charging are both ways of forgetting He already won. You were not protected as a child. You can be, now, by Him and by the people He sends.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where have I been cowering?

2. Where have I been charging in my own strength?

3. What would standing look like in one situation this week?

SOFT ACTION

Stand up, plant your feet, and say aloud, "I stand in Christ." Hold it ten seconds.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You disarmed what scared me. Help me stand where You already won. Amen.

I am not negotiating with fear. I am standing on what Christ has already won.☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.5 | Vol. II Ch. 1

Imagine the old voices that used to say she was too much or not enough. Stand between her and them as the adult you are. Say to them: "You do not speak to her anymore." You do not need to shout. Say it once, calmly.

Jesus, You stand with me. Silence what should be silent.

*I am her protector now, and I do not have
to be loud.*

- Turn off one source of noise or negativity for the rest of the day.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

"Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee."

Submit first, then resist. That order is not optional. Resisting without submitting is how people get hurt. And authority is not volume — Jesus rebuked with a sentence. Loud is for your own fear, not for their ears.

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

I get under God before I stand against anything.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

WARFARE · ADDICTION

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you."

JAMES 4:7 · ESV

The order matters. Submit to God first, then resist. For anyone in addiction, submission begins with an honest admission that you cannot do this on willpower, and that is not defeat; it is where help begins. Resisting without submitting is exhausting. Authority is not volume. Jesus answered temptation with a sentence of Scripture. Loud is for our own fear.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What am I trying to handle in my own strength?

2. What would submitting to God look like there?

3. What is one thing I can resist this week once I am under His care?

SOFT ACTION

Say aloud, "I cannot do this alone. Jesus, I am Yours." Then do one resisting thing.

SUPPLICATION

God, I give You my will, my plan, and my pride. Under Your care, I will stand against what harms me. Amen.

I get under God before I stand against anything.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.5, 2.6 (Step 1) | Vol. II Step 8

Teach her a short prayer, in words a child can say: "Jesus, help me. I am Yours." Say it together. Notice that surrender comes first. Then, if there is something to say no to, say it with Him beside you.

God, I give You my will and my plan. Under Your care, I stand.

I can say help, and I can say no.

□ Say your short prayer three times today, once each in the morning, noon, and night.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Doors

"See to it that no one fails to obtain the grace of God; that no root of bitterness springs up."

HEB. 12:15 · ESV

Some struggles keep getting fed by the same things. Unforgiveness. Believing a lie about yourself. Occult contact, even the kid version you did for protection because nobody else was protecting you. Sexual entanglements. Inherited patterns. Vows you made in pain. Substances. And trauma itself, which can leave you more exposed — not your fault, and still something you are allowed to tend. Christians disagree about how much of this is spiritual and how much is human, so list it honestly and bring it to someone wise.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Every pattern I can name right now:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Everything I can name, I can bring to God and start to change.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

What Keeps Getting Fed: Anger at Both Parents

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.4 | Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 9)

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"Be angry and do not sin; do not let the sun go down on your anger, and give no opportunity to the devil."

EPHESIANS 4:26-27 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Some struggles keep getting fed by the same things: unforgiveness, lies about yourself, anger left to rot, old vows, substances. Paul says anger is not the problem. Holding it past sundown gives the enemy room. Your anger at your father and your mother is not wrong; it is information that you were wronged. The work is to bring it to God and to safe people, so it does not spill on yourself, on your recovery, or on people who did not cause it.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where does my anger really belong?

2. How have I been feeding it, knowingly or not?

3. Where can I safely put it?

SOFT ACTION

Name your anger in one line. Then do one physical thing with it: walk hard, scrub something, push a wall.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You are not afraid of my anger. Take it, and keep it from feeding on me. Amen.

Everything I can name, I can bring to God and begin to change.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Stop Feeding What Scares Her

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: EPHESIANS 4:26-27

Lord, show me what keeps getting fed. Give me strength to stop feeding it.

I can decide what I let in.

- Take a phone-free hour this evening.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Get Under Cover

"You are a hiding place for me; you preserve me from trouble."

PSALM 32:7 · ESV

Before you revoke anything, submit. Out loud: Father, I come through Jesus Christ who died for me and rose again. I am Yours — my body, my mind, my memory, my will, my future. I cannot do this in my own strength. Cover me in the blood of Jesus.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What am I handing over before I go into the next chapter?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I do not go in alone and I do not go in uncovered.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Taken In

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.6 (Step 1) | Vol. II Step 8

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"For my father and my mother have forsaken me, but the LORD will take me in."

PSALM 27:10 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Before anything else, get under cover. David knew what it was to be left: his father and mother had forsaken him, and the Lord took him in. You do not have to pretend your parents were safe in order to receive a safe God. Say who you belong to. Say what you cannot do alone. This is not a spell, and it does not guarantee a trouble-free life. It is a child running to the one who is bigger, and being taken in.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who failed to take me in?

2. What would it mean to be taken in by God?

3. What do I want covered today?

SOFT ACTION

Pray aloud in your own words: "I belong to You. Take me in and cover me today."

SUPPLICATION

Father, You take me in. I run to You. I do not go in uncovered. Amen.

I do not go in alone and I do not go in uncovered.☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.6 (Step 1) | Vol. II Step 8

Wrap yourself in a blanket (or hold a pillow) and read Psalm 91:1-2 aloud. As you do, imagine wrapping her in the same cover. Stay for three minutes. This is a comfort practice, not a spell.

Father, You are her refuge. Cover her, and cover me.

I do not go in uncovered.

□ Make your bed carefully tonight like you are preparing a room for a child.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Forgive, By Name

"Forgive us our debts, as we also have forgiven our debtors."

MATTHEW 6:12 · ESV

One person at a time, out loud. Not because it was okay — it was not okay. Because unforgiveness keeps them in the room with you, and in Jesus' parable in Matthew 18 the servant who will not forgive ends up with the jailers. That is not their punishment. It is yours.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Who am I forgiving today, and for what specifically?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I refuse to be their jailer and their prisoner at the same time.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Forgiving a Mother Who Did Not Protect You

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.6 (Step 3) | Vol. II Step 10**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

*"bearing with one another and, if one has a complaint against another, forgiving each other; as the Lord
has forgiven you, so you also must forgive."*

COLOSSIANS 3:13 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Forgiveness is not saying it was okay and not reconciliation. It is releasing the right to collect. A mother who did not protect you, perhaps because of her own trauma and addiction, still did not protect you. Both are true: she may have been hurt and she hurt you. Forgive in pieces if you have to, out loud, one thing at a time, and let God keep the ledger. If she is gone, forgiveness can happen without her. You can forgive fully and keep every boundary.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What specifically do I need to forgive her for?

2. What do I fear forgiveness would mean?

3. What would I keep, even after forgiving?

SOFT ACTION

Choose one specific thing and say, "I release this to You, God. I am not available for more harm."

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I am tired of being her jailer and her prisoner. I release it to You. Keep me safe. Amen.

I refuse to be her jailer and her prisoner at the same time.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.6 (Step 3) | Vol. II Step 10

You do not have to force forgiveness today. Ask her: "Is there anyone you are ready to release?" If yes, say it. If no, tell her: "There is no rush. We will do it when you are ready." Forgiveness is not trust, and it is not reconciliation.

Lord, free her from carrying this, and do not rush her.

*Forgiveness is mine to give in my time, and
it never means going back.*

□ Write one boundary you will keep even after you forgive.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Forgiveness Is Not Access

"Alexander did me great harm... beware of him."

2 TIMOTHY 4:14-15 · ESV

Forgiveness is between you and God. Reconciliation requires two people and repentance. You can be fully forgiving and permanently unavailable. Paul named people and said avoid them. Jesus withdrew constantly. Nobody taught us this and it changes everything.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Who have I let back in because I thought forgiving required it?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I forgive completely. I am not available for more harm.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Forgiven Is Not Back In

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 7.2 | Vol. II Step 25**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.**"The prudent sees danger and hides himself, but the simple go on and suffer for it."*

PROVERBS 22:3 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Forgiveness is between you and God. Reconciliation requires two people and real repentance. Where someone has harmed you or could harm you, safety decides access, not guilt or family pressure. Jesus withdrew often, and Paul named people and told others to avoid them. If your mother or father reaches out, you have options: no contact, limited contact, contact with conditions. This is not unforgiveness. It is wisdom, and in recovery it may be survival.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who have I let back in because I thought forgiving required it?

2. What does safety actually require right now?

3. Who can help me hold the line?

SOFT ACTION

Write one boundary about contact with a parent. Tell one safe person.

SUPPLICATION

God, give me wisdom, not just kindness. Help me guard what You have given me to guard. Amen.

I forgive completely. I am not available for more harm.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 7.2 | Vol. II Step 25

Tell her: "You do not have to be around people who hurt you." Write one safe boundary today: who she will not be left alone with, what she will not answer, where she will not go. Tell a safe person.

God, give me wisdom, not only kindness. Help me guard her well.

I can forgive and still be safe.

- Practice saying "no, thank you" out loud to an empty room.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Armor, Daily

"Take up the whole armor of God, that you may be able to stand."

EPHESIANS 6:13 · ESV

Thirty seconds every morning, out loud. Truth: I will not lie to myself today. Righteousness: I am covered by His, not mine. Peace: I bring it into rooms, I do not take chaos from them. Faith, salvation, the sword, prayer. Notice there is no armor on the back. You are not built to run.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What is coming at me today that I need to armor for specifically?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I put it on before the day puts anything on me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Armor for the Daughter Who Wasn't Protected

WARFARE • CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal • Standing • Coming Home • **Go deeper** Workbook 2.7 | Vol. II Appendix (daily armor)

SANCTUARY • OPTIONAL

Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

“Stand therefore, having fastened on the belt of truth, and having put on the breastplate of righteousness, and, as shoes for your feet, having put on the readiness given by the gospel of peace.”

EPHESIANS 6:14-15 • ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Thirty seconds, out loud, before the day puts anything on you. Truth: I will not lie to myself today. Righteousness: I am covered by His, not mine. Peace: I bring it into rooms; I do not take chaos from them. Faith, salvation, the Word, prayer. This is the covering you did not get as a baby, given now by Someone who does not fail. Notice there is no armor for the back; you are built to stand, not run.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which piece of armor do I forget most?

2. What is coming at me today that I need to prepare for?

3. Who do I want to be covered by?

SOFT ACTION

Say it aloud for thirty seconds today, standing.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I put on what You gave me. Keep me upright today, and keep my eyes on You. Amen.

I put it on before the day puts anything on me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.7 | Vol. II Appendix (daily armor)

In the morning, put on the armor out loud with her in mind: truth, righteousness, peace, faith, salvation, the Word, prayer. Picture each piece fitting a child her size. Say: "You are not built to run. You are built to stand."

Father, I put on what You gave me. Keep her upright, and keep us together.

I stand in Christ, and she stands with me.

□ Stand tall for thirty seconds, shoulders back, feet apart, and say your armor.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

ARC 4 · DAYS 31-45

The Contracts

The Journal: The Contracts. Standing: Vows, words, ties, the cistern, wanting out. Coming Home: Release What She Promised.

THE HOLY R3UP · 15 DAYS · 60 PAGES

There Is Always a Legal Question

"He canceled the record of debt that stood against us... nailing it to the cross."

COL. 2:14 · ESV

Some of what binds us began as an agreement — a vow, a belief, something you said yes to in pain, often before you could spell. Scripture uses the language of debts and records, and Colossians 2:14 says Christ canceled the record of debt that stood against us. Picture it as paperwork if that helps: what you agreed to in pain does not get the final word over you.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What do I suspect I signed without knowing I was signing?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

What I agreed to in pain does not get the final word. Christ does.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Conclusions Drawn Before You Could Speak

WARFARE · CHILDHOOD

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.4 | Vol. II Ch. 1, 2**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Sit with your back against something solid. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"by canceling the record of debt that stood against us with its legal demands. This he set aside, nailing it to the cross."

COLOSSIANS 2:14 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Scripture uses the language of debts and records, and Colossians 2:14 says Christ canceled the record that stood against us. This book uses a courtroom picture for the beliefs, vows, and—— conclusions people live by without choosing them. A baby does not make vows, but a body draws conclusions: I am not safe, no one comes, I have to take care of myself. Those can run an adult life. Christians hold different views on how literally to take the picture. What is clear is that Jesus came to set captives free, and you may look honestly at what you have been living by.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What conclusions do I think my body drew very early?

2. How do they run my choices now, especially around addiction and love?

3. What is it like to think they do not get the final word?

SOFT ACTION

Write one conclusion you suspect you live by, in plain words.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You carried the record that stood against me. Show me what I have been living by, and show me what You say instead. Amen.

What I concluded in pain does not get the final word. Christ does.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.4 | Vol. II Ch. 1, 2

List the promises, rules, and beliefs she agreed to without knowing it: "I will never need anyone," "it is my fault," "I have to be perfect." Titles only. Tell her: "These were survival rules, not who you are."

Jesus, You carried the record that stood against her. Show us what to put down.

What I agreed to in pain does not get the final word.

□ Move your list to a different room so it is not in your sleeping space.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Survival Vow

"Do not take an oath at all... Let what you say be simply 'Yes' or 'No.'"

MATTHEW 5:34,37 · ESV

Somewhere around eight or nine you made a rule to stay alive. I will never need anyone. I will never be weak again. I will always be the strong one. It worked then. It is running your adult life now, and it is the reason you cannot let anyone hold you.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

The vow I made, the age I made it, and what it is costing me now:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

It kept me alive. It does not get to run me. I release it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Survival Vow: "I'll Never Need Anyone"

CHILDHOOD · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook 2.4 | Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 1), Ch. 4

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALTake a slow sip of water. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.**"Let what you say be simply 'Yes' or 'No'; anything more than this comes from evil."*

MATTHEW 5:37 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Somewhere in childhood most survivors make a rule to stay alive. I will never need anyone. I will never cry. I will never be like her. It worked then, and it may be running your adult life, including the reason you cannot let anyone hold you. Even a vow made to be the opposite of someone binds you to her, because you are still living in reaction. Jesus told us to stop swearing oaths. Not because He is harsh, but because He knows vows made in fear are heavy.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What rule did I make to stay alive?

2. How old was I when I made it?

3. What is it costing me now, especially in recovery and in love?

SOFT ACTION

Write the vow in the exact words you remember. Under it write what it protected you from.

SUPPLICATION

God, a child made that promise because she had to. Thank You that she survived. Show me what it costs now. Amen.

It kept me alive. It does not get to run me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.4 | Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 1), Ch. 4

At the doorway, ask: "What promise did you make to stay safe?" Write it in her exact words. Under it write what it protected her from. Thank her. Do not break it yet.

God, a child made that promise because she had to. Thank You that she lived.

*Her promise protected her, and I honor
why she made it.*

- Do one thing today that is the opposite of her vow, very small (ask for a small favor, show a small feeling).

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Breaking the Vow

"If the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed."

JOHN 8:36 · ESV

Out loud: I made a vow when I was ____, in _____. I said _____. I made it to survive and it worked then. It is killing me now. In the name of Jesus Christ I renounce it, I break it, and I release myself from it. Then replace it, because a person without a rule is not free, just unsteered.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / _____

The new truth I am living by instead:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I break the old rule and I write a new one with God.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Releasing a Child's Promise

CHILDHOOD · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 4 (inner-vow work) | Workbook 2.6 (Step 5)

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"...Let the children come to me; do not hinder them, for to such belongs the kingdom of God."

MARK 10:14 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Jesus welcomed children and did not make them earn it. When you find the vow, speak to the child who made it, not to scold her but to release her. Say: I see you. You made that promise because you had to, and it worked. I am the adult now, and you do not have to hold the door anymore. Then, in Jesus' name, release the vow and replace it with something true: I can let safe people in. I can feel and still be okay. I can want things. A woman who learns this breaks a chain that ran before her.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What would I say to the child who made the vow?

2. What new, true sentence do I want to live by?

3. Who could witness me saying it aloud?

SOFT ACTION

Say the release aloud, in your own words, then say your new sentence three times.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You welcomed children. Welcome her. Come and bring her home. I take over from here, with You. Amen.

I break the old rule and write a new one with God.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 4 (inner-vow work) | Workbook 2.6 (Step 5)

Say aloud to her: "I see you. You made that promise because you had to. It worked. I am an adult now and I am taking over. You do not have to hold the door anymore. In Jesus' name I release you from that vow." Then say your new sentence three times.

Jesus, welcome her. Come and bring her home.

*I break the old rule and write a new one
with God.*

□ Write your new sentence on a card and put it in your pocket.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Self-Curse

"Death and life are in the power of the tongue."

PROVERBS 18:21 · ESV

I hope I die. I will never love anyone again. I am always going to be like my mother. You said it in the worst hour of your life, and part of you has been living by it ever since. Words carry weight, which is also why saying something truer out loud helps.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What did I speak over myself in the worst hour I have had?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I take back every word I spoke in pain. It does not get to run my life.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Words Over You, and Words You Say to Yourself

MOTHER WOUND · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 6 | Workbook 2.6 (Step 5)

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

“Let no corrupting talk come out of your mouths, but only such as is good for building up, as fits the occasion, that it may give grace to those who hear.”

EPHESIANS 4:29 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Words matter. Many of us can still hear what was said over us: you will never amount to anything, you are just like your mother. We also repeat those words to ourselves, and sometimes to others in our worst hour. You cannot unsay what was said to you, but you can say something truer, and you can stop passing it on. Say it plainly. Repair what you can. Words can wound, and words can bless.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What was said over me that I still hear?

2. What do I say to myself that sounds like them?

3. What truer sentence can I say, and to whom?

SOFT ACTION

Speak one blessing today to someone, or to yourself, in the mirror. Make it specific.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, heal what was said over me. Teach me to speak life where there was death. Amen.

I take back every word spoken in pain. It does not get to run my life.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 6 | Workbook 2.6 (Step 5)

Write the words that were said over her in anger or contempt. Then, beside each, write a blessing in its place. Read the blessings aloud to her. Words can wound and words can bless.

Lord, undo what was said, and speak truth over her.

I take back every word spoken in pain.

- Speak one specific blessing to someone today.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Shame Covenant

"Those who look to him are radiant, and their faces shall never be ashamed."

PSALM 34:5 · ESV

Shame is not an emotion here — it is an agreement that the worst thing that happened to you is what you are. It requires secrecy to stay in force, which is why every step of this work is out loud and to a person. Safe light is what shame cannot stand.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What does shame in me still require me to keep secret?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not the worst thing that happened to me. I renounce that agreement.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Shame Covenant: Being Her Daughter

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 14) | Workbook 1.6**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.**"Those who look to him are radiant, and their faces shall never be ashamed."*

PSALM 34:5 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Shame is not the same as guilt. Guilt says I did something wrong. Shame says I am something wrong. A child of an addicted, absent, or complicit parent often carries shame that is not hers: the family's reputation, the secrets, the smell of the house. Shame hides, and the hiding feeds it. Safe light is what shame cannot stand. That means looking toward Him, not at your reflection in other people's faces.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I feel most ashamed of about my family or myself?

2. Who taught me this shame?

3. What does looking toward Jesus instead look like?

SOFT ACTION

Tell one shame-heavy true thing to your safe person. Notice that you are still here.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, I look to You. Lift the shame I have worn like a coat. Let my face be uncovered. Amen.

I am not the worst thing that happened to me, and I am not the worst thing I did.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 14) | Workbook 1.6

In your imagination (or with a real coat or blanket), take the shame off her shoulders and set it down outside the room. Write on a slip of paper "shame" and put it somewhere outside your home, such as a recycling bin. It is a symbol; it does not literally remove anything, but it can help your body practice letting go.

Jesus, You bore shame. Take hers.

I am not the worst thing that happened to me.

□ Wear something bright today.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Silence Contract

"Nothing is hidden that will not be made manifest."

LUKE 8:17 · ESV

Somebody told you not to tell, and you kept it, sometimes for decades, sometimes to protect people who never protected you. Families protect secrets over children. Secrets are load-bearing walls for unhealthy family patterns — pull one out and a lot comes down at once. Do it with support, and never in a way that puts you in danger.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

The secret nobody in my family says out loud:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not the keeper of what was done to me. I break the silence.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Silence Contract: Family Secrets

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 19) | Workbook 6.3**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.**"For when I kept silent, my bones wasted away through my groaning all day long."*

PSALM 32:3 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Somebody told you not to tell, or no one needed to. Families protect secrets over children, and a mother who allows abuse is often keeping the secret too. Telling should be done with support and never in a way that puts you in danger. If a child is at risk now, whether a sibling, a niece, a nephew, or any child near the person who harmed you, protecting that child comes before the family secret: call the Childhelp hotline at 1-800-422-4453, or 911 in an emergency. Your story matters. You are not the keeper of what was done to you.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What does my family never say out loud?

2. What has the silence cost me?

3. What would telling safely look like?

SOFT ACTION

Write the secret for yourself only, then decide who, if anyone, should hear it, and when.

SUPPLICATION

Father, You see what was hidden. Give me courage and wisdom to speak when it is time and safe. Protect every child involved. Amen.

I am not the keeper of what was done to me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 19) | Workbook 6.3

Tell her: "You are allowed to tell." Decide, in writing, who might need to hear what, and when it will be safe. If a child is at risk, protecting them comes first: Childhelp 1-800-422-4453, or 911. You do not have to tell everything today.

Father, You see what was hidden. Give wisdom about when and to whom.

I am not the keeper of what was done to me.

□ Say one true thing to a safe person that you normally hide.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Soul Ties

"Or do you not know that he who is joined to a prostitute becomes one body with her?"

1 COR. 6:16 · ESV

"Soul tie" is not a phrase in Scripture, but survivors know the feeling: someone you barely knew, or someone who harmed you, still has a hold on your thoughts. Scripture does say sexual union joins two people in a real way (1 Corinthians 6:16). What was taken from you was a wrong done to you, not a sin you committed. Letting go of a hold like that is not denying it happened. It is refusing to keep paying rent on it.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Every name — or every 'the one whose name I do not know':

SAY IT OUT LOUD

What God did not join, I do not keep.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Soul Ties, Plainly: To Her, To Him, To the Substance

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 5 | Workbook 2.4**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.**"But he who is joined to the Lord becomes one spirit with him."*

1 CORINTHIANS 6:17 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

"Soul tie" is not a phrase found in Scripture. It names a real experience: someone you barely knew, or someone who harmed you, still has a hold on your thoughts. The deepest holds are often to the first people. You may feel bound to your mother and to the substance, and in the same way. What was taken from you was a wrong done to you, not a sin you committed. Being joined to the Lord is the tie that holds.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ____/____/____

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who still has a hold on my mind or body?

2. Is it a person, a place, or a substance?

3. What would a healthier connection look like, if any?

SOFT ACTION

List names, or write "the one whose name I do not know." Do not write the stories.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You are the one I want to be joined to. Loosen what is not of You, and show me what safe connection looks like. Amen.

What God did not join, I do not keep.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 5 | Workbook 2.4

List the names of people who still have a hold on her mind, or write "the one whose name I do not know." Names only, no stories. Tell her: "We are going to loosen this, slowly."

Lord, loosen what is not of You, and give her safe connection.

I can notice a hold without being stuck in it.

□ Delete or mute one thing that keeps you attached to someone who hurts you.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Cutting the Tie

"He sent out his word and healed them, and delivered them from their destruction."

PS. 107:20 · ESV

Out loud: Jesus, I release my hold on ___ and I ask You to loosen their hold on me. I hand back everything of theirs I have carried — their shame, their blame, their voice in my head, their version of me. I take back my body, my mind, my peace, my identity, my future.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What am I calling back to myself today?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I take back what was mine and I hand back what was never mine.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Releasing the Hold

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Vol. II Ch. 5, Step 15 | Workbook 2.6 (Step 6)

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALPress your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"Brothers, I do not consider that I have made it my own. But one thing I do: forgetting what lies behind and straining forward to what lies ahead, I press on toward the goal for the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus."

PHILIPPIANS 3:13-14 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

You can release your hold on a person and ask God to loosen their hold on you. Hand back what is theirs: the shame, the blame, the voice in your head, their version of you. Take back what is yours: your body, your mind, your peace, your future. Where contact is ongoing, the release is internal and the practical is separate: boundaries, limited contact, someone who can help you hold them. Pressing forward is not pretending. It is a direction.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What am I handing back today?

2. What am I taking back?

3. What practical boundary supports the release?

SOFT ACTION

Pray the release in your own words, by name. Then take one practical step.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, I release my hold, and I ask You to loosen theirs. I hand back what was never mine. Amen.

I take back what was mine and hand back what was never mine.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 5, Step 15 | Workbook 2.6 (Step 6)

Write on paper what you are handing back: their shame, their blame, their version of her. Fold it and put it in an envelope with their name or "unknown." Do not mail it. Say: "I take back my body, my mind, my peace, my future."

Jesus, I release my hold, and I ask You to loosen theirs.

*I hand back what was never mine and
take back what was.*

□ Keep the envelope somewhere out of sight, or bury or shred it safely.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Substance Covenant

"My people... have forsaken me, the fountain of living waters, and dug for themselves cisterns."

JER. 2:13 · ESV

Every addiction is a false savior. It promised peace, escape, belonging, courage, rest — things only God gives. The sin is not the cistern. It is digging your own. And you cannot rebuke a habit you keep feeding; some things are crucified, not cast out.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What did it give me that I could not get anywhere else?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I renounce it as my savior, my comfort, and my god.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Cistern: What the Substance Gave You That She Didn't

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 4.2 | Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 8)

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Sit with your back against something solid. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

“for my people have committed two evils: they have forsaken me, the fountain of living waters, and hewed out cisterns for themselves, broken cisterns that can hold no water.”

JEREMIAH 2:13 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Every addiction promised something real: peace, escape, belonging, courage, rest, a feeling of being held. A baby who was not protected may find that a substance is the first reliable comfort she ever had. That is not an excuse and not a moral failing; it is an explanation, and it points toward what was missing. The cistern is not the sin. Digging your own is. If you can answer what it gave you that you could not get anywhere else, you can find a legitimate source for the need.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What did it give me that I could not get anywhere else?

2. What did it let me stop feeling?

3. What was I truly thirsty for?

SOFT ACTION

Write the job it did. We will replace each one by Day 64.

SUPPLICATION

God, I dug my own cistern because I was thirsty and no one handed me water. Teach me to drink from You. Amen.

I put it down as my savior, my comfort, and my god.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 4.2 | Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 8)

Ask her what she was really thirsty for when she reached for relief: safety, rest, belonging, being seen. Write it. Then give her a small drink of it today in a safe way.

God, You are the fountain. Give her what she was looking for.

My thirst was real, and God can satisfy it.

□ Sit with a friend, or call one, for ten minutes just to be together.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Trauma Bond

"He rescued me, because he delighted in me."

PSALM 18:19 · ESV

Harm and love arrived in the same package, so your instrument for detecting safety got miscalibrated at the factory. You can smell danger a mile away and still walk straight into it. Your alarm works fine. Your identifier is broken, and it is rebuilt by new evidence, slowly, with safe people.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Where is my identifier still broken, and who is the safe evidence?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am building new evidence. Familiar is not the same as safe.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out fear. For fear has to do with punishment, and whoever fears has not been perfected in love."

1 JOHN 4:18 · ESV

When harm and love arrive in the same package, your instrument for detecting safety gets — miscalibrated. You may be drawn to people who feel like home because they feel like her, or him. Your alarm works; your identifier is off. It is rebuilt by new evidence, slowly, with safe people. If love has always had fear in it, real love may feel boring or suspicious at first. Trust the pattern over time, not the intensity.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where has fear been tangled in love for me?

2. Who in my life has been consistently safe?

3. What evidence would I want before trusting someone?

SOFT ACTION

List three signs of a safe person. Check it against someone in your life.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, teach me what safe love looks like. Be the standard I measure by. Amen.

I am building new evidence. Familiar is not the same as safe.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 4.3 | Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 5)

Write a list for her: what a safe person does (is steady, tells the truth, respects no, does not make her afraid). Choose one person who fits it, and one small thing to receive from them.

Lord, teach her what safe love looks like.

Familiar is not the same as safe.

□ Notice one calm, safe thing about someone today and tell them.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Control Contract

"Not my will, but yours, be done."

LUKE 22:42 · ESV

If you can manage every variable, nobody can blindside you again. It made sense. It also means you cannot rest, cannot receive, cannot be surprised by good, and sabotage anything you did not build. Control is a wound wearing competence as a uniform.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What am I controlling because I am afraid of being ambushed again?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I open my hands. Control was never protection.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Control and the Fear of Becoming Her

CYCLE-BREAKING · CHILDHOOD

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 15) | Workbook 1.2**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.**"And which of you by being anxious can add a single hour to his span of life?"*

MATTHEW 6:27 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

If you can manage every variable, nobody can ambush you again. That made sense. It also means you cannot rest, cannot receive, and may be gripping your life so tightly that you squeeze out the good. The fear of becoming your mother can make you control every move, and the fear itself can pull you toward the very patterns you dread. Hypervigilance feels like safety. Sometimes it is a wound wearing competence as a uniform.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where am I controlling because I am afraid of being ambushed again?

2. What am I afraid will happen if I let go?

3. What is one thing I could let be a little messy?

SOFT ACTION

Choose one thing to loosen your grip on this week, and tell someone you are trying.

SUPPLICATION

Father, You see what I am afraid of. Hold what I cannot control. Let me rest in You. Amen.

I open my hands. Control was never protection.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 15) | Workbook 1.2

Tell her she does not need to watch the door today. Choose one task to let go of or ask for help with. Practice rest: ten minutes lying down, no problem-solving.

Father, hold what we cannot control.

I can open my hands. Control was never protection.

- Do one thing imperfectly on purpose.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

"Come to me, all who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest."

I only matter when I am useful. So you produce, you carry, you fix, you serve, and you cannot stop, because stopping feels like disappearing. Test it honestly: who are you when you are producing nothing?

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

I am loved at rest. My worth was never output.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"But the Lord answered her, 'Martha, Martha, you are anxious and troubled about many things, but one thing is necessary. Mary has chosen the good portion, which will not be taken away from her.'"

LUKE 10:41-42 · ESV

I only matter when I am useful. Many children of addicted parents learn to earn love by fixing, caretaking, or staying quiet. Jesus did not shame Martha. He named what she was carrying and invited her to sit. If rest feels like disappearing, ask who you were responsible for rescuing as a child, and whether you are still doing it. Test it honestly: who are you when you produce nothing and rescue no one?

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who was I responsible for as a child?

2. Where do I feel guilty when I rest?

3. What would it mean to be loved at rest?

SOFT ACTION

Do ten minutes of nothing useful today. Notice what comes up. Do not fix it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I am anxious about many things. Let me sit at Your feet without earning it. Amen.

I am loved at rest. My worth was never output.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 16) | Workbook 1.5

Do nothing useful for ten minutes with her. No fixing, producing, or serving. Tell her: "You are loved even when you do nothing."

Jesus, let her sit at Your feet without earning it.

I am loved at rest.

- Do something purely for joy: a hobby, a walk, a song.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Self-Punishment Contract

"There is no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

ROMANS 8:1 · ESV

Some part of you decided that as long as you keep paying, it is not unpunished. So you sabotage, you deny yourself, you stay in what hurts. But the bill was settled, and continuing to pay it may feel like humility while it refuses a payment Jesus already made.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

How do I still punish myself, and what am I paying for?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not going to keep paying for what He already bought.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Self-Punishment: Paying for Her Sins and Yours

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 17) | Workbook 4.4

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

ROMANS 8:1 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Part of you decided that as long as you keep paying, it is not unpunished. So you sabotage, deny yourself, stay in what hurts, or relapse after good news. Some of the debt you are paying belongs to people who never paid it. The bill was settled. Continuing to pay may feel like humility while it refuses a payment Jesus already made. Repair with people, where it is safe, is good. Punishing yourself is not repair.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. How do I still punish myself?

2. Whose debt am I paying?

3. What would accepting grace cost me, and what would it give?

SOFT ACTION

Do one kind thing for yourself today that you would do for a friend.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You already paid. Teach me to receive it and to stop collecting. Amen.

I am not going to keep paying for what He already bought.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Stop Punishing Her

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: ROMANS 8:1

God, the bill is paid. Let her receive it.

I am not going to keep paying for what Christ already paid.

- Cook or buy one thing she would like.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Death Agreement

"I have set before you life and death... choose life, that you and your offspring may live."

DEUT. 30:19 · ESV

A death wish is a symptom, not a sin, and not a truth. Elijah, Jonah, Job, and Moses all asked to die, every one of them mid-assignment, and God's answer to Elijah was food, sleep, a whisper, and a new job — not a rebuke. If that thought has teeth today, call 988 before you read another page.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

When did I first start wanting out, and who can I tell about it?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I turn away from every thought that says I would be better off gone. I choose life, and I will tell someone.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Wanting Out

WARFARE · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 18) | Workbook Resources

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"But he himself went a day's journey into the wilderness and came and sat down under a broom tree. And he asked that he might die, saying, 'It is enough; now, O LORD, take away my life, for I am no better than my fathers.'" And he lay down and slept under a broom tree. And behold, an angel touched him and said to him, "Arise and eat."

1 KINGS 19:4-5 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

A death wish is a symptom, not a sin, and not a truth. Elijah, Jonah, Job, and Moses all asked to die, and God's answer to Elijah was food, sleep, a whisper, and a new job, not a rebuke. Early trauma and addiction both raise the risk of wanting out. If that thought has teeth today, call or text 988 (or call 911) before you read another word. You can also tell your sponsor, a counselor, or a friend. This is not weakness; it is the correct use of help.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. When did I first start wanting out?

2. What is the pain underneath the wish?

3. Who can I tell today?

SOFT ACTION

If the thought is loud, stop here and call or text 988. If it is quieter, tell one person you trust today.

SUPPLICATION

God, I am tired. Feed me, let me sleep, and send me someone. Keep me here. Amen.

I choose life. I will tell someone.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 3 (Contract 18) | Workbook Resources

If a part of you wants out, do not argue. Tell her: "I hear you. I am not leaving you. We are going to get help." Then tell a person today. If it is loud, call or text 988 now.

God, feed her, let her sleep, and send someone.
Keep us here.

I choose to stay, and I will tell someone.

- Text a safe person: "Today is heavy. Can you check on me tonight?"

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Agreement With the Accuser

"The accuser of our brothers has been thrown down."

REVELATION 12:10 · ESV

The most efficient lie of all: it gets said once, and you say it to yourself for the next thirty years. Every time you finish the accuser's sentence — I am worthless, I always ruin things — you strengthen it. Today you take the pen back.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What sentence of the accuser's have I been finishing for him?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I do not receive that. That is not mine. I take back the pen.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Accuser's Pen: "You're Just Like Her"

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.3 | Vol. II Ch. 1, 3 (Contract 22)

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"And the LORD said to Satan, 'The LORD rebuke you, O Satan! The LORD who has chosen Jerusalem rebuke you! Is not this a brand plucked from the fire?'"

ZECHARIAH 3:1-4 (V. 2 QUOTED) · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

In Zechariah's vision, Joshua stands in filthy clothes with the accuser at his right hand. God does not argue Joshua's case. He rebukes the accuser and says, Remove the filthy garments. I have taken your iniquity away. The accuser says it once, and you say it to yourself for thirty years: you are just like her, you will always be an addict, you ruin everything. Today you take the pen back. A defeated prosecutor does not get to write your story.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What sentence have I been finishing for the accuser?

2. What are the filthy garments I am still wearing?

3. What clothing does God offer instead?

SOFT ACTION

Cross out the sentence in your writing, and write God's sentence over it: "Remove the filthy garments."

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You rebuke the accuser. Take the filthy clothes I have been wearing and clothe me. Amen.

I do not receive that. That is not mine. I take back the pen.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.3 | Vol. II Ch. 1, 3 (Contract 22)

Write one sentence the accuser has said to her. Cross it out. Write over it what God says. Read it to her. She does not have to answer. Just hear it.

Lord, You rebuke the accuser. Clothe her in what is true.

I do not receive that. I take back the pen.

□ Rewrite one negative sentence from today into a true one.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

ARC 5 · DAYS 46-55

The Bloodline

The Journal: The Bloodline. Standing: Family patterns and ending the cycle. Coming Home: Show Her Her Family Line.

THE HOLY R3UP · 10 DAYS · 40 PAGES

Not Your Guilt, Your Terrain

"The son shall not suffer for the iniquity of the father."

EZEKIEL 18:20 · ESV

Guilt does not transfer. But consequence, pattern, and wound absolutely do. You did not inherit their sin. You inherited the terrain — and the door has stood open for generations because nobody walked over and shut it. That is the whole assignment.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What has run in my family for three generations or more?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I did not inherit guilt. I inherited a door, and I can close it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Terrain, Not Guilt: What You Inherited

MOTHER WOUND · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.1 | Vol. II Ch. 8**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Press your palms together, then let go. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

"The soul who sins shall die. The son shall not suffer for the iniquity of the father, nor the father suffer for the iniquity of the son. The righteousness of the righteous shall be upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked shall be upon himself."

EZEKIEL 18:20 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Guilt does not transfer. You are not guilty of your mother's addiction or your father's abuse. But terrain does: patterns, wounds, habits, biology, silence. Research suggests addiction runs in families through both genes and environment, and scientists are still learning how. Exodus 20:5 says consequences reach down generations; Ezekiel 18 says each person answers for their own; the same Bible says God's steadfast love reaches thousands. You did not inherit their sin. You inherited the ground it grew on, and you get to change what grows.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What has run in my family for three generations or more?

2. Where do I see it in me?

3. What would it mean to see myself as not guilty of any of it?

SOFT ACTION

Write one pattern that has run in your family, and one way you are interrupting it.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I cannot change what I inherited, but I can walk differently. Meet me where they could not. Amen.

I did not inherit guilt. I inherited a terrain, and I can change what grows on it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.1 | Vol. II Ch. 8

Tell her about terrain, not guilt: "You did not inherit their sin. You inherited a hard place, and we are changing it." Write one pattern that ran in your family, and one way you are interrupting it.

Father, I cannot change what I inherited, but I can walk differently.

I did not inherit guilt. I inherited a terrain I can change.

□ Do one thing today that is different from how your family would have done it.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Map the Line

"Our fathers sinned and are no more, and we bear their iniquities."

LAMENTATIONS 5:7 · ESV

Draw it. Three or four generations up, both sides. Mark the columns — addiction, abuse, suicide, early death, mental illness, poverty, abandonment, occult, rage, infidelity, incarceration. Then look at which columns have marks in three generations. You cannot break what you have not named.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

The patterns running in my line:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am looking straight at it. Naming it has already weakened it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Drawing the Family Line

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook 6.2 | Vol. II Ch. 8 (bloodline map)

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Sit with your back against something solid. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

*"we will not hide them from their children, but tell to the coming generation the glorious deeds of the LORD,
and his might, and the wonders that he has done."*

PSALM 78:4 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Draw it. Three or four generations, both sides. Mark the patterns: addiction, abuse, suicide, early death, mental illness, poverty, abandonment, incarceration, silence. Notice which columns have marks in three or more generations. This is not to blame your family. It is to see clearly, and to also see the good: faith, resilience, a grandmother who prayed. The same line that carried the pain carries gifts, and you get to choose what to carry.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What patterns do I see?

2. What good has also come down my line?

3. What do I choose to carry, and what to leave?

SOFT ACTION

Start the family map on the page, even partially. Add one good thing next to each side.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, show me my family as You see it. Thank You for the good, and help me carry it forward. Amen.

I am looking straight at it. And I am looking at what is good, too.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.2 | Vol. II Ch. 8 (bloodline map)

Gather the good things in your family: a skill, a joke, a recipe, a person who prayed. Write five. Show them to her. She gets to keep these.

Lord, thank You for every good thing that came down the line.

There is good in my story, and I get to keep it.

- Cook or play something that came from the good side of your family.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Four Layers

"Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind."

ROM. 12:2 · ESV

Behavioral — you learned it and it looked normal. Biological — research suggests severe stress can affect how the next generation's bodies respond to stress, though scientists are still learning how. Systemic — poverty, incarceration, no assets, real walls. Spiritual — whatever a vow, a practice, or an unhealed wound opened that nobody ever brought to God. Most people fight one layer and wonder why it did not hold.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Which layer have I been ignoring?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am working all four layers, not just the one I can see.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind, that by testing you may discern what is the will of God, what is good and acceptable and perfect."

ROMANS 12:2 · ESV

A pattern can travel four ways. Behavioral: you learn what you saw. Biological: severe stress can shape how bodies respond, and addiction risk runs in families. Systemic: poverty, instability, and lack of support are real walls. Spiritual: Scripture speaks of the enemy and of unhealed wounds, and Christians differ on how to understand this layer. Most people fight one layer and wonder why it did not hold. Work all four: practice new behavior, protect sleep and health, build support, and bring it to God.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which layer have I been ignoring?

2. What is one small action for each layer?

3. Who could help with the one I cannot reach alone?

SOFT ACTION

Write the four layers and one action for each, small enough to do this week.

SUPPLICATION

God, renew my mind and teach me to work all of it. Give me patience with the pace of change. Amen.

I am working all four layers, not just the one I can see.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.1 | Vol. II Ch. 8

Pick one layer (behavior, body, circumstances, faith) and give her what she needed in it: a calm adult, rest, practical help, a prayer. Do one concrete thing today.

God, give her what she did not get, through me and through others.

I can give her what was missing.

□ Do one small thing for your health today: a walk, a vitamin, a bedtime.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Where It Got Permission

"O LORD, you have searched me and known me!"

PSALM 139:1 · ESV

For each pattern ask where it may have started. What somebody did — a covenant, an oath, a practice, a dedication. What somebody said — a curse spoken over a child. What was done to the line — displacement, slavery, a family destroyed. And what secret the family keeps.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

The entry point I can identify:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am finding the hinge, and hinges can be pulled.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Where It May Have Started

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.3 | Vol. II Ch. 8**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.**"Our fathers sinned, and are no more; and we bear their iniquities."*

LAMENTATIONS 5:7 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

For each pattern, ask where it may have started. What was done to your mother? What was done to your grandmother? What did your family lose, flee, or hide? You will not always find an answer, and you are not required to. Understanding your mother's story is not excusing it, and it does not mean you owe her anything. It may help you see that the harm did not start with you, and that some of what looked like cruelty was another wounded person's survival. Hold it with humility.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I know about my mother's own childhood?

2. What do I not know, and can I let that be?

3. How does understanding differ from excusing for me?

SOFT ACTION

Write one possible starting place for one pattern. Label it "maybe."

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You know what I cannot find. Bring light where it helps and mercy where it does not. Amen.

Understanding is not excusing. It is seeing clearly.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.3 | Vol. II Ch. 8

Look at one pattern and write: "This started before me." Tell her: "You did not start this. You are the one who is finally looking at it." Hold what you do not know with humility.

Lord, bring light where it helps, and mercy where it does not.

I am finding where it started, and it did not start with her.

□ Look up one fact about your family or place that is good.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Standing in the Gap

"I and my father's house have sinned."

NEHEMIAH 1:6 · ESV

Daniel repented for generations of sin he did not commit. Nehemiah said I and my father's house. Leviticus 26:40 says they shall confess their iniquity and the iniquity of their fathers. You are not taking their guilt. You are agreeing with God about what is true, and telling the truth about what ran in your family is part of how a pattern loses its hold.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Which pattern am I standing in the gap for today?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I stand in the gap as a daughter of this bloodline. I do not defend it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Standing in the Gap for a Family That Didn't Stand for You

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.4 | Vol. II Ch. 8 (identificational repentance)

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"let your ear be attentive and your eyes open, to hear the prayer of your servant that I now pray before you day and night for the people of Israel your servants, confessing the sins of the people of Israel, which we have sinned against you. Even I and my father's house have sinned."

NEHEMIAH 1:6 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Nehemiah prayed for his people with the words we have sinned, including himself. Daniel did too. Many believers find this meaningful for family patterns: you do not take on their guilt, you agree with God about what is true, and you ask for mercy on your line. It is a practice to consider, not a requirement for freedom or a magic formula. If it does not sit right, skip it and talk to a pastor you trust. It may feel strange to pray for those who failed you; you can do it without defending them.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which pattern would I bring to God by name?

2. What would it be like to pray without defending anyone?

3. What do I want to ask God for the ones who come after me?

SOFT ACTION

Pray for one pattern in your family in your own words, with no one else listening.

SUPPLICATION

God, I stand in the gap with You for a family that did not stand for me. I tell the truth and ask for mercy. Amen.

I stand in the gap as a daughter of this family. I do not defend it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.4 | Vol. II Ch. 8 (identificational repentance)

Pray for your family by name, including yourself: "Even I and my father's house have sinned." You are not taking their guilt; you are agreeing with God and asking mercy. Tell her she is not praying alone.

God, I stand in the gap with You for the people I love.

I can pray for my family without defending them.

□ Pray for one family member by name today.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Bloodline Prayer

"Christ redeemed us from the curse... by becoming a curse for us."

GALATIANS 3:13 · ESV

Galatians 3:13 speaks of the curse of the law; applying it to family patterns is a practical application, not the verse's direct subject. Out loud, one pattern at a time: Father, I confess that ___ has run in my family. I do not defend it or hide it. I bring every covenant, vow, oath, dedication, and harsh word made by anyone in my family line to the cross of Christ, and I ask You to cancel its hold.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Pattern renounced today, and the date:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am choosing to live under Christ, and I will do the work of changing what I can.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

A Prayer for the Line, Including Whoever Comes After You

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook 6.4 | Vol. II Ch. 8

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALName three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"The LORD passed before him and proclaimed, 'The LORD, the LORD, a God merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and abounding in steadfast love and faithfulness,'"

EXODUS 34:6 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Before any prayer about a family line, remember who is being prayed to: merciful, gracious, slow to anger, abounding in steadfast love. Pray specifically: Father, I confess that ___ has run in my family. I do not defend it or hide it. I bring every vow, oath, and harsh word in my family line to the cross of Christ and ask You to cancel its hold. Place me and whoever comes after me, whether children, nieces, nephews, friends, or people I mentor, under Your protection. Nothing here guarantees an outcome. It hands the outcome to the One who is merciful.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which pattern am I praying over?

2. Who comes after me, in any sense?

3. What am I willing to do differently in response?

SOFT ACTION

Pray the prayer once for one pattern. Write the date.

SUPPLICATION

Merciful Father, I bring this pattern and my family to You. Protect whoever comes after me. Begin with me. Amen.

I trust Jesus to carry what I cannot, and I will do the work of changing what I can.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.4 | Vol. II Ch. 8

Pray: "Father, I bring every vow, oath, and harsh word in my family line to the cross of Christ and ask You to cancel its hold. Place her, me, and my family under Your protection." Do this once. Date it.

Merciful Father, I bring this to You. Begin with me.

I trust Jesus to carry what I cannot.

□ Light a candle while you pray, then blow it out and leave the prayer with God.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

My Own Agreements

"Like a sparrow in its flitting, like a swallow in its flying, a curse that is causeless does not alight."

PROVERBS 26:2 · ESV

Sometimes we keep a pattern alive by treating it as fate. It is just how we are. Everybody in my family is like this. We die young. We do not do money. Nobody in my family stays married. That is not prophecy. That is a pattern, and patterns end.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What have I said that agreed with the pattern?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

That was never prophecy. It was a pattern, and it ends.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

MOTHER WOUND · CYCLE-BREAKING

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"Like a sparrow in its flitting, like a swallow in its flying, a curse that is causeless does not alight."

PROVERBS 26:2 · ESV

It is just how we are. Everybody in my family is like this. We die young. We do not do money. We are all addicts. We say these like fate, and they become fate in the telling. That is not prophecy. It is a pattern, and patterns can end. Proverbs 26:2 says a causeless curse does not land. And Christ has redeemed us (Galatians 3:13 speaks of the curse of the law; applying it to family patterns is a practical application, not the verse's direct subject). Watch the sentences you say over yourself.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which of these sentences do I say?

2. Who taught them to me?

3. What truer sentence could replace each?

SOFT ACTION

Cross out one family "we always" sentence and write a truer one beside it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I do not want to speak fate over myself. Put new words in my mouth. Amen.

That was never prophecy. It was a pattern, and it ends.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.5 | Vol. II Ch. 6

Write the "we always" sentences from your family. Cross one out and write a truer one. Teach her the true one.

Lord, put new words in my mouth.

That was never prophecy. It was a pattern, and it ends.

□ Say a true sentence aloud in place of a family sentence.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Change the Behavior

"Put off your old self... and be renewed in the spirit of your minds."

EPHESIANS 4:22-23 · ESV

You can renounce a curse perfectly and still repeat it, because you learned the behavior and nobody taught you another one. Deliverance closes the door. Discipleship builds the house. Name the inherited behavior and the concrete replacement, and practice it badly on purpose.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

The behavior I inherited, and the one I am building:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not just closing a door. I am building a different house.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

New Behavior, Practiced Badly: Learning What Was Never Modeled

CYCLE-BREAKING • ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal • Standing • Coming Home • Go deeper Workbook 6.6 | Vol. II Step 26

SANCTUARY • OPTIONAL

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

“and to be renewed in the spirit of your minds, and to put on the new self, created after the likeness of God in true righteousness and holiness.”

EPHESIANS 4:23-24 • ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

You can renounce a pattern perfectly and still repeat it, because nobody ever showed you something different. Prayer closes a door. Practice builds a house. You may have to learn calm, boundaries, money, rest, and asking for help like a second language. Find someone who does the thing you never saw: a sponsor, a mentor, a therapist, a friend with a steady life, and get close enough to watch. Practice badly on purpose, because practicing badly is how it is learned. This is also reparenting yourself.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What behavior did I inherit?

2. What is the one I am building instead?

3. Who can I watch or learn from?

SOFT ACTION

Choose one replacement behavior and tell your sponsor, counselor, or a friend what it is.

SUPPLICATION

Father, teach me what I was never shown. Give me patience with myself and with the slow pace of learning. Amen.

I am not just closing a door. I am building a different house.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.6 | Vol. II Step 26

Name one skill she never got to learn (rest, money, calm, asking). Choose a teacher: a book, a class, a friend. Practice it badly on purpose today, for five minutes.

ANCHOR: EPHESIANS 4:23-24

Father, teach her what she was never shown.

I am allowed to learn slowly.

- Ask someone to teach you one small thing.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Honor Without Repeating

"Honor your father and mother."

EXODUS 20:12 · ESV

You can honor them and refuse their pattern. Honor is not obedience, agreement, access, or silence. It means you do not degrade them, you do not build your identity on hating them, and you do not hand them your life as payment. It is not betrayal to be the one who stopped it.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What I can honor, and what I am refusing to carry forward:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I honor where I came from. I am not repeating it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Honor Without Repeating

MOTHER WOUND · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook 6.7 | Vol. II Ch. 8

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALPress your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

"Honor your father and your mother, that your days may be long in the land that the LORD your God is giving you."

EXODUS 20:12 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

You can honor your parents and refuse their pattern. Honor is not obedience, agreement, access, or silence. It means you do not degrade them, you do not build your identity on hating them, and you do not hand them your life as payment. If your mother failed to protect you, honoring may look like praying for her from a distance, speaking truthfully of her, and keeping safe boundaries. It is not betrayal to be the one who stopped it.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What can I genuinely honor about where I came from?

2. What am I refusing to carry forward?

3. What boundary protects both of us?

SOFT ACTION

Write one honest good thing about each parent, if there is one. Then one thing you will not repeat.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You asked me to honor, and You never asked me to be hurt. Show me what honor looks like safely. Amen.

I honor where I came from. I am not repeating it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.7 | Vol. II Ch. 8

Write one honest good thing about each parent or caregiver, if there is one. Write one thing you will not repeat. You can honor without being close or silent.

Lord, show me what honor looks like safely.

I honor where I came from. I am not repeating it.

□ Send a safe, kind, short note to someone from your past who was good to you.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Line Stops Here

"I will restore to you the years that the swarming locust has eaten."

JOEL 2:25 · ESV

Write it and sign it and put it where you will see it every day. Three things that end with me. Three things that begin with me. Then bless the people in your life out loud, by name, regularly. Words can wound and words can bless. Speak over them what nobody spoke over you.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Three things that end with me. Three that begin with me.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I can be the pivot. I am choosing to help what was meant to bury my family become something that frees it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Line Stops Here: How You Do Not Carry It On

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook 6.8 | Vol. II Step 16

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALSit with your back against something solid. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

“And if it is evil in your eyes to serve the LORD, choose this day whom you will serve... But as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD.”

JOSHUA 24:15 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Write it, sign it, put it where you will see it. Three things that end with me. Three things that begin with me. Not carrying it on is not one prayer; it is a way of living. It means staying in recovery. Staying in therapy. Choosing safe partners and safe friends. Not handing your pain to people who did not cause it. If you ever raise children, mentor, or love someone vulnerable, you will have done your healing first. And it means blessing the people around you with what nobody gave you.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Three things that end with me:

2. Three things that begin with me:

3. Who will I bless this week?

SOFT ACTION

Write your declaration and sign it. Bless one person aloud, by name.

SUPPLICATION

God, let it stop here, with You and with me. I place whoever comes after me in Your hands. Amen.

I can be the pivot. I am choosing to turn what was meant to bury my family into something that frees it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 6.8 | Vol. II Step 16

Write her a promise in one paragraph: "I will protect you. The line stops here. I will not leave you." Sign it. Put it where only you can find it.

God, let it stop here, with You and with me.

I am the pivot, and I do not have to be perfect.

- Read your promise aloud once.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

ARC 6 · DAYS 56-68

The Playbook and the Structure

The Journal: The Playbook and the Structure. Standing: Patterns, cravings, daily structure, boundaries, falling. Coming Home: Build Her a House.

THE HOLY R3UP · 13 DAYS · 52 PAGES

Twelve Stages

"We are not ignorant of his designs."

2 CORINTHIANS 2:11 · ESV

Intercept before arrival. Break the foundation. Steal identity and assign a false name. Isolate. Install the coping mechanism. Build the shame loop. Collect signatures. Normalize. Multiply. Attack the calling. Run out the clock. Take the testimony. Patterns can be read. (This is a pattern-spotting tool, not a revealed schedule — Scripture warns us not to be ignorant of the enemy's designs, and it also warns against blaming the devil for everything. Use it to notice, not to label every hard thing an attack.)

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Which of these patterns is loudest in my life this week?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I can read the play now. Predictable is beatable.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Twelve Patterns

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 12 | Workbook 2.2

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Take a slow sip of water. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

“so that we would not be outwitted by Satan; for we are not ignorant of his designs.”

2 CORINTHIANS 2:11 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Volume II lays out twelve patterns that show up in the lives of people who have been hurt and stuck: being unwanted, early wounds, a false name, isolation, a coping tool, a shame loop, agreements, normalizing, passing it on, derailing the calling, waiting too long, silencing the story. This is a pattern-recognition tool, not a revealed schedule. Scripture also says much of our trouble comes from our own hearts, other people, and a broken world. Use it to notice, not to decide every hard thing was a scripted attack, and never to blame yourself for what was done to you.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which of the twelve patterns do I recognize?

2. Which is loudest right now?

3. What would I need to interrupt it?

SOFT ACTION

Mark the two patterns that fit you best. Do not analyze. Just notice.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I do not want to be outwitted, and I do not want to see attacks everywhere. Give me clear eyes. Amen.

I can read the pattern now. Predictable is beatable.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 12 | Workbook 2.2

List three patterns that pull her back into old ways (isolation, a coping tool, waiting). Use them to notice, not to label everything an attack. Say: "I see you. I am not ignorant of this."

Lord, give clear eyes, not fear.

I can read the pattern now.

- Do one thing today that breaks one pattern.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Isolation Is the Hinge

"God settles the solitary in a home."

PSALM 68:6 · ESV

Stage four is isolation, and it makes almost everything else harder. This is why you need five roles filled, not one: the one who knows everything, the one further ahead, the one behind you, the one who is just a friend, and the one allowed to correct you.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Which of my five roles is empty?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I will not do this alone. Alone was the plan, not the answer.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Isolation: Your Family Taught You to Be Alone

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 12 (Stage 4), Step 24 | Workbook Part V Step 6**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"Two are better than one, because they have a good reward for their toil. For if they fall, one will lift up his fellow. But woe to him who is alone when he falls and has no one to lift him up!"

ECCLESIASTES 4:9-10 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Isolation makes almost every harm worse. Abusers isolate. Addiction isolates. Families that keep secrets isolate their children, and a baby who learned that no one comes may still believe it. This is why you need five kinds of people, not one: the one who knows everything, the one further ahead, the one behind you, the one who is just a friend, and the one allowed to correct you. A meeting, a sponsor, a counselor, and a church small group can fill the first of these.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which of the five roles is empty for me?

2. Where could I find one this month?

3. What keeps me from reaching out?

SOFT ACTION

Write the five roles with one name beside each, or a blank. Choose one blank to work on.

SUPPLICATION

God, You settle the solitary in a home. Put people around me, and give me courage to let them in. Amen.

I will not do this alone. Alone was the plan, not the answer.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 12 (Stage 4), Step 24 | Workbook Part V Step 6

Write five roles: someone who knows everything, someone ahead of you, someone behind you, a friend, someone who can correct you. Put a name next to each or leave a blank. Pick one blank to fill.

God, settle the solitary in a home.

She is not alone, and neither am I.

- Reach out to one person you have lost touch with.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The One Who Can Correct You

"Faithful are the wounds of a friend."

PROVERBS 27:6 · ESV

Many people who crash have this slot empty. A chosen person who cannot be corrected is the most dangerous person in the room, and there are a lot of them with microphones. If nobody is allowed to tell you you are wrong, that is this month's assignment.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Who is allowed to tell me I am wrong, and how did I take it last time?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I would rather be corrected than be impressive.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Who Can Tell You You're Wrong

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 3.4 (Work Page 11) | Vol. II Ch. 34**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.**"Iron sharpens iron, and one man sharpens another."*

PROVERBS 27:17 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

A person who cannot be corrected is dangerous, and that includes a survivor who has been wrong-footed so many times she can only defend. If nobody is allowed to tell you you are wrong, that is this month's assignment. Correction from someone who loves you is a gift, and it is uncomfortable. Learn to hear it without collapsing into shame or attacking in defense. Teachable people break cycles; defended people repeat them.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who is allowed to tell me I am wrong?

2. How did I take it the last time?

3. What would help me receive correction without falling apart?

SOFT ACTION

Ask one trusted person, "What is one thing I could hear that would help me?" Listen without answering.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, make me teachable. Give me friends who will tell me the truth with love. Amen.

I would rather be corrected than be impressive.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 3.4 (Work Page 11) | Vol. II Ch. 34

Ask a trusted person: "What is one thing you think I could hear that would help me?" Listen without defending. Thank them. Tell her: "We can learn."

Lord, make me teachable.

I would rather be helped than impressive.

- Ask for help with one small thing.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Running Out the Clock

"Now is the favorable time; behold, now is the day of salvation."

One of the most common traps is not destruction. It is delay. A woman who is going to change soon for thirty years has changed nothing at all. Someday costs nothing. A date changes everything.

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What have I been about to do for years?

Not someday. Today has a date on it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"Look carefully then how you walk, not as unwise but as wise, making the best use of the time, because the days are evil."

EPHESIANS 5:15-16 · ESV

One of the most common traps is not destruction. It is delay. Someday I will get sober. Someday I will tell the truth. When I am ready. A woman who is going to change soon for thirty years has changed nothing. This is not a call to panic or perfection. It is an invitation to pick one small, real step with a date on it. Every day you wait is a day the pattern keeps running.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I been about to do for years?

2. What is the smallest version I could do this week?

3. Who will hold me to it?

SOFT ACTION

Put one date on the calendar for one small step. Tell one person.

SUPPLICATION

Father, redeem the time I have lost, and help me not to waste today. Amen.

Not someday. Today has a date on it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Stop Making Her Wait

RETURN TO HER

ANCHOR: EPHESIANS 5:15-16

Father, redeem the time, and help me not waste today.

Not someday. Today has a date on it.

- Do the thing you have been putting off for five minutes only.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Map the Trigger Chain

"Be sober-minded; be watchful."

1 PETER 5:8 · ESV

Relapse is never one moment. It is a chain of eight or ten links. Setting, emotional state, body state, the thought, the justification, the first action, the point of no return, the use, the aftermath. Circle link three or four. That is where you intervene from now on — by link seven you had already decided.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

My earliest detectable link, and what I will do the moment I see it:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I fight at link three. Link seven is not a fight, it is a formality.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Trigger Chain: When Abandonment Is the Link

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 4 | Vol. II Step 27, 28

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

“Be sober-minded; be watchful. Your adversary the devil prowls around like a roaring lion, seeking someone to devour. Resist him, firm in your faith, knowing that the same kinds of suffering are being experienced by your brotherhood throughout the world.”

1 PETER 5:8-9 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Relapse is never one moment. It is a chain with six to ten links: the setting, the emotional state, the body, the thought, the justification, the first action, the point of no return, the use, the aftermath. For a daughter of an unprotective mother, the early links are often feeling abandoned, unseen, or dismissed, and the thought, no one cares anyway. Circle link three or four. That is where you intervene, because by link seven you had already decided.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What does my chain look like, step by step?

2. Which link is earliest and detectable?

3. What will I do the moment I see it?

SOFT ACTION

Write your chain and circle the earliest link. Write one action for it, such as a phone call or a walk.

SUPPLICATION

God, help me see the early links, and give me a plan for the moment I feel left alone. Amen.

I fight at link three. Link seven is not a fight, it is a formality.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 4 | Vol. II Step 27, 28

Write what sets her off: setting, time of day, body state, the thought, the first action. Circle the earliest link. Write what you will do when you see it.

God, show us the early link.

I can catch it early.

- Set a daily alarm labeled with your early-link action.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

HALT

"He gives food to the hungry. The LORD sets the prisoners free."

PSALM 146:7 · ESV

Hungry, angry, lonely, tired. Many relapses are several of those stacked — and they are not only about the substance. Run the check three times a day. Some of what feels like a craving is blood sugar, and some of what feels like despair is sleep.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Which of the four is loudest right now, and what will I do about it in the next hour?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I will feed, rest, call, and calm before I decide anything.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

HALT: Hungry, Angry, Lonely, Tired

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 4 | Vol. II Ch. 17**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"It is in vain that you rise up early and go late to rest, eating the bread of anxious toil; for he gives to his beloved sleep."

PSALM 127:2 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Many relapses are several of these stacked, and they are rarely only about the substance. Lonely is the one that hits hardest for a child who was left. Some of what feels like a craving is blood—sugar. Some of what feels like despair is sleep. Run the check three times a day: what is loudest, and what can I do about it in the next hour? Feed yourself, rest, call someone, calm your body. That is how you give yourself what no one gave you.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which of the four is loudest right now?

2. What can I do about it in the next hour?

3. Who could I call when it is lonely?

SOFT ACTION

Eat something real and drink water. Set a bedtime and put the phone out of reach.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You give Your beloved sleep. Help me care for myself like someone worth caring for. Amen.

I will feed, rest, call, and calm before I decide anything.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 4 | Vol. II Ch. 17

Check on her: is she Hungry, Angry, Lonely, or Tired? Feed, rest, call, or calm before you decide anything. Do one right now.

Lord, You give Your beloved sleep.

I will feed, rest, call, and calm first.

□ Go to bed on time tonight with the phone out of the room.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Craving Protocol

"With the temptation he will also provide the way of escape."

1 CORINTHIANS 10:13 · ESV

A craving often peaks and fades within fifteen to thirty minutes, even when it does not feel that way. Say it out loud. Set a timer. Change your body — cold water, twenty pushups, walk out the door. Change your location. Call, do not text. Eat and drink. Pray short. Play the tape forward to hour forty-eight.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

My three numbers, memorized:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I only have to outlast a wave. It always breaks.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Craving Wave

ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 7 | Vol. II Step 28

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"No temptation has overtaken you that is not common to man. God is faithful, and he will not let you be tempted beyond your ability, but with the temptation he will also provide the way of escape, that you may be able to endure it."

1 CORINTHIANS 10:13 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

A craving often peaks and fades within fifteen to thirty minutes, even when it does not feel that way. Say it aloud: I am having a craving. It will peak and pass. Set a timer. Change your body: cold water, twenty pushups, walk outside. Change your location. Call, do not text. Eat and drink. Pray short. Play the tape forward. You only have to outlast a wave. A body that never learned to self-soothe can learn it, one wave at a time.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who are the three numbers I will call, memorized?

2. What changes my body fastest?

3. What is my short prayer?

SOFT ACTION

Write your three numbers on a card and tape one copy where you will see it.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, I do not have to win this hour, only this wave. Give me a way out and the sense to take it. Amen.

I only have to outlast a wave. It always breaks.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 7 | Vol. II Step 28

When a craving or urge comes, tell her: "This is a wave. It will peak and pass." Set a timer, change your body, call someone. Write your three phone numbers on a card.

Jesus, I only have to outlast this wave.

I can outlast a wave. It always breaks.

- Practice your wave plan once when you are calm.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Play the Tape Forward

"Ponder the path of your feet."

PROVERBS 4:26 · ESV

Not the first hour. The forty-eighth. The call you would have to make. The face you would have to look at. Write it down now, in advance, while you are clear — because you will not be able to write it in the moment, and that is exactly when you will need it.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

If I use or go back today, within 48 hours I will:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I decide this now, while I can still think.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Play the Tape Forward: Who Else Pays

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook Part V Step 7 | Vol. II Step 29

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALSit with your back against something solid. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.**"There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way to death."*

PROVERBS 14:12 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Not the first hour. The forty-eighth. The call you would have to make. The face you would have to look at. Write it now, while you are clear, because you will not be able to write it in the moment. Add the people who would pay: your sponsor, your friends, whoever looks up to you, whoever you hope to be a different example for. Include where the naloxone is if opioids are in your history. This is not a scare tactic. It is a gift to your future self.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. If I use today, what happens within forty-eight hours?

2. Whose face do I see?

3. What do I most want to protect?

SOFT ACTION

Write your tape on a card. Keep it where you keep your keys.

SUPPLICATION

God, I want to keep what You have given me. Let me remember it when I cannot think. Amen.

I decide this now, while I can still think.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 7 | Vol. II Step 29

Write a short note to future-you from the worst possible moment: what you would need to read. Keep it where you can find it. Tell her: "We decide this now, while we can think."

God, let me remember what matters when I cannot think.

I decide this now, while I can still think.

- Put your note somewhere you will find it in a hard moment.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Replace the Function

"He satisfies the longing soul, and the hungry soul he fills with good things."

PSALM 107:9 · ESV

You cannot leave a vacancy. For every job it did — numbing, energy, sleep, courage, something to look forward to, quieting your head, punishing you, giving you people — write a legitimate replacement. Hard exercise, cold water, sunlight, real food, service, loud worship, something with your hands.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

The job it did, and what does that job now:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not removing something. I am replacing it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Replace the Function: What Your Mother Couldn't Give

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 5 | Vol. II Step 26**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Take a slow sip of water. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

*"Why do you spend your money for that which is not bread, and your labor for that which does not satisfy?
Listen diligently to me, and eat what is good, and delight yourselves in rich food."*

ISAIAH 55:2 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

You cannot leave a vacancy. For every job the substance did, find a legitimate replacement. It numbed pain, so find a place to put pain: therapy, a journal, a friend. It gave energy, so find food, movement, sleep. It gave belonging, so find a meeting or a church group. It quieted your head, so find music, a walk, or silence. It held you, so find real human touch, safe and chosen, and the comfort practices you are learning. God invites us to what satisfies.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What jobs did it do for me?

2. What legitimate replacement could do each job?

3. When will I do it?

SOFT ACTION

Complete the job and replacement list from Day 39. Choose one to start today.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I do not want to leave an empty room. Fill it with what is good. Amen.

I am not removing something. I am replacing it.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 5 | Vol. II Step 26

Make a comfort box for her: five things that soothe without harm (tea, a scent, music, a soft cloth, a card with a verse). Put it where you will reach for it.

Lord, fill the place the old comfort filled.

I can comfort her in ways that do not cost us.

□ Use one item from the comfort box today, even if you are okay.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Fill the House

"The last state of that person is worse than the first."

LUKE 11:26 · ESV

Jesus told a story about a swept house left empty, and the last state was worse than the first. Whatever your view of the spiritual side, the practical truth stands: when something leaves your life, something has to take its place. The same day you empty something, fill it. Where fear lived, put love. Where shame lived, put belonging. Where craving lived, put satisfaction. Leave nothing vacant.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What am I filling today, and with what specifically?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Holy Spirit, occupy every room. Leave nothing empty.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Fill the House

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.6 (Step 8) | Vol. II Step 18

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

"Do not be overcome by evil, but overcome evil with good."

ROMANS 12:21 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Jesus tells a story of a swept house left empty (Luke 11:24-26), and the last state was worse than the first. Whatever your view of the spiritual side, the practical truth stands: when something leaves your life, something must take its place. Where fear lived, put love. Where shame lived, put belonging. Where craving lived, put satisfaction. For a home, this can mean worship music, a routine, a regular meal, a table prayer. Overcome with good, in small and visible ways.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What am I emptying that needs filling?

2. What small good thing could fill it?

3. What would my "filled" home feel like?

SOFT ACTION

Choose one new, simple good habit for your home this week. Start tonight.

SUPPLICATION

Holy Spirit, fill every room that has been emptied. Leave nothing vacant. Amen.

Holy Spirit, occupy every room. Leave nothing empty.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 2.6 (Step 8) | Vol. II Step 18

Add one good thing to your space today: worship music, a plant, a picture, a lit candle, a prayer on the wall. Say: "This is her home now."

Holy Spirit, fill every room that has been emptied.

I am building a home that is safe and good.

- Play a song that makes you feel safe while you tidy one corner.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Architecture, Not Willpower

"Let all things be done decently and in order."

1 CORINTHIANS 14:40 · ESV

Same wake hour. Sunlight in the first hour. Prayer and armor out loud. Protein and water before caffeine. Move twenty minutes. HALT check. A meeting or a call. Same bedtime, phone out of the room. Gratitude out loud. Sleep affects almost everything else.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Which piece of the daily structure am I missing most?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Freedom is architecture. I am building the walls.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Architecture, Not Willpower

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook Part V Step 6 | Vol. II Step 23

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALHold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.**"But all things should be done decently and in order."*

1 CORINTHIANS 14:40 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Freedom is architecture. Same wake hour. Sunlight in the first hour. Prayer out loud. Protein and water before caffeine. Movement. A HALT check. A meeting or a call. Same bedtime, phone out of the room. Pick the three that matter most and let the others wait. If you did not grow up with structure, you are building it from scratch, and that is hard and holy. Sleep affects almost everything else.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which piece of daily structure am I missing most?

2. What is the smallest version I could try?

3. What would I need to ask someone for?

SOFT ACTION

Choose three anchors for your day and write them where you can see them.

SUPPLICATION

God, You are a God of order. Help me build a day I can stand on. Amen.

Freedom is architecture. I am building the walls.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 6 | Vol. II Step 23

Choose three anchors for her day: a wake time, a meal, a bedtime. Write them where you can see them. Be kind when you miss one.

God, You are a God of order. Help me build a day I can stand on.

I am building walls that hold.

□ Do your three anchors today and cross them off.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Boundaries in the Real World

"Let your yes be yes and your no be no."

MATTHEW 5:37 · ESV

Boundaries that exist only in your heart are wishes. Block the number. Change the lock. Tell the relative who relays messages to stop. And decide now what you will do when they reach out — because they will, usually right when you get peaceful, and deciding in the moment is how you get pulled back in.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

The boundary, and exactly how I enforce it this week:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not explaining it forty times. It is a property line.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Boundaries With Family, With Her, With Him

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook 7.5 (Step 6) | Vol. II Step 25

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"Keep your heart with all vigilance, for from it flow the springs of life."

PROVERBS 4:23 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Boundaries that exist only in your heart are wishes. Block the number. Change the lock. Tell the relative who relays messages to stop. Decide in advance what you will do when they reach out, because they usually do right when you get peaceful. Decide what contact with your mother or father, if any, looks like, and what is non-negotiable (no substances, no abuse, no guilt trips). A boundary is a property line, not a punishment, and you do not have to explain it forty times.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What boundary do I need to set?

2. How will I enforce it this week?

3. What will I do when they push back?

SOFT ACTION

Set one real-world boundary today. Write the exact sentence you will use.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, give me a firm yes and a firm no, and keep my heart open to those who are safe. Amen.

I am not explaining it forty times. It is a property line.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 7.5 (Step 6) | Vol. II Step 25

Set one real boundary today: block a number, say no, change a lock. Write the exact sentence you will use. Tell her: "I will protect you."

Lord, give me a firm yes and a firm no.

A boundary is a property line, not a punishment.

□ Say your boundary sentence aloud three times.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

When You Fall

"The righteous falls seven times and rises again."

PROVERBS 24:16 · ESV

Having a plan is not permission — not having one gives the fall a runway. Stop at the first one; the fall is the first act, the ruin is the decision afterward. Tell someone within the hour. Do not throw away ninety days over one day. Then find the link you missed and write it down.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

My written plan for the day I fall:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

The identity is in the rising, not the never falling.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

When You Fall

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 8 | Vol. II Step 29

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"Rejoice not over me, O my enemy; when I fall, I shall rise; when I sit in darkness, the LORD will be a light to me."

MICAH 7:8 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Having a plan is not permission. Not having one gives the fall a runway. Stop at the first one. The fall is the first act, the ruin is the decision afterward. Tell someone within the hour. Have naloxone in the house if opioids are in your history, and tell a person who can help. Do not throw away ninety days over one day. Then find the link you missed and write it down. Shame says hide; recovery says tell. The identity is in the rising.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What is my written plan for the day I fall?

2. Who will I tell within the hour?

3. What will I not do afterward?

SOFT ACTION

Write the plan and share it with one person. Keep a copy somewhere you can find it.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, when I fall, You are my light. Give me someone to call. Amen.

The identity is in the rising, not in never falling.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Part V Step 8 | Vol. II Step 29

Write your plan for the day you fall: who you will tell within the hour, where you will go, what you will not do. Tell her: "If we fall, we get back up. We do not hide."

Lord, when I fall, You are my light.

The identity is in the rising, not in never falling.

- Share your plan with one person.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

ARC 7 · DAYS 69 – 76

God

*The Journal: God. Standing: Where He was, honest anger, silence.
Coming Home: Where Was Jesus?.*

THE HOLY R3UP · 8 DAYS · 32 PAGES

Where He Was

"The LORD is near to the brokenhearted."

PSALM 34:18 · ESV

In the room. Not outside it, not arriving after. Near, during. That is harder than absence, because it means He saw — and better than absence, because it means you were never alone in there even when you felt completely alone. And He kept the record of every tear.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Where do I most need to know He was standing?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

He was in the room. I was never in there by myself.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Where Was He When You Were Six Months Old?

CHILDHOOD • WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal • Standing • Coming Home • **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 22 | Workbook 1.5

SANCTUARY • OPTIONAL

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

“So she called the name of the LORD who spoke to her, “You are a God of seeing,” for she said, “Truly here I have seen him who looks after me.””

GENESIS 16:13 • ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Hagar, a mistreated servant who had run away, is the first person in Scripture to give God a name, and it is the God who sees. He was near the brokenhearted, in the room, not outside it, not arriving later. That is harder than absence, because it means He saw. It is also better than absence, because it means you were never alone, even when you felt completely alone. I do not know why He did not stop it. I know He saw, and I know He kept the record of every tear.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where do I most need to know He was?

2. What do I feel when I imagine Him in that room?

3. What do I want to say to Him?

SOFT ACTION

Say aloud, "You saw me." Sit with whatever comes.

SUPPLICATION

God of seeing, I did not know You were there. Show me, gently, how You were. Amen.

He was in the room. I was never in there by myself.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 22 | Workbook 1.5

If you want, sit at the doorway and ask: "Where were You, Lord?" You may sense, imagine, or see nothing, and that is fine. Do not force a scene. You can instead say aloud: "You are a God of seeing." If you are angry, say that too.

God of seeing, show me, gently, how You were there.

He was in the room. She was never alone
in there.

□ Light a candle and sit quietly with the question for five minutes.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Why He Did Not Stop It

"Now we see in a mirror dimly, but then face to face."

1 CORINTHIANS 13:12 · ESV

He made a world with real agency, because love that cannot be refused is not love. Real agency means people can genuinely choose evil, and He does not routinely override the will He gave. He did not cause it, want it, or approve it. He hated it. And that is an explanation, not a comfort, and I will not pretend it is the same thing.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What part of this has no answer, and can I hold it open anyway?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I trust His character where I cannot trace His hand.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Why Didn't He Stop It?

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 23 | Workbook 3.1

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Press your palms together, then let go. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

"Can a woman forget her nursing child, that she should have no compassion on the son of her womb? Even these may forget, yet I will not forget you."

ISAIAH 49:15 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

God made a world with real agency, because love that cannot be refused is not love. That means people can choose evil, and He does not routinely override the will He gave. He did not cause it, want it, or approve it. He hated it. That is an explanation, not a comfort, and I will not pretend it is the same. But hear how He answers in Isaiah: Can a woman forget her nursing child? Even these may forget, yet I will not forget you. He knows that mothers fail. And He says: I will not.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I most need to ask Him?

2. What do I do with the part that has no answer?

3. How does it feel to hear Him say, "I will not forget you"?

SOFT ACTION

Write the question you have never asked, and leave it open.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I do not understand. I trust Your character where I cannot trace Your hand. Stay with me. Amen.

I trust His character where I cannot trace His hand.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 23 | Workbook 3.1

Ask her: "What do you want to ask God?" Write her question. Do not answer it. Leave it open. Say: "We trust His character where we cannot trace His hand."

Father, I do not understand. Stay with us.

I can hold a question without a verdict.

□ Write one question for God on a card and put it in your Bible.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Not Punishment

"It was not that this man sinned, or his parents."

JOHN 9:3 · ESV

The disciples asked whose sin caused a man's blindness and Jesus rejected the entire premise of the question. Your suffering was not invoiced to you. Jesus paid the bill and God does not double-bill. Whatever this was, it was not the sentence for being you.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What have I secretly believed I was being punished for?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

He is not punishing me. There is no condemnation.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Not Punishment

CHILDHOOD · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 20 | Workbook 3.3

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Sit with your back against something solid. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

"Jesus answered, 'It was not that this man sinned, or his parents, but that the works of God might be displayed in him.'"

JOHN 9:3 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

The disciples asked whose sin caused a man's blindness, and Jesus rejected the whole premise. What was done to you as a baby was not the sentence for anything you did or were. Your suffering was not invoiced to you. Jesus paid the bill and God does not double-bill. Grief is not proof of a curse, and hardship is not a verdict. If you have been secretly wondering what was wrong with you that this happened, nothing was.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I secretly believed I was being punished for?

2. Where did I learn that suffering means I did something wrong?

3. What would it mean to let that go?

SOFT ACTION

Write the sentence you believe, then cross it out and write, "This was not punishment."

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You refused the lie that suffering is always a sentence. Take mine out of that frame. Amen.

He is not punishing me. There is no condemnation.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 20 | Workbook 3.3

Tell her: "What happened was not a punishment for who you were." Write the sentence you believed, cross it out, and write: "This was not punishment."

Jesus, refuse the lie that suffering is always a sentence.

I am not being punished. There is no condemnation.

- Do one kind thing for someone who is suffering.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Angry at God

"My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?"

MATTHEW 27:46 · ESV

Jesus quoted a psalm of abandonment from the cross. Job accused God for thirty-seven chapters and God said Job spoke rightly. Lamentations is grief laid out before God, and God kept it in the canon. He can handle your rage. What He cannot work with is your distance.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What have I never said to Him directly?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I bring it to Him instead of holding it against Him.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Angry at God

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 27 | Workbook 7.6

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Take a slow sip of water. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

"How long, O LORD? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me? How long must I take counsel in my soul and have sorrow in my heart all the day? How long shall my enemy be exalted over me?"

PSALM 13:1-2 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Scripture preserves complaints. Jesus quoted a psalm of abandonment from the cross. Job accused God and God said Job had spoken rightly of Him. Lamentations is grief laid out before God, and God kept it in the canon. He can handle your rage. What He cannot work with is your distance. Say it to Him directly, even the part that says, where were You when I was a baby and no one protected me?

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I never said to God directly?

2. What am I afraid will happen if I do?

3. What would it look like to say it today?

SOFT ACTION

Write or say it to God, unedited, for two minutes.

SUPPLICATION

God, here it is, all of it. I am bringing it to You instead of holding it against You. Amen.

I bring it to Him instead of holding it against Him.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 27 | Workbook 7.6

ANCHOR: PSALM 13:1-2

Anger can be honest prayer.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Take Your Case Out of Court

"Vengeance is mine, I will repay, says the Lord."

ROMANS 12:19 · ESV

As long as you have a verdict against God, you cannot receive from Him. You do not have to stop having questions. You have to stop having a verdict. And handing over the case against the ones who hurt you is not letting them off — it is God taking a weight that was killing you.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What verdict am I revoking today?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I keep the questions open. I withdraw the verdict.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Taking Your Case Out of Court

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 26 | Workbook 2.6 (Step 3)

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"Beloved, never avenge yourselves, but leave it to the wrath of God, for it is written, 'Vengeance is mine, I will repay, says the Lord.'"

ROMANS 12:19 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

As long as you hold a verdict against God, you cannot receive from Him. You do not have to stop having questions. You have to stop having a verdict. And handing over your case against your—father and your mother is not letting them off. It is God taking a weight that was killing you. He is the judge, and He sees everything, including what never reached a human court. Some people never face anything on earth. That is not the end of the story.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What verdict am I carrying against God?

2. What case am I carrying against my father and mother?

3. What would it feel like to hand each to Him?

SOFT ACTION

Write "I withdraw the verdict" beside the one you are ready to put down.

SUPPLICATION

God, I keep my questions open and I withdraw my verdict. The case is Yours. Amen.

I keep the questions open. I withdraw the verdict.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 26 | Workbook 2.6 (Step 3)

Write her case against those who hurt her. Then write: "I give this case to God." Fold and put it away. You can keep your questions. You are putting down the weight.

Lord, I withdraw the verdict. The case is Yours.

I keep the questions open and withdraw the verdict.

□ Take one deep breath and let your shoulders drop three times.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Silence

"It is good that one should wait quietly for the salvation of the LORD."

LAM. 3:26 · ESV

Elijah was suicidal and looked for God in wind, earthquake, and fire, and God came in a thin silence — after He fed him and let him sleep twice. Food, sleep, then the whisper. Sometimes the silence is not rejection. Sometimes you are exhausted and He is feeding you first.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Have I been asking for a whisper when I actually need food and sleep?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Silence is documented. It is not rejection.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

WARFARE · ADDICTION

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

"It is good that one should wait quietly for the salvation of the LORD."

LAMENTATIONS 3:26 · ESV

Elijah was suicidal and looked for God in wind, earthquake, and fire, and God came in a thin silence, after He fed him and let him sleep twice. Food, sleep, then the whisper. Sometimes the silence is not rejection. Sometimes you are exhausted and He is feeding you first. In early recovery you may have no energy for a long quiet time, and that is okay. A few honest sentences are prayer.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Have I been asking for a whisper when I need food and sleep?

2. What would feed me today?

3. What is one small way to wait?

SOFT ACTION

Eat something and rest ten minutes before praying. Then pray one sentence.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, I am tired. Feed me, and then speak. Amen.

Silence is documented. It is not rejection.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 27 | Workbook 7.6

Sit two minutes with her in the quiet. Eyes open is fine. If your mind runs, say "later" and come back. The coming back is the prayer.

Father, I do not have to say anything. I am not leaving.

Silence is not rejection.

- Eat something and rest ten minutes before praying.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Sitting Silent With Him

"Be still, and know that I am God."

PSALM 46:10 · ESV

Noise was safety. If it was quiet you could hear them coming, and you had to feel it. So silence will feel like danger before it feels like peace. Start at two minutes. Eyes open if closed is unsafe. When your mind runs, say later and come back. The coming back is the prayer.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

How long did I sit, and what came up?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am here. He does not have to say anything. I am not leaving.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Rocked Like a Weaned Child

CHILDHOOD · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 7.6 | Vol. II Ch. 27

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"But I have calmed and quieted my soul, like a weaned child with its mother; like a weaned child is my soul within me."

PSALM 131:2 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Noise was safety. If it was quiet, you could hear them coming, and you had to feel it. So silence may feel like danger before it feels like peace. Start with two minutes. Eyes open if closed feels unsafe. When your mind runs, say later and come back. The coming back is the prayer. The psalmist describes a soul quieted like a weaned child with its mother. You may not have had that mother. You can ask for it from the One who comforts like one.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. How long did I sit, and what came up?

2. What does silence feel like in my body?

3. What would it be like to be quieted like a child with her mother?

SOFT ACTION

Sit two minutes today. Feet on the floor. Say once, "Jesus, I am here." Then nothing.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I do not have to say anything. I am not leaving. Quiet my soul like a child with her mother. Amen.

I am here. He does not have to say anything. I am not leaving.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 7.6 | Vol. II Ch. 27

Hold a pillow or soft thing against your chest and rock gently for three minutes while you breathe slowly. Whisper: "You are not alone. I am here." This is comfort, not pressure.

Lord, quiet her soul like a child with its mother.

I can comfort her the way she needed to be comforted.

- Hum a lullaby or a hymn.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

All Things Work Together

"And we know that for those who love God all things work together for good, for those who are called according to his purpose."

ROMANS 8:28 · ESV

It does not say all things are good. It says He works in all things toward good, and the next verse defines good as being made like Christ. It is not a promise that your story will have a satisfying plot. It is a promise that nothing in it is unusable in His hands.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What do I need Him to use rather than explain?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

It was not good. It will not be wasted. Those are different.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

All Things, Honestly

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 25 | Workbook 3.5

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

"And we know that for those who love God all things work together for good, for those who are called according to his purpose."

ROMANS 8:28 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

It does not say all things are good. It says God works in all things toward good, and the next verse defines that good as being made like Christ. It is not a promise that your story will have a satisfying plot, and it is not meant to be said to someone in fresh grief. It is a promise that nothing in your story, including what happened when you were a baby and the years in your addiction, is unusable in His hands. It was not good. It will not be wasted. Those are different things.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What do I need Him to use rather than explain?

2. What have I been tempted to call good that was not?

3. What do I hope He will redeem?

SOFT ACTION

Write one thing that was not good, and one thing you are asking Him not to waste.

SUPPLICATION

God, I will not call it good, but I ask You not to waste it. Use it. Amen.

It was not good. It will not be wasted. Those are different.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 25 | Workbook 3.5

Write one thing that was not good, and one thing you ask God not to waste. Tell her: "It was not good. It will not be wasted."

God, I will not call it good, but I ask You not to waste it.

It was not good. It will not be wasted.

□ Share something small that you learned with someone.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

ARC 8 · DAYS 77-84

Brandi and Letting Go

The Journal: Brandi and Letting Go. Standing: Grief, guilt, children out of reach, release. Coming Home: Say Goodbye and Hello.

THE HOLY R3UP · 8 DAYS · 32 PAGES

You Were Her Sister

"He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."

PSALM 147:3 · ESV

You were not her savior. You were her sister. You did not lose her because you were too slow, too broken, or too late. You lost her because addiction is lethal, she was sick, and the world she was in was built to fail people exactly like her — and none of those three were yours to control.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What I did do for her:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I loved her. I was never her God. That was never my job.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

You Were Not Their Savior

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook 7.4 (Work Page 17) | Vol. II Ch. 38, 39

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALLook around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.**"He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."*

PSALM 147:3 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

If you lost someone to addiction, you may carry the idea that you should have saved them. You may also carry it about your mother. You were not their savior. You were a child, then a sister, then a daughter, then a friend. You lost them because addiction is lethal, because they were sick, and because the world they were in was built to fail people like them. None of those were yours to control. This page is for Brandi, and for the mother you could not save. Grief is allowed here.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What did I do for them?

2. What do I keep telling myself I should have done?

3. Was it truly in my power at that age and in that condition?

SOFT ACTION

Write one thing you did that was love. Let that be enough for today.

SUPPLICATION

God, I loved them and I was never their God. Hold them, and hold me. Amen.

I loved them. I was never their God. That was never my job.☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 7.4 (Work Page 17) | Vol. II Ch. 38, 39

If you lost someone, tell her: "You were their sister, daughter, friend. You were not their savior." Write one thing she did that was love.

God, I loved them, and I was never their God.

I loved them. I was never their God.

□ Look at a photo of someone you lost and say one thing you love about them.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Who Was Responsible

"The LORD is a stronghold for the oppressed."

PSALM 9:9 · ESV

List it out: her choices, the people who hurt her, the ones who sold to her, the systems that turned her away, the disease itself, the patterns she was born into, and your choices. Count how many lines have your name on them. Now count how many do not.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What I keep telling myself I should have done — and was it in my power, at the age and condition I was in?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I judge my past self with resources she did not have. I stop.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Who Was Responsible

MOTHER WOUND · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 39 | Workbook 7.4**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.**"The LORD is a stronghold for the oppressed, a stronghold in times of trouble."*

PSALM 9:9 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

List what actually contributed: their choices, the people who hurt them, the ones who sold to them, the systems that turned them away, the disease itself, the patterns they were born into, and your own choices. Then count how many lines have your name on them, and how many do not. The point is not to avoid responsibility. It is to put it where it belongs, so grief can be grief and not an endless trial.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who or what was responsible for each part?

2. Which lines have my name, truthfully?

3. What age and condition was I in then?

SOFT ACTION

Fill in a list of responsible parties. Stop when it is done.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, You are a stronghold for the oppressed. Help me put the weight where it belongs. Amen.

I judge my past self with resources she did not have. I stop.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 39 | Workbook 7.4

Write who and what contributed to the loss: their choices, the people who hurt them, the systems, the disease, your choices. Count how many lines have her name. Tell her the weight is being redistributed.

Lord, put the weight where it belongs.

I judge my past self with the resources she had.

□ Set down something heavy you have been carrying today.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Where She Is

"Today you will be with me in paradise."

LUKE 23:43 · ESV

I am not God and I will not pretend. But addiction is not the unforgivable sin, God judges the heart and not the manner of death, and Romans 8 lists death first among the things that cannot separate us from His love. A cry does not have to be eloquent — the thief got one sentence in mid-execution.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Can I hope, legitimately, without lying to myself?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am putting her in the hands of someone kinder than the people who scared me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Hope Without Certainty

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 40 | Workbook 7.4

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Sit with your back against something solid. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"If I ascend to heaven, you are there! If I make my bed in Sheol, you are there!"

PSALM 139:8 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

I am not God, and I will not pretend to know where she is. But addiction is not the unforgivable sin, God judges the heart and not the manner of death (1 Samuel 16:7), and Romans 8:38-39 lists death first among the things that cannot separate us from His love. A cry does not have to be eloquent: the thief on the cross got one sentence (Luke 23:42-43). You can hope, legitimately, without lying to yourself. Hope is not certainty, and you do not need certainty to stop tormenting yourself.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Can I hope without needing to know?

2. What does it feel like to place them in God's hands?

3. What would help me leave them there?

SOFT ACTION

Say aloud, "I do not know, and I hope." Sit with it.

SUPPLICATION

God, You are there, even in Sheol. I put them in Your hands. I do not know everything, and I hope. Amen.

I am putting them in the hands of someone kinder than the people who scared me.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 40 | Workbook 7.4

Say to her: "I do not know, and I hope." Remember that God judges the heart, and that no one is beyond His love (Romans 8:38-39). Put the one you lost into His hands, and leave them there.

God, You are there, even in Sheol. I put them in
Your hands.

I do not know, and I hope.

- Look at the sky for one minute.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Not a Debt

"You did not receive the spirit of slavery to fall back into fear."

ROMANS 8:15 · ESV

Her death did not buy your life and there was no exchange. If you build this whole movement as restitution for being the one who lived, you will never be able to stop and it will never be enough, because guilt does not close accounts. Build it because it is right and because you love her. Not as bail.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Am I building out of love or out of guilt? How can I tell?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Her name goes on the work as a dedication, not a debt.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Not a Debt

ADDICTION · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 40, 41 | Workbook 7.4

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Take a slow sip of water. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"For you did not receive the spirit of slavery to fall back into fear, but you have received the Spirit of adoption as sons, by whom we cry, 'Abba! Father!'"

ROMANS 8:15 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Their death, or their harm, did not buy your life, and there was no exchange. If you build your recovery or your work as restitution for being the one who lived, you will never be able to stop, and it will never be enough, because guilt does not close accounts. Build it because it is right, and because you love them. Their name goes on it as a dedication, not a debt. A survivor does not owe her life as payment.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Am I building out of love or out of guilt?

2. How can I tell the difference?

3. What would change if it were a dedication, not a debt?

SOFT ACTION

Write the sentence, "My life is not a payment." Say it aloud once.

SUPPLICATION

Father, I did not receive a spirit of slavery. Free me from owing. Let me carry their name in love. Amen.

Their name goes on the work as a dedication, not a debt.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 40, 41 | Workbook 7.4

Write: "My life is not a payment." Tell her she does not owe anything because she lived. Their name goes on your work as a dedication, not a debt.

Father, free me from owing. Let me carry their name in love.

My life is not a payment.

- Do something joyful in their honor.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Letter

"Jesus wept."

JOHN 11:35 · ESV

Write her everything. The love, the rage, the why did you not call me, the I am sorry, the last conversation you wish you had, and the thing you have never told anyone about the last time you saw her. Then write the indictment you have been running against yourself, and — if you can do it safely — burn it outside and watch it go.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What I have never said to her:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not letting her go. I am putting her down in better hands.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Letter: To Her, To Him, To Brandi

MOTHER WOUND · CHILDHOOD

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Vol. II Ch. 42 | Workbook 7.4

SANCTUARY · OPTIONALFeel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.**"Jesus wept."*

JOHN 11:35 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Jesus wept at a grave He was about to open. Grief is not weak faith. Write a letter to the one you need to write to: your mother, your father, or Brandi. Everything: the love, the rage, the why did you not protect me, the I am sorry, what you never said. You will not send it. Then write the indictment you have been running against yourself, and, if you can do it safely, burn it outside and watch it go.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What I have never said to her:

2. What I have never said to him:

3. What case have I been prosecuting against myself?

SOFT ACTION

Write the letter. Then, if you wish and it is safe, burn the second page.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You wept. Weep with me. Let me say it all, and let it go. Amen.

I am not letting them go. I am putting them down in better hands.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 42 | Workbook 7.4

Write them a letter with everything: love, rage, sorry, what you never said. Then write the case you have been running against yourself, with each count answered. If you can do it safely, burn the second page outside.

Jesus, You wept. Weep with me.

*I am not letting them go. I am putting
them down in better hands.*

□ After writing, wash your face and drink water.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Grief Is Not a Relapse

"Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted."

MATTHEW 5:4 · ESV

Grief that is not given a place will take one — usually as rage or shutdown. Know your dates and plan for them instead of getting ambushed. Have one person for those days. And stop calling it a setback when it is love with nowhere to put itself.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

My dates, and who I am calling on them:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am allowed to grieve, and I am allowed to have a good day.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Grief Is Not a Relapse

ADDICTION · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Step 30 | Workbook 7.4**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.**"Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted."*

MATTHEW 5:4 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Grief that is not given a place will take one, usually as rage, shutdown, or a craving. Know your dates: birthdays, anniversaries, the day you got the call. Plan for them instead of being ambushed. Have one person to call on those days. And stop calling it a setback when it is love with nowhere to put itself. You may grieve more than a death: the childhood you did not get and the mother you needed.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What are my hard dates?

2. Who will I call?

3. What gentle ritual could I make for what I am grieving?

SOFT ACTION

Put the next hard date on your calendar with a name and a plan.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, comfort me as You promised. Let me grieve without breaking. Amen.

I am allowed to grieve, and I am allowed to have a good day.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Step 30 | Workbook 7.4

Write your hard dates on a calendar with a plan and a person for each. Tell her: "Missing them is love with nowhere to put itself."

Lord, comfort me as You promised.

I am allowed to grieve, and I am allowed to have a good day.

□ Have one good, light moment today and do not feel guilty for it.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Letting the Living Go

"He withdrew to desolate places and prayed."

LUKE 5:16 · ESV

Four kinds: release to God with them still in your life, boundary, distance, or full cut off. You are not obligated to give unlimited access to someone actively harming you, and no Scripture requires it. Turn the other cheek was about personal insult, not standing in a house fire.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Person, cost, and which of the four:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Loving someone does not require me to die with them.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Letting the Living Go: If Your Mother Is Still Here

MOTHER WOUND · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 7.2 | Vol. II Ch. 37

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Name three things you can see and one thing you can hear. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

"But he would withdraw to desolate places and pray."

LUKE 5:16 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

There are four kinds of letting go: release to God with them still in your life, boundary, distance, and no contact. You are not obligated to give unlimited access to someone who is actively harming you, and no Scripture requires it. If your mother is living, decide which kind fits now and what would change it. If she is gone, you may still be letting go of the mother you needed and the apology you may never hear. You can love someone and not be their savior.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Which of the four fits my relationship with my mother now?

2. What would have to change for that to change?

3. What am I grieving that has no funeral?

SOFT ACTION

Write which kind you are choosing, the cost, and the next step.

SUPPLICATION

Father, You see her. Go where I cannot go. Help me love without losing myself. Amen.

Loving someone does not require me to die with them.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 7.2 | Vol. II Ch. 37

Ask her about someone living she needs to release or hold at a distance. Choose one: release to God, boundary, distance, or no contact. Write the next step. You can love someone and not be their savior.

Father, You see them. Go where I cannot go.

*Loving someone does not require me to die
with them.*

- Write one boundary or release sentence and say it aloud.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Release

"Cast your burden on the LORD, and he will sustain you."

PSALM 55:22 · ESV

Out loud: I release ___ into the hands of God. I am not their savior, judge, jailer, or payment. What was good, I keep. What was mine, I take back. What was theirs, I return. I forgive them, and I am not available for more harm. Then replace the space on purpose, because holes get filled by whatever is nearest.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Who I am releasing, and what I am putting in the space:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Out of my hands, into His. His are better than mine ever were.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Release

WARFARE · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 7.5 (Work Page 18) | Vol. II Step 30**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Put a hand on your chest and let one long breath out. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.**"Cast your burden on the LORD, and he will sustain you; he will never permit the righteous to be moved."*

PSALM 55:22 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Say it: I release ___ into the hands of God. I am not their savior, judge, jailer, or payment. What was good, I keep. What was mine, I take back. What was theirs, I return. I forgive them, and I am not available for more harm. Then replace the space on purpose, because holes get filled by whatever is nearest. Put something good in it: a person, a practice, a purpose.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Who am I releasing?

2. What am I keeping, and what am I returning?

3. What will I put in the space?

SOFT ACTION

Write the release by name, and read it aloud. Then do one small good thing in the space.

SUPPLICATION

God, I release them into Your hands. Sustain me. Amen.

Out of my hands, into His. His are better than mine ever were.☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Say Goodbye and Hello

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 7.5 (Work Page 18) | Vol. II Step 30

RETURN TO HER

Do a small ritual: write one thing you are saying goodbye to, and one you are saying hello to, on two slips of paper. Put the first in a box and the second where you will see it. Say: "Out of my hands, into His."

ANCHOR: PSALM 55:22

PRAYER

God, I release them. Sustain me.

AFFIRMATION

Out of my hands, into His.

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

- Replace what you released with something good in the space it left.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

ARC 9 · DAYS 85-90

Becoming Her

The Journal: Becoming Her. Standing: Stewarding what you have learned. Coming Home: Meet the New You.

THE HOLY R3UP · 6 DAYS · 24 PAGES

Consecrated Before Formed

"Before I formed you in the womb I knew you... I consecrated you."

JEREMIAH 1:5 · ESV

God knew you before you were formed, which means what was done to you never canceled what He had in mind for you. (The verse was spoken to Jeremiah about his own call; read it as a window into how God knows His people, not a promise of a particular assignment.) I cannot tell you the harm was aimed at your calling — I do not know that. But the place that hurt most is often the place you understand best, and that can become a place you help from.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What hurt earliest, and what did it try hardest to take?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

God's knowing came first. The harm does not get the final word.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Known Before You Were Formed

CHILDHOOD · MOTHER WOUND

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · Go deeper Workbook 3.1 | Vol. II Ch. 28

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Look around until your eyes find the exit. You can leave if you need to. *Lord, You were here before I said anything.*

"For you formed my inward parts; you knitted me together in my mother's womb. I praise you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Wonderful are your works; my soul knows it very well."

PSALM 139:13-14 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

God knew you before you were formed, and what was done to you never canceled what He had in mind for you. Scripture says He knitted you together in your mother's womb. Your mother's womb was not the whole story, and she was not the one who made you; He was. I cannot tell you the harm was aimed at your calling. I do not know that. But the place that hurt most is often the place you understand best, and that can become a place you help from.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What was hurt earliest, and what did it try to take?

2. What do I see when I picture myself as known and wanted by God?

3. What does it change?

SOFT ACTION

Look at a photo of yourself as a child. Say, "Known and wanted by God."

SUPPLICATION

Father, You knitted me together. Let that be the final word over me. Amen.

God's knowing came first. The harm does not get the final word.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 3.1 | Vol. II Ch. 28

Look at her photo or drawing. Say: "Known and wanted by God before anyone hurt you." Write one sentence of how God sees her. The harm does not get the final word.

Father, You knitted her together. Let that be the final word.

God's knowing came first. The harm does not get the final word.

- Look at yourself in the mirror for ten seconds with kindness.

Too much today? Open your eyes, name five things you see, and stop. Stopping is part of the practice.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Wound Is the Shape

"You meant evil against me, but God meant it for good."

GENESIS 50:20 · ESV

Joseph was starved of family and put in charge of feeding families. Moses was pulled out of the water and sent to pull a nation out. Paul was the persecutor and became the apostle of grace. Often the fruit comes in the shape of the wound — not always, not automatically, and never as a reason to call the wound good. Look at yours and read it as a map, not a verdict.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

I am the one who _____ for the people who _____.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

My wound does not have to stay a wound. It can become a door.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Wound as a Door

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 3.5 | Vol. II Ch. 33

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Press your palms together, then let go. *Jesus, I do not have to perform for You.*

"Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies and God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our affliction, so that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction, with the comfort with which we ourselves are comforted by God."

2 CORINTHIANS 1:3-4 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Joseph was starved of family and put in charge of feeding families. Moses was drawn out of the water and sent to draw a nation out. Often, the fruit comes in the shape of the wound. Not always, not automatically, and never as a reason to call the wound good. Look at yours as a map, not a verdict. The so that is the whole point: you were not comforted to feel better only. You were comforted so you would know the road for someone else.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. Where do my wound and my compassion overlap?

2. Who might need exactly what I know?

3. What is one small way I could offer it?

SOFT ACTION

Complete the sentence: "I am the one who ___ for the people who ___."

SUPPLICATION

God of all comfort, comfort me, and let me comfort someone else with what You gave me. Amen.

My wound does not have to stay a wound. It can become a door.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 3.5 | Vol. II Ch. 33

Write: "I am the one who ___ for the people who ___." Ask her what she would like to help someone else with one day. Do not rush it.

God of all comfort, comfort me, and let me comfort someone else.

My wound does not have to stay a wound.

- Offer one kind word to someone who is hurting.

If this stirs up more than you can hold, do your landing (warm drink, a walk, a text) and come back tomorrow.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Chosen Means Sent

"You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you that you should go."

JOHN 15:16 · ESV

Chosen is not a rank, it is an assignment with a destination. Many of the people in Scripture were marked early, isolated, delayed, misunderstood, broken in one specific place, then used. The cost is real: lost people, delay that looks like denial, being called crazy by good people, and carrying it without credit.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What has this already cost me, and what am I still unwilling to pay?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Chosen does not mean liked more. It means sent.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Sent, Not Special

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 3.1–3.4 | Vol. II Ch. 28, 29**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Sit with your back against something solid. *Father, meet me exactly where I am.*

"You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you that you should go and bear fruit and that your fruit should abide, so that whatever you ask the Father in my name, he may give it to you."

JOHN 15:16 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Chosen is not a rank. It is an assignment with a destination. Scripture uses the language of being chosen of every believer, not only the dramatic ones. Many people in Scripture were marked early, isolated, delayed, misunderstood, and broken in a specific place before they were used. The cost is real: lost people, delay that looks like denial, being misunderstood by good people. It does not mean God likes you more. Your assignment may start with simply being the one who stays in recovery.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What has this already cost me?

2. What am I still unwilling to pay?

3. What is the assignment right in front of me?

SOFT ACTION

Name the assignment closest to you today. Do one small thing for it.

SUPPLICATION

Jesus, You chose me and sent me. Keep me humble and faithful. Amen.

Chosen does not mean liked more. It means sent.☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 3.1–3.4 | Vol. II Ch. 28, 29

Imagine the future woman walking toward the doorway: how she stands, what she wears, what is in her eyes. Describe her in five lines. Ask her: "What do you want to tell the girl at the door?" Write what you hear.

Jesus, let me see who I am becoming, and let it be good.

She is becoming someone safe, and I get to walk with her.

□ Dress today like the woman you are becoming.

You can do the prayer and skip the step. That still counts.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Two Futures

"Choose life, that you and your offspring may live."

DEUTERONOMY 30:19 · ESV

One possible future is the woman who knew exactly what she was for, could describe it in detail, told people about it — and never started, while the pattern passed on. Another is the same woman, with the agreements she made in pain released, the pattern interrupted, five people who truly know her, and somebody helped because of what she built. Neither is guaranteed. Choices are what you have, and you get to make a small one today.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

If this exact week repeats 260 times, what is my life in five years? Who else pays?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am going to do it — scared and imperfect and on a date.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Two Roads: Carrying It On, or Ending It Here

CYCLE-BREAKING · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 43–45 | Workbook 3.5

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Take a slow sip of water. *Holy Spirit, stay near, and do not let me go further than I can hold.*

"I call heaven and earth to witness against you today, that I have set before you life and death, blessing and curse. Therefore choose life, that you and your offspring may live,"

DEUTERONOMY 30:19 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

One possible future is the woman who knew what she was for, told people about it, and never—started, while the pattern ran on. Another is the same woman, with the agreements she made in pain released, the pattern interrupted, five people who truly know her, and someone helped _____ because of what she lived. Neither is guaranteed. Choices are what you have, and you get to make a small one today. If this page pulls you down, close it and call someone.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. If this week repeats 260 times, where am I in five years?

2. Who else is affected by my choices?

3. What is the one small step I can take today?

SOFT ACTION

Take the small step you wrote. Then tell one person.

SUPPLICATION

God, I choose life, for me and for those who come after me. Start small with me today. Amen.

I am going to do it, scared and imperfect and on a date.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Vol. II Ch. 43–45 | Workbook 3.5

Write a letter from the future woman to the girl: "I am here now. I am safe. I will not leave you. Here is what I promise." Sign it. Then write a short reply from her.

Father, let them know each other.

I am choosing life, for both of us.

□ Read your letter aloud to a mirror, or to a friend you trust.

If you feel far away or numb, press your feet into the floor and look around the room for the exit and the date.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Steward, Not Survivor

"Who comforts us in all our affliction, so that we may comfort others."

2 CORINTHIANS 1:4 · ESV

Victim: this happened to me. Survivor: and I am still here. Steward: and now it belongs to God and it is for somebody else. The 'so that' is the whole point — you were not comforted so you would feel better. You were comforted so you would know the road.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

One thing I can steward this week — not someday, this week:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I know the road because I was on it. That is the qualification.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Steward, Not Survivor: What You Pass On Without Children

CYCLE-BREAKING · WARFARE

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 3.5 | Vol. II Step 32**SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL**Feel your feet on the floor. Keep your eyes open. *God, I am here. You are here. That is enough to start.*

“I am reminded of your sincere faith, a faith that dwelt first in your grandmother Lois and your mother Eunice and now, I am sure, dwells in you as well.”

2 TIMOTHY 1:5 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Victim: this happened to me. Survivor: and I am still here. Steward: and now it belongs to God and it is for somebody else. You do not need children to pass something on. You pass it on to the people who watch how you live: friends, nieces, nephews, coworkers, people in a meeting, people you mentor. Paul remembered a line of faith that passed through women, a grandmother and a mother. You can start a line of faith and honesty, whether or not you ever raise a child. What you pass on is how you live.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

Date: ___/___/___

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What have I learned that is worth passing on?

2. Who is watching how I live?

3. What does passing it on look like in an ordinary week?

SOFT ACTION

Share one honest, hopeful truth with someone who is watching you this week.

SUPPLICATION

Lord, make me a steward of what You have taught me. Let what I pass on be good. Amen.

I know the road because I was on it. That is the qualification.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook 3.5 | Vol. II Step 32

Walk her in imagination from the doorway into your present room, up to the safe place you built on Day 1. Give her a seat. Then give her something real: a stuffed animal, a plant, a stone, a place at the table. Tell her: "You live here now, with me."

Lord, bring her home, and keep us together.

She is home, and I am home.

□ Set a place at your table or put a chair near yours for her.

Swap the step for something small and kind: water, a snack, a stretch. That is practice too.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

The Commission

"They have conquered him by the blood of the Lamb and by the word of their testimony."

REV. 12:11 · ESV

Ninety days ago you started this with a list you were afraid to write. Read the whole page out loud, standing up, and sign it. Then set the next date and run it again, because you can only see the next layer from ground you have already taken.

TODAY'S WORK

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

What is different about me than on day one? And what is next?

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am the woman God chose. Not someday. Today. The line stops here.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

The Commission

WARFARE · CYCLE-BREAKING · ADDICTION

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Closing | Vol. II Ch. 51

SANCTUARY · OPTIONAL

Hold something warm or cold in your hands for a minute. *Jesus, You are bigger than what I am about to read.*

*“...Do not be afraid of them. Remember the Lord, who is great and awesome, and fight for your brothers,
your sons, your daughters, your wives, and your homes.”*

NEHEMIAH 4:14 · ESV

WHAT THIS MEANS

Nehemiah rebuilt a wall with one hand on the work and the other on the weapon. That is the picture: build and stand at the same time. Revelation 12:11 says they conquered by the blood of the Lamb and the word of their testimony, and your testimony is whatever is true, told at your own pace to safe people. Read the whole page aloud, standing. Then set the next date and run it again, because you can only see the next layer from ground you already took. You are not finished. You are on your way, and you are not carrying it on.

WHAT STOOD OUT TO ME

SACRED REFLECTION

1. What is different about me than on Day 1?

2. What is the next layer I can see now?

3. Who will walk with me into it?

SOFT ACTION

Sign it, date it, and tell one person. Then pick your next date.

SUPPLICATION

Father, thank You for ninety days of honesty. Keep me standing, keep me building, and keep me Yours. In Jesus' name. Amen.

I am the woman God chose to stand and to build. Not someday. Today. The line stops here.

☐ I said it. I wrote it. That is enough for today.

Same day, other pages: Journal · Standing · Coming Home · **Go deeper** Workbook Closing | Vol. II Ch. 51

Sit with three pieces of paper: the letter from her (write it if you have not), the letter from the new you (Day 88), and a promise you sign today. Read them aloud. Say: "Welcome home. We are a team. We are not finished, and we are not alone." Date and sign the last page. Celebrate.

Father, thank You for ninety days. Keep us standing, keep us building, and keep us Yours.

*I am the woman God chose to stand and
build, and she is with me.*

Do something joyful and celebratory today. Tell someone you finished.

If nothing comes, nothing is required. Rest is allowed.

WHAT SHE SAID · WHAT I NOTICED

Begin Again

The next layer is only visible from ground you already took.

Go back to day one and read what you wrote. Not to grade yourself. To see it. The woman who wrote day one did not know whether she could finish this. She finished it.

Then set the next date and run it again. You will get different answers, because you are standing somewhere different now. That is not repetition. That is depth.

The line stops here.

And somebody may get out because you did.

SIGN IT

Signed: _____ Date: ____ / ____ / ____

THE HOLY R3UP · THE JOURNAL · WRITE THE TRUTH

The Challenge Jar

Cut along the dashed lines, fold each card, and keep them in a jar or envelope. Draw one at random any time — when a day feels flat, when it feels too heavy, or when you finish early. Use as many or as few as you like.

CHALLENGE

Text someone a photo of something beautiful you see today.

CHALLENGE

Drink a full glass of water before anything else.

CHALLENGE

Walk around the block and count how many different trees or flowers you see.

CHALLENGE

Listen to a song you loved as a kid, all the way through.

CHALLENGE

Write three things you can smell, taste, or feel right now.

CHALLENGE

Tidy one drawer for five minutes.

CHALLENGE

Sincerely compliment someone.

CHALLENGE

Take a slow bath or shower and thank your body.

CHALLENGE

Call someone you have not talked to in a month.

CHALLENGE

Stand in sunlight for five minutes.

CHALLENGE

Make your bed with care.

CHALLENGE

Give away one thing you no longer need.

CHALLENGE

Eat something colorful.

CHALLENGE

Write a thank-you note to someone who helped you.

CHALLENGE

Turn off screens an hour before bed.

CHALLENGE

Pray the Lord's Prayer slowly, one line at a time.

CHALLENGE

Do ten slow stretches.

CHALLENGE

Doodle for ten minutes with no goal.

CHALLENGE

Sing one worship song out loud, even badly.

CHALLENGE

Read one psalm aloud.

CHALLENGE

Smile at yourself in the mirror and say your new name.

CHALLENGE

Write one thing you did well today.

CHALLENGE

Water or care for something living.

CHALLENGE

Make something with your hands.

CHALLENGE

Sit outside for ten minutes and just notice.

CHALLENGE

Wear your favorite color today.

CHALLENGE

Ask someone how they are, and really listen.

CHALLENGE

Say no to one thing you do not have to do.

CHALLENGE

List ten things you are grateful for.

CHALLENGE

Dance silly for one song.

PRAYER

Lord, I am here. Be here too.

PRAYER

Jesus, hold her hand and mine.

PRAYER

Father, thank You for getting me through today.

PRAYER

God, I do not have words. You know them.

PRAYER

Holy Spirit, quiet what is loud in me.

PRAYER

Lord, show me one thing I can do next.

PRAYER

Jesus, stay near while I do the hard part.

PRAYER

Father, give me rest tonight.

PRAYER

God, protect the ones I love.

PRAYER

Lord, teach me to be gentle with myself.

PRAYER

Jesus, be the shelter I run to.

PRAYER

Father, give me courage for one small step.

PRAYER

God, I give You what I cannot fix.

PRAYER

Lord, turn my eyes to what is true.

PRAYER

Jesus, thank You for not giving up on me.

PRAYER

Father, put safe people around me.

PRAYER

God, help me forgive in my time.

PRAYER

Lord, meet me in the quiet.

PRAYER

Jesus, heal what I cannot reach.

PRAYER

Father, I belong to You. Amen.

AFFIRMATION

I am not too much and I am not too late.

AFFIRMATION

She was a child, and it was not her fault.

AFFIRMATION

I am allowed to rest.

AFFIRMATION

I can learn slowly and still be growing.

AFFIRMATION

God has not given up on me.

AFFIRMATION

I can be kind to myself today.

AFFIRMATION

I do not have to earn love.

AFFIRMATION

My story is not finished.

AFFIRMATION

I am safer than I used to be.

AFFIRMATION

I can ask for help.

AFFIRMATION

My feelings are information, not a verdict.

AFFIRMATION

I am allowed to have boundaries.

AFFIRMATION

I am more than my worst day.

AFFIRMATION

What I survived does not define my worth.

AFFIRMATION

I can start again as many times as I need.

AFFIRMATION

I am known and loved by God.

AFFIRMATION

I can tell the truth and still be held.

AFFIRMATION

My body kept me alive, and I can thank it.

AFFIRMATION

I can be gentle and strong.

AFFIRMATION

I am coming home.

TASK

Put 988 and your safe person's number in your phone favorites.

TASK

Write your safe-place details on a card and keep it with you.

TASK

Schedule one appointment or call you have been avoiding.

TASK

Clear one surface in your home for five minutes.

TASK

Restock your landing kit.

TASK

Reread one day of your journal.

TASK

Pack a small bag: water, a snack, and a note to yourself.

TASK

List your three safest people.

TASK

Write your date and plan on a sticky note.

TASK

Delete one app or contact that keeps you stuck.

TASK

Lay out tomorrow's clothes tonight.

TASK

Save your boundary sentence in your phone notes.

TASK

Make a simple three-day meal plan.

TASK

Move your bedtime fifteen minutes earlier.

TASK

Write one question for your counselor.

TASK

Wash dishes or fold laundry as a prayer.

TASK

Clean out one stress spot (a bag, a car, a purse).

TASK

Write down your three early-warning signs.

TASK

Look up one local support group or class.

TASK

Take a photo of one thing that makes you feel safe.

A Letter From Her

A Letter From the New Me

Write as the woman you are becoming: "I am here now. I am safe. I will not leave you. Here is what I promise."
Be specific and kind.

Our Promise

Read both letters aloud, then write one promise you can keep, small enough to do on a bad day.

Signed: _____ Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Witnessed by: _____

*Welcome home. We are a team. We are not finished, and we are
not alone.*

LOOKING BACK

Final Reflection

Take your time. Answer in pencil if that feels safer. You are not grading yourself — you are noticing.

WHAT IS ONE THING I TOLD THE TRUTH ABOUT THAT I HAD BEEN AVOIDING?

WHERE DID I FEEL THE MOST RESISTANCE, AND WHAT MIGHT THAT BE PROTECTING?

WHAT IS ONE THING THAT IS DIFFERENT — EVEN SLIGHTLY — FROM WHEN I STARTED?

WHAT DO I STILL NEED HELP WITH, AND WHO COULD I ASK?

PROGRESS REVIEW

Where I Am Now

Fill this in honestly. “Still hard” is an allowed answer. Finishing is not the same as being finished.

Arc	What I finished or practiced	What shifted	What still needs care
Arc 1 · Telling the Truth			
Arc 2 · The Lies and the Names			
Arc 3 · The Realm and Your Authority			
Arc 4 · The Contracts			
Arc 5 · The Bloodline			
Arc 6 · The Playbook and the Structure			
Arc 7 · God			
Arc 8 · Brandi and Letting Go			
Arc 9 · Becoming Her			

YOUR NEXT STEP

Next-Step Challenge

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Go back to Day 1 and read what you wrote — not to grade yourself, to see it. Then choose one practice (the armor, the craving protocol, the silence, the release) and keep it for the next thirty days. Tell one person which one.

MY ONE NEXT STEP

WHO WILL KNOW ABOUT IT, AND BY WHEN?

WHAT WILL I DO IF I MISS A DAY?

Pick the page back up. Missing a day is not failure — the identity is in the rising.

Closing Prayer

PRAYER

Father, thank You for walking with me through these pages. I did not do this perfectly, and You never asked me to. Where I told the truth, thank You for staying. Where I skipped, meet me there with patience. Where I found grief, hold me in it. Where I found anger, let me bring it to You instead of away from You. Give me safe people, good help, and a next step small enough to take. Keep me honest without letting me shame myself. Teach me to tend what You have given me — slowly, the way a vineyard is tended. I belong to You, and I am still building. In Jesus' name. Amen.

THE HOLY R3UP

Certificate of Completion

This certifies that

Participant's name

has completed

The 90-Day Rebuild

with honesty, courage, and grace for the days that were hard. Brokenness is not the destination. Keep going — one next step at a time.

Signature

Date

You survived. Now we rebuild.

THE HOLY R3UP & CO.

KEEP THIS PAGE

Help, Right Now

If you are in danger right now, or the thought of dying has teeth in it today, stop reading and call. That is not failure. That is the correct use of this page.

Need	Contact
988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline	Call or text 988 · free, 24/7, confidential
Crisis Text Line	Text HOME to 741741
SAMHSA National Helpline (substance use, treatment referrals)	1-800-662-4357 · free, 24/7, confidential
National Domestic Violence Hotline	1-800-799-7233, or text START to 88788
RAINN (sexual assault)	1-800-656-4673
National Human Trafficking Hotline	1-888-373-7888, or text 233733
Veterans Crisis Line	Dial 988, then press 1

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Narcan (naloxone)** is available without an individual prescription at most pharmacies, and free through many health departments and harm-reduction programs. Keep it in the house even if you do not use. It can reverse an opioid overdose and will not hurt someone who did not take opioids.
- **Withdrawal from alcohol, benzodiazepines, and barbiturates can kill you.** Do not detox from those alone. That is a medical detox, not a willpower problem. Call SAMHSA or go to an emergency room.
- Numbers and services change. Confirm them before you rely on them.

MY PEOPLE

Role	Name	Number
Knows everything		
Further ahead		
Behind me		
Just a friend		
Can correct me		

Reaching back. Freeing the bound.

THE HOLY R3UP & CO.

REFERENCE ONE

Trauma and the Spiritual Realm

The Workbook, whole. Come here when a day says Go deeper.

THE HOLY R3UP

This is for the person who knows something is wrong and doesn't know where to go.

This is for the one who got called "chosen" and found out it came with a price tag nobody warned them about.

This is for the one who is still breathing after what should have killed them.

You are not crazy. You are not cursed beyond reach. You are not too far in.

Turn the page.

How to Use This Workbook

This is not a devotional. This is not a feel-good study. This is a **work** book. There are blank lines because you are supposed to write in them. If you read it without writing, nothing changes.

Seven Parts:

Part	What it does
I	Trauma — what actually happened to your body, mind, and spirit
II	The Spiritual Realm — the crash course nobody gave you
III	The Chosen One — deep dive on the calling and its cost
IV	Survivor of Addiction and Abuse — naming it out loud
V	Roadmap: Breaking Addiction — step by step
VI	Roadmap: Breaking Generational Curses — step by step
VII	Roadmap: Letting People Go, and Sitting Silent With God

Rules of engagement:

1. Do it in order the first time. After that, go where the bleeding is.
2. Write by hand if you can. The hand knows things the mouth won't say.
3. Do not do this workbook at 2 a.m. alone your first time through. Pick daylight. Pick a day you have somewhere to go afterward.
4. If a page cracks you open and you can't close it, stop. Call someone. Come back tomorrow. The page will wait.

Before you start — the honest safety page:

- If you are in danger from another person right now, this workbook is not the first step. Getting safe is. **National Domestic Violence Hotline: 1-800-799-7233** (or text START to 88788).
- If you are thinking about ending your life: **call or text 988** (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, US). Do it before you do this workbook.
- If you are physically dependent on alcohol, benzodiazepines (Xanax, Klonopin, Ativan), or barbiturates, **do not quit cold on your own**. Withdrawal from those can kill you — seizures, delirium. That is not weakness, that is chemistry. You need a medical detox. **SAMHSA Helpline: 1-800-662-4357**, free, 24/7, confidential.
- Spiritual work and medical care are not enemies. God made doctors too. Deliverance does not cancel dosage. Do both.

PART I

Trauma: What Actually Happened to You

1.1 The definition they never gave you

Trauma is not the event. Trauma is what the event **left inside you** when your nervous system could not finish the response it needed to finish.

Say it plainer: something happened that was too much, too fast, too soon, or for too long, and you had no way out and nobody to run to. So your body did the only thing it could — it froze the moment and carried it.

You are not still reacting to the past. You are reacting to the **unfinished present** the past left in your body.

1.2 The four responses — and why yours wasn't a choice

Response	What it looks like	What it protected
Fight	Rage, arguing, provoking, control, "I'll ruin it before it ruins me"	Your right to exist
Flight	Leaving, moving, cutting off, ghosting, staying too busy to feel	Your body's exit
Freeze	Going blank, dissociating, watching yourself from the ceiling	Your mind, when the body couldn't run
Fawn	People-pleasing, over-apologizing, becoming useful to whoever is dangerous	Your life, by making you not-worth-hurting

Most abuse survivors are fawners who got called "sweet." Most addiction survivors are flighters who got called "unreliable." Most children of chaos are freezers who got called "spacey."

They were not personality traits. They were survival strategies that kept working after the danger left.

WORK PAGE 1 — NAME YOUR DEFAULT

Which of the four is your default? _____

When did you first learn it? (Age, place, who was in the room.)

What did it save you from?

Where is it costing you now?

Say out loud: "This kept me alive. It is no longer the only thing I have. Thank you. You can rest now."

1.3 The kinds of trauma — check what's yours

Mark everything that applies. Nobody is grading you. Nobody sees this but you and God.

- ☐ **Acute** — one event. A wreck. An assault. A night.
- ☐ **Chronic** — the same thing over and over. Years of it.
- ☐ **Complex (C-PTSD)** — repeated harm inside a relationship you couldn't leave. Childhood. Marriage. Trafficking. A church.
- ☐ **Developmental** — it happened while you were still being built, so it's in the foundation, not the walls.
- ☐ **Betrayal trauma** — the harm came from the one who was supposed to protect you. This is the one that breaks the ability to trust itself.
- ☐ **Sexual trauma** — your body was taken from you and you still live in it.
- ☐ **Religious / spiritual abuse** — Scripture used as a weapon. God's name on a hand that hit you. "Submit." "Forgive." "Don't be divisive."
- ☐ **Grief trauma** — a death you never got to finish grieving because life didn't stop.

- ☐ **Traumatic loss by addiction or suicide** — the specific hell of losing someone to the same thing that almost took you.
- ☐ **Medical trauma** — being held down, not believed, not medicated, not heard.
- ☐ **Institutional trauma** — CPS, courts, jail, rehab, foster care, a system that processed you instead of helping you.
- ☐ **Moral injury** — what YOU did that you can't reconcile with who you wanted to be. This is the one nobody makes workbooks for. We will.
- ☐ **Vicarious** — what you absorbed carrying everybody else's.

WORK PAGE 2 — THE INVENTORY NOBODY ASKED YOU FOR

Write the list. Not the story yet — the **list**. One line each. No details. Just titles, like chapters.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

Now circle the one you skipped. Write it here:

That's the one. That's where the work is. We're coming back to it.

1.4 What trauma does to the body (simplified, so you stop thinking you're broken)

Your body is not malfunctioning. It is running an old program on a current threat setting.

- **Amygdala** — your smoke alarm. After trauma it's set to go off at toast. Hypervigilance, startle, "I can read a room in three seconds."
- **Hippocampus** — your filing clerk. Trauma disrupts it, so the memory never gets filed as **past**. That's why it feels like now. That's a flashback. It is not weakness and it is not demonic — it is a filing error with a body attached.
- **Prefrontal cortex** — your reasoning. It goes offline under threat. That's why you "know better" and still do it. Knowing lives upstairs; the alarm lives downstairs; downstairs wins.
- **Vagus nerve** — your brake pedal. Trauma wears the brake. That's the shutdown, the numbness, the sudden exhaustion.
- **Cortisol and adrenaline** — the fuel. Years of it is why your stomach, your immune system, your sleep, your cycle, your teeth, your back all went down at once.

Trauma leaves its mark on the body. Talking helps, and for many people it is not enough by itself. You cannot think your way out of a body-level wound. You have to bring the body.

BODY-BASED RESETS (USE THESE ALL THROUGH THE WORKBOOK)

Learn these NOW, before the hard pages.

- 1. The 4-7-8 breath (drops the alarm)** In through the nose 4 counts. Hold 7. Out through the mouth 8, long and loud. Four rounds. The long exhale is the part that works.
- 2. 5-4-3-2-1 (ends a flashback)** Out loud: 5 things you see, 4 you can touch, 3 you hear, 2 you smell, 1 you taste. Then say the date and your age. "It is [today's date]. I am [your age]. That was then."
- 3. Cold water on the wrists and face (hard reset)** Can slow the heart rate fast. Works for many people when other things do not. (If you have a heart condition, ask your doctor before using cold water on your face.)
- 4. Orienting (tells the body the room is safe)** Slowly turn your head and look at every corner of the room. Let your eyes land on the exit. Your body needs to SEE there's a door.
- 5. Push the wall** Palms flat on a wall, push hard for 10 seconds, release. Gives the fight response somewhere to go.
- 6. Name it to tame it** "I am having a trauma response. This is not danger. This is memory."

WORK PAGE 3 — YOUR BODY MAP

Where does it live in your body? Mark it.

- Throat / can't speak: _____
- Chest / tight, can't breathe: _____
- Stomach / dread, nausea: _____
- Shoulders, jaw, fists: _____
- Hips / pelvis: _____
- Legs / want to run: _____
- Nowhere — numb, can't feel it: _____

For the loudest spot, answer: **If it could talk, what would it say?**

How old does it sound? _____

That's who you're actually working with. Not a disorder. A kid.

1.5 Trauma's beliefs — the lies it installed

Trauma doesn't just hurt you. It **teaches** you. Check what got installed:

- ☐ It was my fault.
- ☐ I should have known.
- ☐ I'm too much.
- ☐ I'm not enough.
- ☐ If they knew the real me they'd leave.
- ☐ Love always costs.
- ☐ Safe is boring; chaos is home.
- ☐ I only matter when I'm useful.
- ☐ I can't trust myself.
- ☐ God let it happen, so God allowed it, so God is not safe.
- ☐ I'm the family's problem.
- ☐ If I stop moving, it catches me.
- ☐ I don't get to want things.

- ☐ I'm already ruined, so it doesn't matter what I do now.

WORK PAGE 4 — LIE / EVIDENCE / TRUTH

Take your top three. Fill this out honestly — do not give the Sunday School answer.

Lie #1: _____

Who taught it to me (name or situation): _____

Evidence I have used to keep believing it:

Evidence against it (make yourself find one thing):

Scripture or truth I am choosing to stand on instead:

What it would change if I actually believed the truth:

(Repeat for #2 and #3.)

Truth anchors for this section:

- Psalm 34:18 — "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted and saves the crushed in spirit."
- Psalm 56:8 — He keeps count of your tossings; He puts your tears in a bottle. Your crying was **recorded**, not ignored.
- Isaiah 61:1–3 — binding up the brokenhearted, beauty for ashes, oil of joy for mourning. The exchange is the whole point.
- Romans 8:1 — no condemnation. Not "less." **None.**

1.6 The part nobody will say out loud

Some of what happened to you was not your fault AND some of what you did afterward was. Both are true at once. Holding only the first makes you a permanent victim. Holding only the second makes you a person who can't stop punishing themselves.

You need both hands.

WORK PAGE 5 — THE TWO COLUMNS

What was DONE to me (not mine to carry)	What I DID (mine to own and be forgiven for)

Look at column one. Say: **"I set this down. It was never mine."**

Look at column two. Say: **"I own this. I am not condemned for it. I will make it right where I can."**

That's it. That's the whole difference between shame and repentance. Shame says *I am bad*.
Repentance says *I did bad, and I'm not staying there*.

PART II

The Spiritual Realm: The Crash Course

2.1 Start here: there are two realms and one is more real

The physical realm is what you can measure. The spiritual realm is what generates it.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"We look not to the things that are seen but to the things that are unseen. For the things that are seen are transient, but the things that are unseen are eternal." — 2 Corinthians 4:18

"For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the cosmic powers over this present darkness." — Ephesians 6:12

Paul is describing something real: **an opposing spiritual reality, with structure and strategy — and a limit.** Christians hold a range of views on the details, and Scripture gives us less of a map than we sometimes wish. What it gives us clearly is Jesus.

2.2 The three-way error most people make

Error	What it sounds like	Why it wrecks you
Everything is demonic	"The devil gave me depression."	You spend years binding a spirit that was a thyroid, a trauma loop, or a bad marriage. Nothing improves, so you conclude God failed.
Nothing is spiritual	"It's all just psychology."	You white-knuckle a war you can't see and lose ground you don't know you're standing on.
It's spiritual so I don't need help	"I just need more faith."	You die of something treatable while praying.

Our working position: it is often more than one thing at once, and you work on every part that is there.

A wound can be real trauma, and it can also be a place where lies and temptation find footing. A craving can be real neurochemistry, and it can also be a pull toward a false comfort. Treat the body. Tend the wound. Take the spiritual side to God. You do not have to decide which one it "really" is before you start getting help.

2.3 What's actually in the realm

God — not a force, a Person. Sovereign, present, the only one with unlimited authority. Not the author of what was done to you.

The Holy Spirit — God living *in* you if you're His. Your comfort, your conviction, your power, your discernment. Conviction feels like clean grief and points to a specific thing with a way out. Condemnation feels like drowning and points at your whole self with no exit. **Learn the difference. It will save you years.**

Jesus — the one who already won. Colossians 2:15: He disarmed the powers and made a public spectacle of them. This matters because it means you are not fighting for a victory — you are **enforcing** one.

Angels — messengers and warriors. Sent. Not summoned by you, not worshiped by you.

Satan — a created being. Fallen. Limited. A liar (John 8:44), a thief (John 10:10), an accuser (Revelation 12:10). **He is not omnipresent and he is not the opposite of God.** Scripture never says he can read minds; only God knows the heart (1 Kings 8:39).

The enemy's forces — Ephesians 6:12 names rulers, authorities, cosmic powers, and spiritual forces, and Colossians 2:15 says Christ disarmed them. Scripture says far less about how they work than people online pretend. You do not need a map of ranks. You need Jesus, honest people, and discernment — and you need to hold back from calling a hard experience demonic just because it is hard. A pattern that follows you from place to place, or runs through a whole family, is worth taking seriously, and worth bringing to a doctor, a counselor, and a trusted pastor together.

Your own flesh — Galatians 5. Not a demon. Your untrained appetite. **Most of what people try to cast out, they need to crucify.** You cannot rebuke a habit you keep feeding.

WORK PAGE 6 — SORTING YOUR OWN SITUATION

Take the thing tormenting you most. Answer:

What part of this is body / brain / chemistry? (Needs care, sleep, food, meds, doctor.)

What part is wound? (Needs healing, grief, truth, maybe a therapist.)

What part is flesh? (Needs discipline, boundaries, no.)

What part is spiritual? (Needs renouncing, authority, closing a door.)

Now you have four assignments instead of one impossible one. That's what discernment is for.

2.4 What keeps feeding the struggle

Some struggles keep getting fed by the same things. Naming them is not meant to shame you — it gives you something you can change. Christians disagree about how much of this is spiritual, so use what helps and hold the rest loosely.

Check honestly:

- ☐ **Unforgiveness / bitterness** (Matthew 18:34–35 — the jailer. Hebrews 12:15 — the root.) Very common in survivors, and very understandable.
- ☐ **Agreement with a lie** — "I'm worthless" is a lie you have been rehearsing, and it needs replacing with truth.
- ☐ **Occult contact** — tarot, mediums, Ouija, spells, santería, crystals for power, "harmless" psychics, astrology as authority, rituals you did as a kid for protection because nobody else was protecting you.
- ☐ **Sexual entanglements ("soul ties")** — 1 Corinthians 6:16 says sexual union joins two people. What was done to you against your will was a wrong done to you, not a sin of yours — and it can still leave a hold on your mind and body that is worth bringing to God and a counselor. ("Soul tie" is not a phrase in Scripture; it is a name many believers use for this experience.)
- ☐ **Family patterns** — sin and wounds running through generations (Exodus 20:5, Lamentations 5:7).
- ☐ **Vows and self-curses** — "I will never love anyone again." "I'll always be like my mother." "I hope I die." Those are promises you made in pain.
- ☐ **Substances** — altering the mind lowers your guard, and addiction can rule a life like an idol. (Galatians 5:20 lists sorcery — *pharmakeia* — next to idolatry; Scripture's concern is what rules you, not medicine taken under a doctor's care.)
- ☐ **Trauma itself** — a wound can leave you more exposed and more alone. That is not your fault, and it is something you are allowed to tend.
- ☐ **What you consume** — what you watch, hear, scroll, and replay at night is a diet, and it feeds something.
- ☐ **Things done or spoken over you by others** — dedications, harsh words from family, things you don't fully remember.

WORK PAGE 7 — THE PATTERN LIST

List everything you can identify. Next to it, write **"BROUGHT TO GOD"** once you've prayed through it in 2.6, or **"WORKING ON IT"** if you're not there yet.

Pattern	How it started	Status

2.5 Your actual authority — read this twice

You are not begging. You are not negotiating. You are not equal-and-opposite.

- **Luke 10:19** — "I have given you authority to tread on serpents and scorpions... and nothing shall hurt you."
- **Ephesians 2:6** — you are seated *with Him in the heavenly places*. Positional. Above, not below.
- **James 4:7** — submit to God, THEN resist the devil. **That order is not optional.** Resisting without submitting is how people get hurt.
- **1 John 4:4** — greater is He in you than he in the world.
- **Revelation 12:11** — they conquered by the blood of the Lamb and the word of their testimony. **Your story matters.** Telling the truth about what happened to you — to safe people, at your own pace — takes the power out of secrecy.

What authority is not: a volume contest. You don't need to scream. Jesus rebuked with a sentence. Loud is for your own fear, not for their ears.

2.6 Praying it through — renouncing, forgiving, and handing it to God

Before you pray this: these prayers are a faith practice, not a formula. Scripture invites us to confess, forgive, resist the devil, and pray out loud with others (James 4:7; 5:16), but it does not hand us a script, and nothing here replaces a doctor, a counselor, or a pastor who knows you. You are allowed to skip any step that

stirs up more than you can hold. Saying the words aloud helps many people mean them. Do it with one trustworthy believer present if you can. If you can't, you can still pray it alone.

Step 1 — Get under cover.

PRAYER

"Father, I come to You through Jesus Christ, who died for me and rose again. I am Yours. I submit myself to You — my body, my mind, my memory, my will, my future. I need You for this, not my own strength. Cover me in the blood of Jesus."

Step 2 — Confess what's yours.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I confess my part. Not what was done to me — my part. [Name it specifically. No lists of 'anything and everything.' Be specific. Specific is where power is.] I repent. I turn from it. I receive Your forgiveness, and I refuse to keep paying for what You already paid for."

Step 3 — Forgive, by name.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I choose to forgive [name]. Not because it was okay. It was not okay. Because I refuse to be their jailer and their prisoner at the same time. I release them to You and out of my hands. I take back what I gave them access to. I cancel the debt I have been trying to collect."

(This will not feel true the first time. Do it anyway. Feeling follows obedience, sometimes by months.)

Step 4 — Renounce what you've named.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"In the name of Jesus Christ I renounce [each item from Work Page 7, one at a time, out loud]. I break every agreement I made with it, knowingly or unknowingly. I take my hand off it, and I ask You to close that door and seal it with the blood of Jesus."

Step 5 — Break vows and self-curses.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I break every vow I made in pain. Specifically: [say each one]. I renounce it. I release myself from it in Jesus' name. It has no more claim on my life."

Step 6 — Release what is not yours.

PRAYER

"Jesus, I release my hold on [name, or 'the one whose name I don't know'], and I ask You to loosen their hold on me. I hand back what is theirs. I take back what is mine — my body, my mind, my peace, my identity, my future. What God did not join, I do not keep."

Step 7 — Resist (optional). *If you believe something spiritual has been pressing on you, talk it through with a pastor or counselor you trust first. Scripture's instruction is simple: submit to God, resist the devil, and he will flee (James 4:7). Skip this step if it stirs up more than you can hold.*

PRAYER

"Jesus, I belong to You. Anything that is not from You — any lie, fear, or influence that took hold through what I have named — has no place in my life, my home, or my family. In Your name I resist it, and I ask You to send it away. I am Yours. Holy Spirit, stay with me. Amen."

Step 8 — Fill it. Do not skip this. Luke 11:24–26 is Jesus' picture of a swept house left empty, and the practical lesson is that when something leaves your life, something good has to move in.

PRAYER

"Holy Spirit, fill every place that just emptied. Fill it with Your presence, Your peace, Your truth, Your love. Where fear lived, put love. Where shame lived, put sonship. Where craving lived, put satisfaction. Occupy every room."

Step 9 — Declare.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I belong to God. I am forgiven, I am free, and I am not going back. What tried to end me is going to be the testimony that frees somebody else. In Jesus' name. Amen."

WORK PAGE 8 — DATE IT

I did the renouncing on: ____ / ____ / ____

Who was with me: _____

What I felt in my body during and after:

What came up for me in the days after (write it — naming what comes up makes it easier to face):

Expect a rough few days. Old contacts texting. Old dreams. A wave of grief. A craving with a new face. This kind of work stirs things up. That is not proof it worked and it is not proof it failed — it is proof you touched something real. Sleep, eat, stay near your people, and tell your counselor or one safe person. Not every hard day is a spiritual attack, and you do not have to decide what caused it before you ask for help.

2.7 The armor — daily, not occasionally

Ephesians 6:14–18. Many believers put it on out loud, every morning, thirty seconds:

- **Belt of truth** — "I will not lie to myself today."
- **Breastplate of righteousness** — "I am covered by His, not mine."
- **Shoes of peace** — "I bring peace into rooms; I don't take chaos from them."
- **Shield of faith** — "Every lie aimed at me today, I put this in front of."
- **Helmet of salvation** — "My mind belongs to God. I don't have to think every thought that shows up."
- **Sword of the Spirit** — "The Word is my answer, not my feelings."
- **Prayer** — "I stay in conversation, not monologue."

Notice: **no armor on the back.** You're not built to run. You're built to stand, and to stand with others.

PART III

The Chosen One: The Deep Dive

3.1 First, the correction

The internet sold "chosen one" as special. Scripture sells it as **sent**.

Chosen is not a rank. It is an **assignment**. It does not mean God likes you more. It means God has something for you to carry that most people will not carry, and He is going to prepare you for it in ways that will look, from the outside, like He abandoned you.

*"You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you that you should go and bear fruit."
— John 15:16*

Appointed **that you should go**. Chosen is a verb with a destination.

3.2 A pattern you can see in many of them

Look at the pattern and see whether you recognize yourself in it:

Who	The early wound	The wilderness	The assignment
Joseph	Betrayed and trafficked by his own blood	13 years — slavery, false accusation, prison, forgotten	Saved the nations, and the family that sold him
Moses	Born under a death order, raised in the enemy's house, identity split	40 years on the back side of the desert after a killing	Led a whole people out
David	Overlooked youngest, left with sheep	Years hunted by the king who was supposed to bless him	King, and the voice of everyone who ever cried out
Hannah	Barren, mocked, misunderstood — the priest thought she was drunk while she prayed	Years of unanswered asking	Gave the nation its prophet
Esther	Orphan, taken into a king's harem — she was not "picked," she was collected	Hidden, silent, one wrong move from death	Stopped a genocide
Paul	Was the abuser first. Blood on his hands.	Blinded, then years unknown in Arabia and Tarsus	Wrote most of the New Testament
Jesus	Rumored illegitimate, refugee child, hometown rejection	40 days of hunger and direct temptation	Everything

The pattern:

1. Marked early — often by wound, not by celebration.
2. Isolated — removed from the people who should have carried you.
3. Delayed — longer than you can stand.
4. Misunderstood — called crazy, drunk, dramatic, too much, divisive.
5. Broken in a specific spot — the exact place your assignment will require humility.

6. Then used — and often the fruit comes in the shape of the wound.

Read that last one again: often, the fruit comes in the shape of the wound. Not always, and not automatically. Scripture never tells us every wound is an assignment, and it never says God planned the harm. It does show Him bringing good out of it (Genesis 50:20).

Joseph's assignment was famine and family. He was starved of family. Moses' assignment was deliverance. He was the one who got delivered out of the water. Paul's assignment was grace. He was the one who least deserved it.

Your story may point toward what you are meant to do — look at where your wound and your compassion overlap. That is interpretation, not a guarantee. Hold it loosely and test it with mature people.

WORK PAGE 9 — READING YOUR OWN STORY

What was attacked earliest in my life?

What did they try hardest to take from me? (Voice? Body? Innocence? Family? Mind? Faith?)

What do people keep coming to me about, even when I feel unqualified?

What makes me furious in a way that isn't about me? (Holy anger is a compass.)

What could I explain to someone in the dark that a person with a normal life could never explain?

Look at those five answers together. **They may point toward something you are meant to do.** Write it in one sentence:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I am the one who _____
for the people who _____."

3.3 The cost of being chosen – the unfiltered list

Nobody prints this part. Here it is.

1. Isolation that isn't punishment. You will lose people. Some you'll grieve for years. Not all of it is attack — some of it may be God clearing a table so He can seat the right people at it. But it will feel identical to abandonment. Both can be true.

2. Being misunderstood by good people. Not just enemies. Pastors. Family. Friends who love you. They will call your calling pride, your grief drama, your boundaries bitterness, your urgency instability.

3. Delay that looks like denial. Joseph, thirteen years. Moses, forty. You will get a promise and then watch the opposite happen for a long time. **The promise doesn't fail in the delay. It gets forged there.**

4. A season that feels out of proportion. If it has been *weirdly* much, that does not mean you are cursed — and it does not prove you are carrying something special, either. Some seasons are just brutal. Ask for help either way.

5. Repeat temptation at the same fault line. Whatever nearly took you out will come back with a suit on. Often when you step up, it will knock. Not because you failed. Because it's the known door.

6. Being made to carry it without credit. Sometimes you will do the thing and someone else will get thanked. If you need the credit, you cannot carry the weight.

7. The loneliness of the middle. Too healed for your old crowd. Too raw for the polished ones. That gap is where most called people quit. **You are not supposed to stay in the gap. You are supposed to build in it.** That's what 7HE HOLY R3UP is for.

8. Grief that comes back on a schedule. Anniversaries. Songs. Smells. Being chosen does not exempt you from missing the ones you lost. The absence of someone you lost does not get smaller because the work is real. It gets *carried better*. Different thing.

WORK PAGE 10 — COUNTING THE COST HONESTLY

What has this already cost me?

What am I still unwilling to pay? (Be honest. God can work with honest.)

What am I demanding from God as a condition? ("I'll do it if You give me _____.")

Who did I lose that I need to grieve instead of chase?

3.4 Counterfeits — how to tell calling from ego

The "chosen one" idea gets hijacked constantly. Run your sense of calling through this grid:

Real calling	Counterfeit
Points people to God	Points people to you
Survives being unseen	Requires an audience
Comes with correction you accept	Rejects all correction as persecution
Makes you more approachable	Makes you more untouchable
Confirmed by fruit and by mature people	Confirmed only by your own feelings
Welcomes accountability	Calls accountability jealousy
Grows in obscurity	Dies in obscurity
Says "this happened TO me and God is using it"	Says "this happened because I'm superior"
Wants others free	Wants others dependent

The test that never fails: Can you be corrected? A chosen person who can't be corrected is the most dangerous person in any room, and there are a lot of them with microphones.

WORK PAGE 11 — THE MIRROR

Who in my life is allowed to tell me I'm wrong? (If the answer is nobody, that's the assignment for this month.)

Last time I was corrected, how did I respond?

Do I need to be needed? Where does that show up?

3.5 The transition: from victim to survivor to steward

Three stages. Most people stall at two.

Victim — "This happened to me." True. Necessary. You must be allowed to be here. Skipping it is how people end up doing ministry out of an open wound.

Survivor — "This happened to me and I'm still here." Strength. Also a place you can get stuck, because "still here" can become an identity built on the thing that hurt you. If your whole self is *what you survived*, the abuser still owns the deed.

Steward — "This happened to me, I'm still here, and now it belongs to God and it's for somebody else." This is where the wound stops being a hole and becomes a door.

"Who comforts us in all our affliction, so that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction." — 2 Corinthians 1:4

The "so that" is the whole thing. You were not comforted so you'd feel better. You were comforted so you'd know the road.

WORK PAGE 12 — WHERE AM I?

Circle: **Victim / Survivor / Steward** — and be honest, it may differ by area.

Area of my life	Which stage	What's the next step
Addiction		
Abuse		
Family		
Grief		
Faith		
Body		

One thing I can steward this week — not someday, this week:

PART IV

Survivor of Addiction and Abuse

4.1 The truth about how the two braid together

Addiction and abuse are not two separate problems that happened to the same person. They feed each other.

Abuse creates the hole. Addiction fills it. Addiction then puts you in rooms where more abuse happens. More abuse deepens the hole. Around and around.

This is why "just stop using" fails. You are not asking someone to drop a habit. You are asking them to sit in an unmedicated wound with no skills and no safety. Of course they went back. Anyone would.

Which means: you cannot get sober and heal the trauma later. You have to run them together. Sobriety without trauma work is a countdown. Trauma work while actively using is a spin cycle. Both, at once, slowly.

4.2 What addiction actually is

Three layers. Work all three or it comes back.

Layer 1 — Physical. Real dependence. Real receptors. Real withdrawal. Requires medical help sometimes. Not a moral issue.

Layer 2 — Psychological. The relief. Addiction is not a love of the substance. It is a love of the *gap in the pain*. It worked. That's the problem — it worked, right up until it started charging interest.

Layer 3 — Spiritual. Every addiction is a false savior. It promises what only God gives: peace, escape, belonging, numbness from shame, courage, rest. It's a counterfeit communion.

"My people have committed two evils: they have forsaken me, the fountain of living waters, and dug for themselves cisterns — broken cisterns that can hold no water." — Jeremiah 2:13

The cistern isn't the sin. **Digging your own** is.

WORK PAGE 13 — WHAT WAS IT DOING FOR YOU?

This is the most important question in the whole workbook. Answer it slowly.

What did it give me that I couldn't get anywhere else?

What did it let me stop feeling?

Who was I when I was using? (Sometimes people use to access a self they can't reach sober — confident, loud, calm, wanted.)

What was the first time it worked? (Age, situation.)

Now the hard one: If I take it away and don't replace the function, what happens?

That's your relapse map. You don't just need to remove the substance. You need a legitimate answer for every job it was doing. Write those jobs down; Part V builds replacements for each.

4.3 Abuse: naming it without softening it

Check what happened. Not "was it bad enough." Just — did it happen.

- ☐ Hit, shoved, choked, restrained, thrown
- ☐ Threatened, with words or weapons or a look
- ☐ Sexually coerced, assaulted, or used
- ☐ Trafficked, sold, traded, "loaned out"
- ☐ Controlled — money, phone, car, friends, food, sleep
- ☐ Isolated from anyone who would have helped
- ☐ Degraded, mocked, called names until you believed them
- ☐ Gaslit — told your memory was wrong until you stopped trusting your own head

- ☐ Love-bombed then withdrawn, on a cycle, until the cycle became the drug
- ☐ Punished for having needs
- ☐ Blamed for their behavior
- ☐ Threatened with your kids, your freedom, your reputation, your life
- ☐ Neglected as a child — nobody came
- ☐ Spiritually abused — Scripture used to keep you in it
- ☐ Made to feel crazy for reacting normally to abnormal treatment

THE SPECIFIC DAMAGE OF BETRAYAL BY FAMILY

If the hand that hurt you was supposed to feed you, you didn't just get injured. **Your instrument for detecting safety got miscalibrated at the factory.** That's why you can smell danger from a mile away and still walk straight into it. Your alarm works. Your *identifier* is broken. You learned that harm and love arrive in the same package.

That is fixable. It is not fixable by trying harder. It is fixable by building new evidence, slowly, with safe people, over time.

WORK PAGE 14 — THE LETTER YOU WILL NEVER SEND

Write it to the one who did the most damage. Nobody reads it. You can burn it after.

Rules: no editing for fairness. No "but they had a hard life too." Not yet. Rage allowed. Raw words allowed. God's not scandalized; He's read worse in the Psalms (go read Psalm 55 or 109 if you don't believe me).

Start with: **"What you took from me was..."**

Now end it with one line, whenever you're able — not today if not today:

"I am not sending you my life as payment anymore."

4.4 Moral injury – the page nobody writes

Some of you are not haunted by what was done to you. You're haunted by **what you did while you were surviving**.

What you did to get well. Who you hurt to get high. The kid who watched. The people you stole from. The ones you brought into it. The times you were the dangerous one.

Here is the truth, unfiltered: **that was real, and it is not unforgivable**. Paul stood by at Stephen's stoning and went on to persecute believers (Acts 7:58–8:3). God did not just forgive him — God *commissioned* him and had him write letters we still read. Not despite it. He referenced it constantly. It was his credential for grace.

But forgiveness is not the same as amends. You get forgiven by God. You make it right with people where you safely can. Two different tracks. Do both.

WORK PAGE 15 — MORAL INJURY INVENTORY

What I did	Who it hurt	Can I make it right?	How / or why not

"Can I make it right?" — sometimes the answer is no: they're gone, contact is unsafe, or approaching them would harm them more. **When you can't make direct amends, you make living amends.** You become someone who doesn't do that anymore, and you serve where that damage lives.

What I can't fix directly, I will pay forward by:

Receive this out loud: "I did that. It was mine. Jesus paid for it. I am not going to keep punishing someone He already pardoned."

PART V

Roadmap: Breaking Addiction

Step by step. In order. No skipping.

THE HOLY R3UP

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Safety first: alcohol, benzos, and barbiturates can kill you in withdrawal. Opioid withdrawal won't usually kill you but it will make you want to die, and MAT (Suboxone, methadone, naltrexone) is a legitimate, not-cheating, God-honoring tool. **Get a medical opinion before Step 1. SAMHSA: 1-800-662-4357.**

Step 1 – Tell One Person the Actual Truth

Not a version. The truth. What, how much, how often, how long, how bad.

Why this is step one: addiction lives in secrecy. Every single thing you keep hidden keeps its power. Confession is not humiliation — it's cutting off the oxygen.

"Confess your sins to one another and pray for one another, that you may be healed." – James 5:16

Pick who: someone who (a) won't panic, (b) won't gossip, (c) won't use it against you later, (d) won't minimize it. Sponsor, counselor, pastor you trust, one friend who's been through it.

Do it in the next 48 hours.

- Person I'm telling: _____
- When: _____
- Done: ☐

Step 2 – Get the Medical Picture

Call SAMHSA or a doctor. Ask four questions:

1. Is my withdrawal dangerous?
2. Do I need supervised detox?
3. Is MAT right for me?
4. What else is going on — sleep, thyroid, nutrition, depression, ADHD, pain?

Untreated mental health conditions are a common driver of relapse. If you've been self-medicating something real, taking away the medication without treating the condition is not sobriety. It's a stopwatch.

- Called: ☐ Date: _____
- What they said: _____
- Next appointment: _____

Step 3 – Set a Date and Clear the Runway

Not "someday." A date. Within 14 days.

My date: ____ / ____ / ____

Before the date, do all of this:

- ☐ **Remove it all.** Every stash, every backup, every "just in case." Dispose of it safely (many pharmacies take pills back). Have someone with you.
- ☐ **Remove the tools.** Pipes, needles, bottles, the app, the browser history, the card you use.
- ☐ **Delete and block every dealer and drinking buddy.** All of them. Screenshot nothing. Keep no number "just to say no."
- ☐ **Tell three people the date.** Accountability is a fence, not an insult.
- ☐ **Clear the calendar for the first 72 hours.** No obligations. No driving if you can avoid it.
- ☐ **Stock the house.** Water, electrolytes, easy food, sugar, fruit, something soft to sleep on, a fan, a bucket, ibuprofen.
- ☐ **Decide where you go if the house isn't safe.** Write the address: _____
- ☐ **Line up day 1, 2, and 3.** A meeting, a person, a phone call at a set time. Empty time is where it gets you.

Step 4 – Map the Trigger Chain

Relapse is never one moment. It's a chain with 6–10 links, and every link before the last one is easier to break.

Fill this out for your most common relapse:

Link	Yours
1. Setting (where, what time of day)	
2. Emotional state (bored? lonely? angry? celebrating?)	
3. Body state (tired? hungry? in pain? not slept?)	
4. The thought that starts it	
5. The justification ("I've earned it," "one won't...", "nobody cares anyway")	
6. The first action (a text, a drive, a search)	
7. The point of no return	
8. The use	
9. The aftermath	

Now: circle link 3 or 4. **That's where you intervene from now on.** Not link 7. By link 7 you already decided; you just hadn't admitted it.

My earliest detectable link is: _____ **When I notice it, I will immediately:**

HALT check — run it 3x/day. Hungry, Angry, Lonely, Tired. Most relapses are three of those stacked and none of them are actually about the substance.

Step 5 – Replace the Function

Go back to Work Page 13. For every job the substance did, write a legitimate replacement. This is non-negotiable — you cannot leave a vacancy.

Job it did	Legitimate replacement	When I'll do it
Numbed pain		
Gave energy		
Helped me sleep		
Made me social / confident		
Gave me something to look forward to		
Quieted my head		
Punished me		
Gave me a community		

Replacements that actually work on the nervous system: exercise (one of the best-supported ways to ease a craving in real time), cold water, heavy lifting, running, sunlight in the first hour awake, real food, 8 hours attempted, service to someone else, loud worship, a phone call, a saw or a paintbrush or something with your hands, drums, singing, dancing in your kitchen like a fool.

Replacements that don't: scrolling, a new relationship, overwork, sugar as a whole strategy, isolation with a Bible you're reading like a hostage.

Step 6 – Build the Structure (the First 90 Days)

Sobriety is not willpower. It's architecture.

Daily non-negotiables — write your own version:

Time	What	Why
Wake	Same hour, feet on floor, sunlight	Body-clock reset; losing sleep is a major relapse risk
First 10 min	Prayer out loud + armor (2.7)	Set the day before it sets you
Morning	Protein + water before caffeine	Blood sugar crashes read as cravings
Midday	Move your body 20+ min	Chemistry, not vanity
Afternoon	HALT check + text your person	Breaks the chain early
Evening	Meeting / call / group 5x week minimum first 90 days	Isolation is the killer
Night	Same bedtime. Phone out of the room.	Protect the sleep or lose the war
Before sleep	Gratitude, 3 things, out loud	Rewires the negativity groove

Weekly:

- ☐ One recovery meeting minimum (AA/NA/Celebrate Recovery/SMART/church group — whatever you'll actually attend)
- ☐ One check-in with sponsor/mentor
- ☐ One therapy session if you can access it
- ☐ One act of service — small, anonymous
- ☐ One full rest day

The 90-day rule: for the first 90 days, no major decisions. No new relationships. No moving. No quitting jobs. No going back to fix your family. (If safety or housing is at stake, safety comes first.) Your judgment is recovering too and it comes back last.

STEP 7 – CRAVING PROTOCOL (*memorize this*)

A craving often peaks within 15–30 minutes and then fades, even when it does not feel like it will. You only have to outlast a wave.

When it hits:

1. **Say it out loud.** "I am having a craving. It is 10:40. It will peak and pass."
2. **Set a timer for 20 minutes.** You are not deciding anything until it rings.
3. **Change your body.** Cold water on wrists/face. 20 pushups. Walk out the front door.
4. **Change your location.** Do not stay in the room where it started.
5. **Call.** Not text. Voice. Have three numbers memorized and one who always answers.
6. **Eat and drink.** Water and protein. Half your cravings are blood sugar.
7. **Pray specific and short.** "Jesus, I can't do this minute. You hold it." Not eloquent. Effective.

8. **Play the tape forward.** Not the first hour. The 48th. The phone call you'd have to make. The face of the person you'd have to tell. Write it now so it's ready:

My play-the-tape-forward, written in advance:

If I use today, within 48 hours I will: _____

The person whose face I'll see is: _____

What I will have thrown away: _____

9. **When the timer rings, reset it once if needed.** You almost never need a third.

My three numbers:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

STEP 8 – RELAPSE PLAN (write it now, not after)

Having a plan does not give permission. Not having one gives the relapse a runway.

"The righteous falls seven times and rises again." – Proverbs 24:16 The identity is in the rising, not the not-falling.

If I use:

1. I stop at the first one. The relapse is the first use; the *run* is the decision after it.
2. Within 1 hour I tell: _____
3. I go to: _____ (a meeting, a person, a room that's safe)
4. I do NOT hide it, and I do NOT declare myself a failure. I do not throw away 60 days over one day.
5. I get medical help if needed — **tolerance drops during sobriety, and that's how overdoses happen after a clean stretch.** Know this. Tell whoever you use around. Have naloxone (Narcan) in the house if opioids are in your history. Free at most pharmacies.
6. I go back to Step 4 and find the link I missed, and I write it down.

What I will NOT do after a relapse:

Step 9 – The Spiritual Side of the Same War

Run these alongside Steps 1–8, never instead of.

- ☐ **Renounce the addiction as a false god by name.** "I renounce [substance/behavior] as my savior, my comfort, and my god. It is not my provider. Jesus is." (Full renouncing in 2.6.)
- ☐ **Break the agreements.** "I am an addict and I always will be" — decide what you actually believe. *I have an addiction* is a fact. *I am worthless because of it* is a lie. Break the second, respect the first.
- ☐ **Close the doors** the using opened — people, places, sexual ties, occult contact, what you watched and listened to in that life.
- ☐ **Fast something, on purpose, on a schedule.** Social media. Sugar. Screens. A meal, only if your doctor says it is safe for you — skip food fasting if you are pregnant, diabetic, have an eating-disorder history, or take medication with meals. Fasting practices the muscle of telling a craving no.
- ☐ **Get baptized or re-affirm it** if that's part of your story. Mark the line. Bodies need markers.
- ☐ **Take communion regularly.** You had a false communion for years. Replace the ritual with the real one.
- ☐ **Worship loud when it's bad.** 2 Chronicles 20 — they sent the singers out front, before the army.
- ☐ **Get someone to lay hands and pray over you.** Don't do this whole war solo.

Step 10 – Milestones and Meaning

Track it. Visibly. Days matter and your brain needs the count.

Milestone	Date reached	How I marked it
24 hours		
72 hours (for many people, the hardest stretch)		
1 week		
30 days		
60 days		
90 days (many people notice sleep, mood, and focus improving)		
6 months		
1 year		

At 90 days, add this: start being useful to one other person who's earlier than you. Not as a savior — as a witness. Nothing protects sobriety like being needed by somebody who's watching whether it's real.

PART VI

Roadmap: Breaking Generational Curses

6.1 What it is and what it isn't

It is: a way of naming patterns of sin, wound, and unhealed pain that can run down a family until somebody brings them into the light and changes course.

- "Visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children to the third and fourth generation" — Exodus 20:5
- "Our fathers sinned and are no more, and we bear their iniquities." — Lamentations 5:7

It isn't: God punishing you for what your grandfather did. Read Ezekiel 18 and Jeremiah 31:29–30 — God explicitly says the son does **not** bear the father's guilt. And Galatians 3:13 — "Christ redeemed us from the curse."

So how is it both? Because **guilt** doesn't transfer, but **consequence, pattern, wound, and access** absolutely do. You didn't inherit their sin. You inherited the *terrain*. The debt was paid; the door was left standing open, and nobody in four generations walked over and shut it.

That's your job. That's the whole assignment. You're the one who closes it.

Practical layers, all real at once:

- **Behavioral** — you learned it. Modeled, absorbed, normal to you.
- **Biological** — research on epigenetics suggests severe stress can affect how the next generation's bodies respond to stress. It is an active area of science, not a settled verdict, and it is not destiny.
- **Systemic** — poverty, incarceration, no education, no assets. Real walls.
- **Spiritual** — whatever a vow, a practice, or an unhealed wound opened that nobody ever brought to God.

You work all four with four different tools. Most people try one and wonder why it didn't hold.

6.2 Step 1 – Map the Bloodline

You can't break what you haven't named. Draw it. Three or four generations up if you can. Both sides.

For each person, note what ran through them:

Person / generation	Addiction	Abuse	Sexual sin / trafficking	Suicide / early death	Mental illness	Poverty	Abandonment	Occult / witchcraft	Rage	Infidelity	Incarceration
Me											
Mother											
Father											
Maternal grandmother											
Maternal grandfather											
Paternal grandmother											
Paternal grandfather											
Great-grandparents (any known)											

Person / generation	Addiction	Abuse	Sexual sin / trafficking	Suicide / early death	Mental illness	Poverty	Abandonment	Occult / witchcraft	Rage	Infidelity	Incarceration
Siblings											
My children											

Now look at the columns. Which ones have marks in three or more generations?

The patterns running in my line are:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Which of these has already touched my children or the generation after me?

That's why this is worth doing — for you, and for whoever comes after you.

6.3 Step 2 – Find the Entry Points

For each pattern, ask: **where did this get permission?**

- What did somebody in this line *do* — a covenant, an oath, a practice, a dedication, a betrayal, a killing, a dealing with spirits?
- What did somebody in this line *say* — a curse spoken over a child, "you'll never amount to anything," "you're just like your father," a death wish?
- What was done *to* this line — slavery, genocide, displacement, land taken, a family destroyed? (Corporate trauma is real and it runs.)
- What secret has this family kept? **Secrets are load-bearing walls for curses.** The thing nobody talks about is usually the thing with the most power.

The secret in my family that nobody says out loud:

Naming it here, on paper, often takes some of the weight off. Secrets grow in the dark.

6.4 Step 3 – Repent for the Line (Identificational Repentance)

Many believers find this meaningful. It is based on how Daniel, Nehemiah, and Ezra prayed for their people. It is a practice to consider, not a requirement for your freedom, and it is not a magic formula. If it does not sit right with you, skip to Step 4 and talk it through with a pastor you trust.

You are not confessing their guilt as if it's yours. You are **standing in the gap, as someone who belongs to that family, and agreeing with God about what is true.**

Biblical precedent: Daniel 9 (Daniel repents for Israel's sin, generations of it, including sins he did not commit). Nehemiah 1:6 – "I and my father's house have sinned." Leviticus 26:40 – "they shall confess their iniquity and the iniquity of their fathers."

Pray out loud, one pattern at a time:

PRAYER

"Father, I come as a son/daughter of this bloodline. I stand in the gap. I confess and agree with You that [pattern — addiction, violence, sexual sin, witchcraft, abandonment, whatever] has run in my family line. I do not defend it. I do not excuse it. I do not hide it anymore.

I confess the sins of my ancestors in this area — known and unknown — and I confess my own participation and agreement with it. [Name your own part.]

I ask Your forgiveness for my line, on the basis of the blood of Jesus Christ, which is more than enough.

I bring to the cross of Christ every covenant, vow, oath, dedication, harsh word, and agreement made by anyone in my family line that has shaped us for harm, and I ask You to cancel its hold.

I renounce [pattern] as having any right to me, my body, my mind, my marriage, my finances, my children, or any generation after me.

Jesus, I place myself, my children, and my family line under Your protection. Anything that is not from You — any lie, pattern, or influence that has run through [pattern] — I resist in Your name. Do not let it pass on to my children.

Lord, I ask You to establish a new pattern in this line, starting with me. Let it be said that it stopped here. Amen."

If you choose to pray this, do it once for every pattern on your list. One at a time, specifically, out loud.

Pattern	Date renounced

Pattern	Date renounced

6.5 Step 4 – Break Your Own Agreements with It

A pattern keeps going when we keep agreeing with it, and you have probably been doing that without knowing.

Things I've said or believed that agreed with the pattern:

- "It's just how we are."
- "Everybody in my family is like this."
- "I'm turning into my mother/father."
- "Addiction runs in my family so I was always going to..."
- "We don't do money."
- "Nobody in my family stays married."
- "We die young."

Write yours:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Break each one out loud: "I renounce the agreement I made when I said '_____' That is not prophecy, it is a pattern, and patterns end. I break it in Jesus' name."

Now replace it: "The truth is: _____"

6.6 Step 5 – Change the Behavior (the Part Prayer Doesn't Do for You)

Here's the unfiltered part: **you can renounce a curse perfectly and still repeat it, because you learned the behavior and nobody has taught you a different one.**

Deliverance closes the door. **Discipleship builds the new house.** You need both or you'll be doing this same prayer next year.

For each pattern, name the concrete behavior and the concrete replacement:

Pattern	The behavior I inherited	The new behavior I'm building	How I'll practice it this week
e.g. rage	Yelling when scared	Naming fear out loud, walking out for 10 min	Tell my kid the plan so they can hold me to it

Where do I get the new behavior from? You have to see it modeled. Find someone who does the thing you never learned — marriage, money, parenting, anger, rest — and get close enough to watch. **You cannot imagine your way into a pattern you've never seen.**

Who I'm going to learn from:

6.7 Step 6 – Honor Without Repeating

You can honor your parents and refuse their pattern. Both. Simultaneously. It is not betrayal to be the one who stopped it.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"Honor your father and mother." — and also — "Whoever loves father or mother more than me is not worthy of me." (Matthew 10:37)

Honor is not obedience, agreement, access, or silence. Honor means you don't degrade them, you don't build your identity on hating them, and you don't hand your life to them as payment.

What I can genuinely honor about where I came from:

What I am refusing to carry forward:

6.8 Step 7 – Establish the New Covenant Line

Don't just close a door. **Build something.**

Write it. Out loud. Then put it somewhere you will see it every day.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

THE LINE STOPS HERE

I, _____, declare before God that the following ends with me and does not pass to the generation after me:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

And I declare that the following BEGINS with me in this bloodline:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

I can be the pivot. I am choosing to help what was meant to bury my family become something that frees it.

Signed: _____ Date: _____

Then: bless the people in your life out loud, by name, regularly. Words can wound and words can bless. Speak over them what nobody spoke over you.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I place whoever comes after me, in any sense, in the Lord's hands. They are not the enemy's inheritance. They are God's."

PART VII

Letting People Go, and Sitting Silent with God

7.1 Why letting go is the hardest page in the book

Because you're not letting go of a person. You're letting go of:

- the version of them you needed them to become
- the apology you're still owed
- the hope that this time it would be different
- the role you've played your whole life
- and the belief that if you hold on hard enough, love will finally show up

You are grieving something that never existed. That's why it hurts worse than a funeral. There's no body and nobody sends flowers.

7.2 The four kinds of letting go

Type	What it means	The hard truth
Release to God	They stay in your life, you stop carrying their outcome	You can love someone and not be their savior
Boundary	They stay, with limits	Boundaries are not punishments; they're property lines
Distance	Less access, not zero	You can go low-contact without a declaration
Cut off	No contact	Sometimes required. Sometimes the only way anyone survives

You are not obligated to give unlimited access to someone who is actively harming you, and no Scripture requires it. Jesus withdrew constantly (Luke 5:16, John 6:15). Paul named people and said avoid them (2 Timothy 4:14–15, Romans 16:17). "Turn the other cheek" was about personal insult, not standing in a house fire.

WORK PAGE 16 — SORTING YOUR PEOPLE

Person	What they give	What they cost	Which of the four	Next step

7.3 The honest diagnostic — is this letting go, or is it quitting on someone?

Run it through:

- Am I leaving because they're harming me, or because they're **inconvenient** to my new life? (Those are different.)
- Have I told them the truth clearly, at least once, when I wasn't in a rage?
- Am I cutting them off to punish them, or to survive?
- If they changed, would I actually want them back — or am I done regardless? (Both answers are allowed. Know which it is.)
- Am I repeating the abandonment I received, or breaking the enmeshment I was raised in?
- Would I advise someone I love to stay in this?

What came up:

7.4 The specific one: letting go of someone still using

This is its own hell, and if you've lost someone to it, read this slowly.

What you can do: love them, tell the truth, keep the door of relationship open while closing the door of enabling, keep Narcan in your house, know the number to call, pray without ceasing, and be someone they can come back to.

What you cannot do: want it more than they do and have that work. Save someone who isn't reaching. Control the outcome. Be the reason. Trade your life for theirs.

The hardest sentence in this workbook: You can do everything right and still lose them.

And here's the other side of it: **if you lost someone, that does not mean you did it wrong.** It means addiction is lethal and they were sick and you were not God. Read that again. You were not, and are not, God. That was never your job and it was never in your hands.

WORK PAGE 17 — FOR THE ONE YOU LOST OR MIGHT LOSE

What I did do for them:

What I keep telling myself I should have done:

Was that actually in my power? _____ Who in this story was responsible for what?

Responsible for	Who
Their choices	
The people who hurt them	
The system that failed them	
The disease itself	
My choices	

Say it: "I loved them. I was not their God. I put them in the hands of the One who is, and I will carry their name forward into the work instead of carrying their death as a debt."

7.5 How to actually do it — the release

Don't do this halfway. Halfway is how you end up doing it fourteen times.

Step 1 — Say the truth about what it was. Out loud. Not the sanitized version. Not the villain version either. The true one.

Step 2 — Grieve it like a death. Because it is one. Let yourself cry for a person who is still alive. This is legitimate grief and it needs the same space.

Step 3 — Forgive without reconciling. Forgiveness is between you and God. Reconciliation requires two people and repentance. **You can be fully forgiving and fully unavailable.** Nobody taught us that and it changes everything.

Step 4 — Return what's theirs.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I give back the shame that was never mine. I give back the blame. I give back the story they wrote about me. I give back the responsibility for their choices. I take back my name, my voice, my body, my future, and my peace."

Step 5 — Release the hold. (2.6, Step 6.)

Step 6 — Set the actual boundary in the actual world. Block the number. Change the lock. Tell the family member who relays messages to stop. Boundaries that exist only in your heart are wishes.

Step 7 — Plan for the pullback. They will reach out. Usually right when you get peaceful. Decide now what you'll do, because deciding in the moment is how you get pulled back in.

When they reach out, I will:

Step 8 — Replace the space. A cut-off leaves a hole and holes get filled by whatever's nearest. Put something in it on purpose — people, work, service, God.

WORK PAGE 18 — THE RELEASE DECLARATION

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I release _____ into the hands of God.

I am not their savior, their judge, their jailer, or their payment.

What was good, I keep. What was mine, I take back. What was theirs, I return.

I forgive them. I am not available for more harm.

The boundary I am setting is: _____

The date I set it: ____ / ____ / ____

7.6 Sitting Silent with God

This is the last section because it's the one that holds everything else up. And it's the one you'll resist most, because silence is where the pain lives and you've spent your whole life outrunning it.

WHY SILENCE IS THE HARDEST SPIRITUAL DISCIPLINE FOR SURVIVORS

Noise was safety. If it was quiet, you could hear them coming. If it was quiet, you had to feel it. So you filled every second — music, TV, scrolling, people, work, using. You are not undisciplined. **You are guarded.**

Silence will feel like danger before it feels like peace. That's not failure. That's a nervous system that learned quiet meant something bad was about to happen.

WHAT THE SCRIPTURE ACTUALLY SAYS

- **1 Kings 19:11–12** — Elijah, suicidal and burned out, looks for God in wind, earthquake, fire. God's in "a sound of thin silence." The whisper comes *after* God feeds him and lets him sleep twice. **Note the order: food, sleep, then the whisper.** God did not rebuke his exhaustion. He fed it.
- **Psalms 46:10** — "Be still and know." The Hebrew *rapha* is closer to "let go, drop your hands, stop striving."
- **Psalms 62:1** — "For God alone my soul waits in silence."
- **Lamentations 3:26** — "It is good that one should wait quietly for the salvation of the LORD."
- **Isaiah 30:15** — "In returning and rest you shall be saved; in quietness and in trust shall be your strength." And then, brutally honest: "But you were unwilling."

THE PRACTICE — START ABSURDLY SMALL

Week 1 — 2 minutes a day. Yes, two. Sit. Feet on the floor. Eyes open if closed feels unsafe — that's allowed and it's smart. Say once: "Jesus, I'm here. You don't have to say anything. I'm not going anywhere for two minutes."

Then nothing. No agenda. No asking. No performance.

When your mind runs — and it will — don't fight it. Say "later" and come back. You'll come back forty times in two minutes. **Coming back IS the practice.** The returning is the prayer.

Week 2 — 5 minutes. Week 3 — 10 minutes. Week 4 — 15 minutes. Stay here. 15 minutes daily beats an hour on Sunday.

WHAT TO DO WHEN SILENCE GETS LOUD

What comes up	What to do
Panic / tight chest	Open your eyes. Orient (look at all four corners). Breathe 4-7-8. Come back tomorrow, shorter. You are not failing.
Memories flooding	Keep a notebook beside you. Write the memory down, one line. Tell it "you're on the list." Return to the silence.

What comes up	What to do
Rage	Let it be there. Rage in God's presence is biblical. Read a psalm of imprecation out loud if you need words.
Accusation ("God's disgusted with you")	That voice isn't His. Answer it once — "Romans 8:1" — and return. Don't argue with it.
Nothing at all, for weeks	Normal. Faithfulness in the dry season is worth more than ecstasy in the easy one. Keep showing up.
You fall asleep	Then you needed sleep. God is not offended. Elijah slept twice before the whisper.

THE FOUR POSTURES OF SILENCE

Rotate these. Don't do just one.

1. **Silent presence** — nothing. Just there. "I'm here."
2. **Silent listening** — one question, then quiet. "What do You want me to know today?" Then wait. Write down what comes; test it later against Scripture and wise people. If it accuses, shames, or condemns you, it isn't Him.
3. **Silent surrender** — hands open, palms up. Physically hand over one thing. Name it. Leave it. Go.
4. **Silent lament** — sit with the grief without fixing it. Don't explain it to God. Don't excuse Him. Just bring it. Psalm 88 ends in darkness and God still printed it.

WORK PAGE 19 — SILENCE LOG (FIRST 30 DAYS)

Day	Minutes	What came up	What I heard, if anything
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

(Continue on your own paper through day 30.)

After 30 days, answer: What changed in me?

What did I hear most consistently?

What am I still afraid to hear?

CLOSING

The Commission

THE HOLY R3UP

You have now done work most people never do. Not because they're weaker — because nobody handed them the pages.

Here's what's true now:

What happened to you was real. Nobody gets to minimize it, including you.

What you did while surviving is forgiven. Not excused — paid for. Stop billing yourself.

The spiritual realm is real, and you are not helpless in it. You belong to Christ, who has already won. Seated with Him, not cowering.

Being chosen cost you what it costs everybody. You are not being punished. God can use what you have been through, and He does not waste it.

The addiction is breakable. Not by willpower — by architecture, honesty, community, medicine where needed, and the Spirit of God. Step by step, day by day, one craving at a time.

You can be the one who changes the pattern. That can feel like a burden. It can also be the beginning of something good.

You are allowed to let people go. Even blood. Even the ones you love. Loving someone does not require you to die with them.

And you are allowed to sit down and be quiet with God, and bring Him nothing, and produce nothing, and still be fully His.

For Brandi Renee.

And for every person who is going to find this in the middle of the night and finally realize somebody wrote it down for them.

The place you wished existed — you're building it. That's the answer to the prayer nobody heard you pray.

REFERENCE TWO

The Whole Story, Volume II

The master companion, whole: contracts, family patterns, the enemy's playbook, where God was, and the step-by-step unraveling.

THE HOLY R3UP

Introduction

If you are reading this, you already know something got its hooks in you and you have never been able to name it.

This book names it. Every agreement, every door, every pattern, and the exact place God was standing while it happened. Then it shows you how to work through it, step by step, with Scripture, with safe people, and with the authority Christ gives His own.

This is the companion to *Trauma and the Spiritual Realm*. That workbook gave you the crash course. This book goes deeper: what vows and agreements made in pain can do to a life, how patterns travel through families, what Scripture says about the enemy, where God was, and how to walk it out over months, not a weekend.

How to use it. Read Books One through Three straight through once. Work Book Five slowly, with a safe person beside you. Come back to Books Six through Nine when you are ready for the harder questions. Write on the lines. Skip whatever stirs up more than you can hold.

A word about the big pictures. Contracts, doors, stages, seasons — these are pictures. Scripture uses legal and relational language, and these pictures lean on it, but Christians hold different views about how literally to take them. Test all of it against the Bible and with people who know you. Keep what helps. Put down what does not.

You do not have to do this alone. If you can reach a trauma-informed counselor, do. Prayer and professional care belong side by side. And if a page ever opens something you cannot close, stop and call someone. The page will wait.

BOOK ONE

The Architecture of Bondage

THE HOLY R3UP

1. Why There Is Always a Legal Question

A note before this chapter: what follows uses a courtroom picture — legal ground, contracts, revoking — drawn from the legal language Scripture itself uses. It is a teaching frame, not a formula, and Christians hold different views on how literally to take it. Use what helps you, test all of it against Scripture, and never let it stand in for medical care, therapy, or safety.

Here is a picture that Scripture's own language makes possible: **the spiritual realm is not a contest of raw power. It is a matter of truth, law, and authority.**

If it ran on raw power, you'd already be free — God is infinitely stronger and it would be over. It doesn't run on power. It runs on **legal right, agreement, authority, and covenant**. That's why Scripture is full of courtroom language:

- Satan is called **the accuser** — Revelation 12:10. An accuser is a legal role. He's a prosecutor.
- In Job 1-2, he has to **ask permission**, twice, and is given explicit limits. He cannot exceed them.
- In Zechariah 3, he stands at Joshua's right hand **to accuse him** — and the Lord answers not with force but with a verdict and a change of clothes.
- Colossians 2:14 — Christ "canceled the **record of debt** that stood against us with its **legal demands**." Debt. Legal demands.
- Ephesians 4:27 — "give no **opportunity** to the devil." The Greek is *topos* — literally **a place, an opportunity, a foothold**.
- Luke 4:6 — Satan offers Jesus the kingdoms "for it has been **delivered to me**." He claims a transfer of authority. Jesus does not dispute the claim; He refuses the terms.

So the whole question of your bondage is a legal question: what has legal ground in your life, how did it get it, and how does it get revoked?

That is good news. **Legal ground can be revoked.** Feelings can't be argued with, but contracts can be canceled. And you are dealing with a defeated enemy whose entire remaining strategy is to keep you from reading the paperwork.

"He disarmed the rulers and authorities and put them to open shame, by triumphing over them in him." — Colossians 2:15

Disarmed. Past tense. Already done. Your work is not to win. **Your work is to enforce.**

THE THREE QUESTIONS FOR EVERYTHING IN THIS BOOK

For every single thing tormenting you, you will ask:

1. **What is the legal ground?** (How did it get in?)
2. **Has it been revoked?** (Have I actually, specifically, out loud canceled it?)
3. **Is the space filled?** (Or is it sitting empty waiting to be reoccupied?)

Everything in Books One through Four exists to help you answer #1. Book Five does #2 and #3.

2. What a Contract Actually Is in the Spirit

A spiritual contract is **an agreement that grants access**. It requires three things:

1. Agreement. Something in you said yes. Sometimes a real yes. Sometimes a yes made at eight years old in terror. Sometimes a yes somebody else made on your behalf. It can still shape you.

2. Words or act. Spoken, sworn, done with the body, written, or ritualized. Scripture takes spoken words seriously (Proverbs 18:21; Matthew 12:36–37; Romans 10:9–10). That's part of why we say these things out loud: speaking makes a decision real to you.

3. Consideration — something exchanged. Relief. Protection. Power. Money. Belonging. Numbness. The feeling of control. **Every contract gave you something.** That's why you made it. That's why it's hard to break. And that's exactly the thing you'll have to grieve.

THE FOUR WAYS A CONTRACT IS ENTERED

Type	How	Example
Knowing	You understood and agreed	A ritual, an oath, a deliberate dealing
Unknowning	You agreed without understanding	"I'll never trust anyone again." A tarot reading "for fun." A song you sang over yourself.
Coerced	Agreed under threat or grooming	What was extracted from you at nine. What a trafficker made you say.
Inherited / imposed	Someone with authority over you did it	A dedication, a curse spoken over your crib, a family covenant

Read this carefully, because this is where survivors get destroyed: a coerced or inherited contract is **not your guilt**. You are not being punished for it. But it is still **your jurisdiction to cancel**, because you're the one standing in that life now. Guilt isn't the issue. **Standing** is.

You are not repenting for being a victim. You are exercising authority over territory that's yours.

THE ONE THING THAT VOIDS EVERY CONTRACT

"For you were bought with a price." — 1 Corinthians 6:20 "Knowing that you were ransomed... not with perishable things such as silver or gold, but with the precious blood of Christ." — 1 Peter 1:18–19

A prior and superior claim voids a later one. You were bought. The blood of Christ is the higher bid, the earlier covenant, and the final authority. Every other contract is a squatter with an expired lease who is counting on you never checking the deed.

This is the legal basis for everything in Book Five. You don't negotiate. You produce a superior title.

3. The Twenty-Two Contracts – The Complete Catalog

Go through all twenty-two. Check what applies. Do not soften. Nobody is reading this but you and God, and He already knows.

CONTRACT 1 – THE SURVIVAL VOW

Made in the moment of harm by a child who had no other options.

Sounds like: "I will never need anyone again." "I will never cry again." "I will never be weak." "I'll never let anyone touch me." "I'll never love anyone." "I won't be here when I'm older." "I'll be so good they can't hurt me." "I'll be so bad it won't matter."

What it gave you: it genuinely got you through. This is the most sympathetic contract in the book and the most binding.

What it costs now: the vow is still enforcing. That's why you can't let people in. It's not that you won't — **a promise is being kept.** You are being loyal to a child's contract.

☐ Applies to me. Mine says: _____

CONTRACT 2 – THE IDENTITY AGREEMENT

You accepted a verdict about who you are.

Sounds like: "I'm the bad one." "I'm the strong one." "I'm the crazy one." "I'm the family's problem." "I'm damaged goods." "I'm an addict, period." "I'm unlovable." "I'm nothing."

How it was signed: somebody said it, often repeatedly, and you eventually agreed. **The signature moment is the day you stopped arguing.**

What it gave you: a category. Predictability. Even a bad identity is more bearable than no identity.

☐ Applies. Mine: _____

CONTRACT 3 – THE SELF-CURSE

Words you spoke against your own life.

Sounds like: "I hope I die." "I wish I'd never been born." "I'll end up just like her." "I'll always be poor." "Nothing ever works for me." "I deserve this."

"Death and life are in the power of the tongue." – Proverbs 18:21

This isn't name-it-claim-it nonsense, and your words did not seal your fate. But words shape how we see ourselves, and the ones you spoke in your worst hour have probably been echoing ever since. **You can bring them to God and speak something truer.**

☐ Applies. Mine: _____

CONTRACT 4 — THE SEXUAL COVENANT (SOUL TIE)

"Do you not know that he who is joined to a prostitute becomes one body with her? For it is written, 'The two shall become one flesh.'" — 1 Corinthians 6:16

Scripture treats sex as more than a casual act — it joins two people in a real way, which is part of why what happens there can leave a mark.

Say the hard part out loud: this includes what was done to you. What was done in assault is **not your sin** — it was a crime against you — and it can still leave a hold on your body, your dreams, and your trust twenty years later. You did not choose it, and you are not stuck with it. That kind of hold deserves real care: safe people, a trauma-informed counselor, and prayer.

Includes: every partner, every hookup, everyone from active addiction, every buyer if you were trafficked, everyone you don't remember, pornography (a tie to a stranger and to an image), and the person you were married to.

☐ Applies. Names or number I can recall: _____

CONTRACT 5 — THE TRAUMA BOND

The covenant of cycled cruelty and relief.

How it's made: intermittent reinforcement. Harm, then tenderness. Harm, then tenderness. Your brain floods with relief every time the danger recedes — and it starts pairing **the abuser with safety** because they're the one who ends the pain they cause.

This is chemical, not moral. It is the exact same mechanism as gambling addiction. This is why you can love, defend, and miss someone who nearly killed you, and why "why don't you just leave" is the stupidest question ever asked of a victim.

The spiritual layer: it's a counterfeit covenant. It mimics marriage — exclusivity, secrecy, sacrifice, "nobody will ever love you like I do."

☐ Applies. With whom: _____

CONTRACT 6 — THE TRAFFICKING / EXPLOITATION CONTRACT

Its own category because its damage is its own.

What was installed: your body is currency. Your worth is transactional. Your no doesn't exist. Someone else owns your yes. Someone else has the right to name you.

What was often literally spoken over you: a new name, ownership language, "you belong to me," threats sworn on your family, and sometimes actual ritual.

This is the most violently imposed contract there is. And it breaks. Every clause of it breaks, because a person cannot legally sell what they do not own, and **nobody ever owned you.** The sale was fraudulent from the first minute. Not forgiven — **void.**

☐ Applies.

CONTRACT 7 — THE OCCULT CONTRACT

Any deliberate contact with spiritual power outside of God.

"There shall not be found among you anyone who... practices divination or tells fortunes or interprets omens or is a sorcerer or a charmer or a medium or a necromancer or one who inquires of the dead." — Deuteronomy 18:10–11

Includes: Ouija, tarot, mediums and psychics, palm reading, astrology used as authority over your decisions, spell work, hexes, love spells, santería, brujería, voodoo, hoodoo, root work, Reiki and energy work with spirit guides, channeling, automatic writing, spirit guides, "your higher self," crystals used for power, manifestation as a spiritual technology, sigils, Wicca, Freemasonry oaths, Eastern Star, secret society initiations, blood pacts, séances, summoning, levitation games, and the "harmless" things you did at slumber parties.

Christians weigh some items on that list differently. Weigh them with Scripture and a trusted pastor. The point is not to frighten you about childhood games — it is to be honest about what you turned to for protection or answers.

The thing nobody says: a lot of survivors got into this **because nobody else was protecting them.** A twelve-year-old with a Ouija board and no father is not a rebel. She's a child looking for anything that will answer her.

That's understandable, and it still opened a door. Both.

☐ Applies. What I did: _____

CONTRACT 8 — THE SUBSTANCE COVENANT

Every addiction is a covenant with a false god. It has a ritual, a liturgy, a priesthood, a place of worship, a sacrifice, and a promise.

What it promised: peace, courage, sleep, escape, belonging, an end to the shame, one hour of feeling normal. **What it demanded:** your money, your body, your people, your name, your children's memory of you, and eventually your life.

"They have forsaken me, the fountain of living waters, and dug for themselves cisterns — broken cisterns." — Jeremiah 2:13

Paul lists idolatry and sorcery (*pharmakeia*) side by side in Galatians 5:20. Scripture's concern is what rules you — not medicine taken under a doctor's care. If a prescription is part of your recovery, it stays.

☐ Applies. My substance/behavior: _____

CONTRACT 9 — THE UNFORGIVENESS CONTRACT

The most common one, and the most understandable.

*"And in anger his master delivered him to the jailers until he should pay all his debt. So also my heavenly Father will do to every one of you, if you do not forgive your brother from your heart."
— Matthew 18:34–35*

Jesus said the **jailers**. He said torturers. That's not metaphor decoration — it's a description of what happens inside a person who holds a debt.

Why this is a contract: unforgiveness is you holding a debt you cannot collect, from a person who may be dead, while paying interest daily. **You have agreed to be their collections department for free, forever.**

"See to it that no one fails to obtain the grace of God; that no root of bitterness spring up and cause trouble, and by it many become defiled." — Hebrews 12:15

Root. It goes down and it spreads and it defiles **many** — your kids feel it.

And the part that has to be said: nobody is telling you it was okay. Nobody is telling you to reconcile. Nobody is telling you to feel differently by Friday. Forgiveness is **releasing the right to collect**, not pretending the debt didn't exist.

☐ Applies. Who I'm still holding: _____

CONTRACT 10 — THE BITTERNESS AGAINST GOD CONTRACT

The one people are too scared to write down.

Sounds like: "Where were You." "You could have stopped it." "I prayed and You did nothing." "If You're real and You let that happen, I don't want You." "You saved other people."

Why it's a contract: it's an agreement that God is not good, and it quietly closes the one door you actually needed open. It doesn't make God your enemy. **It makes you unable to receive from Him.**

Book Three answers this directly and does not flinch. Do not skip it.

☐ Applies. What I hold against Him: _____

CONTRACT 11 — THE GENERATIONAL COVENANT

Something your bloodline agreed to, that was never revoked.

Includes: family occult practice, land dedications, oaths and secret societies, a child dedicated to something, family "gifts" (reading cards, seeing spirits, "we've always been intuitive"), curses spoken between family members, blood feuds, covenants made in war or slavery or migration, unaddressed violence in the line, and the family secret nobody names.

Full mechanics in Chapter 8.

☐ Applies. What I know of: _____

CONTRACT 12 — THE WORD CURSE SPOKEN OVER YOU

What someone with authority declared about your life.

Includes: "You'll never be anything." "You're just like your father." "I wish you'd never been born." "You ruined my life." "You're too much." "Nobody will ever want you." A teacher, a pastor, a judge, a doctor, a parent.

Why it lands: words from people in authority over a child function as **prophetic declaration** in that child's inner world. You didn't just hear it. **You organized around it.**

☐ Applies. What was said, by whom: _____

CONTRACT 13 — THE RELIGIOUS / SPIRITUAL ABUSE CONTRACT

When the harm came wearing God's name.

Includes: Scripture used to keep you in danger ("submit," "forgive," "don't touch God's anointed," "don't be divisive"), being blamed for your own abuse, purity culture that made you responsible for what was done to you, being told your trauma was a demon and your medication was faithlessness, shunning, spiritual covering as control, tithing under threat, and prophecy used to manipulate.

Why this is the worst one: it poisons the well. You now have to go to the only one who can heal you, through the door that hurt you. **That's the specific cruelty of it, and it is the enemy's masterstroke.**

Hear this: what they did in His name was not Him. Jesus reserved His harshest words on earth for exactly those people — Matthew 23, the whole chapter. Read it when you can stand it. **He is angrier about it than you are.**

☐ Applies. What was done: _____

CONTRACT 14 — THE SHAME COVENANT

The agreement to live hidden.

Guilt says "I did something bad." **Shame says** "I am something bad."

Guilt can be confessed and cleared. **Shame cannot, because it isn't about an act — it's about existence.** That's why you can be forgiven and still feel filthy.

How it functions as a contract: shame's terms are *stay hidden and I'll keep you safe from being seen*. Its enforcement mechanism is **secrecy**. Which is exactly why confession — 1 John 1:7, walking in the light — is the one thing that kills it.

☐ Applies. What I'm most ashamed of: _____

CONTRACT 15 — THE CONTROL CONTRACT

The vow that you will never be helpless again, enforced by managing everything.

Looks like: hypervigilance, planning for disasters, needing to know everything, not delegating, rage when surprised, testing people, not sleeping, managing everyone's emotions, perfectionism.

What it gave you: an illusion of safety. And genuinely — being the one who watches the door probably saved you more than once.

What it costs: you cannot rest, you cannot be loved, and you cannot trust God, because trust requires the one thing the contract forbids.

☐ Applies. Where I control most: _____

CONTRACT 16 — THE PERFORMANCE CONTRACT

"I only exist if I'm useful."

Made by: the child who learned love was payment for labor. The one who parented her parents. The one who was only praised for achievement.

Costs: you cannot receive anything. Grace is unbearable to you because grace is unearned and your contract says unearned means unsafe.

☐ Applies.

CONTRACT 17 — THE SELF-PUNISHMENT CONTRACT

An agreement to pay for what Christ already paid for.

Looks like: self-harm, staying with people who hurt you, sabotaging good things, refusing pleasure, not letting yourself be happy, relapsing after good news, choosing the harder road on purpose, staying poor, staying alone.

The hidden logic: if I punish myself, I control the punishment. Anticipated pain is less terrifying than pain that comes when it wants.

The theology of it: it's a rejection of the cross, made out of love for justice. You want the debt paid. **It was. By Him. You are refusing the receipt.**

☐ Applies. How I punish myself: _____

CONTRACT 18 — THE DEATH WISH / DEATH AGREEMENT

The one people carry silently for decades.

Sounds like: "I don't want to be here." "I've never expected to live long." "It'd be easier if I was gone." "I'm just waiting it out."

Sometimes made in a specific moment. Sometimes made so long ago you don't remember not having it. **It is not a spiritual contract you are trapped in. It is pain speaking, and it deserves a real answer: tell someone safe and get professional support.**

*"I have set before you life and death, blessing and curse. Therefore choose life." —
Deuteronomy 30:19*

Choose is a verb. It's an action available to you today.

If you are in danger right now: call or text 988. Do that before anything else in this book.

☐ Applies. When I made it: _____

CONTRACT 19 — THE SILENCE CONTRACT

"We don't talk about that."

Made by: whole families at once, usually without a word. Enforced by consequence — the one who talks becomes the problem.

Why the enemy loves it most: Revelation 12:11 says they overcame by the blood of the Lamb **and the word of their testimony.** The blood he can't touch. **The testimony he can — by keeping your mouth shut.** Silence is one of the most effective weapons against you, and it's the one your own family may help enforce.

This is why 7HE HOLY R3UP exists. Saying it out loud is part of the fight.

☐ Applies. What we don't talk about: _____

CONTRACT 20 — THE LOYALTY CONTRACT

The agreement to stay bound to your family's dysfunction because leaving it feels like betrayal.

Sounds like: "They did their best." "That's just how we are." "I can't abandon them." "Family is everything."
"Who am I if I'm not this?"

Why it's the hardest to break: breaking it requires you to become the traitor. **You will be called one.** The one who heals gets labeled the one who left.

☐ Applies. Who I'm loyal to at my own cost: _____

CONTRACT 21 — THE FALSE PROTECTION CONTRACT

Anything you took on as a covering because God felt absent.

Includes: superstitions, rituals you invented as a child, objects you can't part with, "energy protection," charms, a saint you prayed to instead of Christ, a person you made into God, a substance that took the edge off, a persona you built to be untouchable.

Every one of these was an attempt to feel safe when nobody was keeping you safe. That's not wicked. It's grief. And it still has to come down, because a false covering keeps the real one out.

☐ Applies. My false covering: _____

CONTRACT 22 — THE AGREEMENT WITH THE ACCUSER

The one where you became his voice.

How you know: the voice in your head that narrates your failures uses *his* vocabulary but *your* volume. You've been finishing his sentences so long you think they're yours.

"The accuser of our brothers has been thrown down." — Revelation 12:10

When you speak against yourself, you are doing the work of a defeated prosecutor for free. That's the whole deal. That's the last contract, and canceling it changes the sound of your own mind.

☐ Applies. What the voice says most: _____

THE TALLY

Number of contracts I identified: _____

The three heaviest:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

The one I almost didn't write down: _____

That one is often the keystone — the one that, once named, changes the most.

4. Soul Contracts: The Truth, the Counterfeit, and What's Actually Real

You asked about soul contracts specifically, so let's be exact, because there are two completely different things going by that name and confusing them will cost you years.

THE NEW AGE VERSION — AND WHY IT'S A TRAP

The popular teaching says: before you were born, your soul **chose** this life, chose your parents, chose your traumas, and signed agreements with other souls to learn lessons. Your abuser and you had a pre-birth agreement. You picked this.

Why people find it comforting: it makes senseless suffering purposeful. It gives you back a feeling of control — you weren't a victim, you were a volunteer.

Why it is spiritually devastating, and this is the part nobody says:

1. **It makes you the author of your own abuse.** It is the most sophisticated form of victim-blaming ever devised, and it wears a soft voice.
2. **It requires you to have pre-existed**, which Scripture does not teach — you were *created*, and God formed you, knew you, and wrote your days (Psalm 139:13–16, Jeremiah 1:5). Known before birth, yes. **Pre-existing and negotiating, no.**
3. **It removes the abuser's guilt.** If it was agreed, there's no crime, no perpetrator, and no justice — and therefore no God who avenges you. It takes your court case away.
4. **It removes the need for a Savior.** If suffering is curriculum, you don't need rescue, you need a better grade.
5. **It cannot comfort you at 3 a.m.** Because in the end it says: this happened, and on some level you wanted it. That is not healing. That's the accuser in a linen shirt.

The truth: you did not sign up for it. It was done to you. It was evil. It was a crime. There is a God who calls it a crime, who has recorded every second of it, and who will settle every account.

Renounce the soul-contract teaching if you took it on:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"In the name of Jesus Christ, I renounce the lie that I chose, agreed to, or signed up for what was done to me. I was created by God, formed by His hands, and what happened to me was a crime against me, not a curriculum for me. I reject that agreement and I return the false comfort. I receive the true comfort — that I was a victim of evil and God is my avenger and my healer."

WHAT IS REAL, AND WHY THE TERM PERSISTS

The reason "soul contract" resonates with survivors is that **something real is happening and that's the only language they've been handed for it.**

What's real is this: **after birth, inside trauma, a child makes promises and decisions in order to survive — and those can keep running a life long after the danger is gone.**

That's Contract 1, 2, 3, and 18 in the catalog above. The Survival Vow. The Identity Agreement. The Self-Curse. The Death Agreement.

What people call a "soul contract" is, in reality, an inner vow: made by your inner self, usually as a child, usually in a single unbearable moment, in order to survive — and never revisited.

That is not pre-birth. It's **age seven, in a closet, deciding something about the world forever.**

The counterfeit teaching	The actual reality
Made before birth	Made during trauma
You chose your suffering	You chose a <i>response</i> to suffering
Purpose: lessons	Purpose: survival
Binding karmically	Shaping you, and changeable with truth, support, and God's help
Removes the criminal	Names the criminal and the wound
Can't be broken, only "completed"	Can be released today — out loud, in Jesus' name, with support

This distinction is the single most liberating thing in Book One. Because the counterfeit says you're serving a sentence you signed. The truth says a terrified child made a promise, and an adult with authority can release her from it.

THE INNER-VOW WORK

This is delicate and it's the deepest excavation in the book.

Find the moment. Not the whole story — the *moment*. The second where something in you decided.

Common vow moments:

- The first time you weren't believed
- The first time nobody came
- The moment you realized they were never going to stop
- The moment you stopped crying because it made it worse
- The moment you decided to be good enough to be safe
- The moment you decided to be bad enough that it wouldn't matter
- The moment you left your own body

WORK: FINDING AND BREAKING INNER VOWS

Vow 1

The moment: _____

My age: _____ Where: _____

What I decided in that moment (write it as a sentence starting with "I will" or "I will never"):

What it protected me from:

What it's cost me since:

Now do this out loud, and speak to the child directly:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"[Your name], age [age] — I see you. You made that promise because you had to. It worked. You survived, and I'm here because of what you did.

I'm an adult now and I'm taking over. You don't have to hold the door anymore.

In the name of Jesus Christ, I release you from that vow. I break it. I renounce it. It is no longer in force in my life.

And here is the new agreement: [state the replacement — 'I will let safe people in and I will learn who is safe.' 'I will feel things and survive feeling them.' 'I will want things.']

Jesus, You were in that room. Come get her. Bring her home."

Repeat for every vow you find. There are usually between three and nine. Take weeks if you need to.

Vow	Age made	Date broken

Vow	Age made	Date broken

5. Soul Ties, Fragments, and Giving Pieces of Yourself Away

WHAT A SOUL TIE ACTUALLY IS

"Soul tie" is not a phrase found in Scripture. It is a name many believers use for a real experience: a deep bond, or a painful hold, between you and another person. Scripture does describe real bonds between people (1 Samuel 18:1; Genesis 2:24; 1 Corinthians 6:16). We use the phrase here as a practical label, not a settled doctrine.

A soul tie, in this sense, is a **bond between two people** — mind, will, emotion, identity — formed by covenant, sex, trauma, deep loyalty, or vow.

Godly ties exist and are good: David and Jonathan, "the soul of Jonathan was knit to the soul of David" (1 Samuel 18:1). Marriage. Real spiritual family. **Don't cut these.**

Ungodly ties are the ones formed outside of covenant or inside violation.

HOW IT CAN SHOW UP

- You can't stop thinking about someone you don't even want
- You feel them — mood, presence, when something's wrong
- Dreams about them for years
- Physical reaction to their name
- You keep going back with no rational reason
- You feel like part of you is missing and it has their shape
- You can't move on romantically because someone from 1998 still has a chair in the room
- You feel loyal to someone who harmed you

These are also common after trauma and attachment wounds, and a counselor can help you sort out what is what. They are not proof that something spiritual is going on.

WHERE TIES COME FROM

Source	Notes
Sexual union	Any, all, including one time
Sexual violation	Not your sin. It can still leave a hold.
Trafficking / exploitation	Multiple, often with people you never knew
Trauma bonding	Abuser, captor, the person who cycled you
Marriage	Godly — but after divorce or abuse, the <i>ungodly parts</i> need cutting while honoring what was real

Source	Notes
Deep friendship / enmeshment	Codependency, a parent who made you their spouse emotionally
Vows and oaths	"I'll always be yours," blood-sister pacts, gang oaths
Shared sin	The person you used with, stole with, lied with
Pornography	Ties to strangers and to images
Unresolved grief	A bond to the dead that keeps you from living — real, and gentle to loosen
Spiritual authority misused	A pastor, leader, or "covering" who bound you to them instead of to Christ

THE FRAGMENTATION QUESTION — HANDLED CAREFULLY

Survivors describe "losing pieces of myself." Language matters here, so here's the honest version, in both registers, because both are true:

Psychologically: dissociation is real and well documented. Under unbearable threat, the mind compartmentalizes — memory, emotion, and identity get separated so the unbearable part can be held somewhere you don't have to live. This is a survival genius, not a defect. At its extreme it's DID and it deserves a trained trauma therapist, not just prayer. **Get one if that's you. That is not a lack of faith.**

Spiritually: those compartments are places that never got brought to God. Not lost souls — **rooms in your house nobody's opened in thirty years.** Parts of you frozen at the age they were left, still holding the vow, still bracing.

The prayer isn't "reassemble my soul like a puzzle." The prayer is:

PRAYER

"Lord, every part of me that got left behind, that is still standing in that room, at that age, holding that moment — I invite You in there. Go get her. Bring her into today. Let every part of me be gathered, present, and whole in Your presence. Nothing of me stays in that house."

Beware the counterfeit here. Soul retrieval, shamanic journeying, past-life regression, and "calling back your fragments" through ritual are Contract 7. The need is real. **That method opens a door.** Take the need to Christ.

THE CUTTING (RELEASING THE HOLD) — DO THIS THOROUGHLY

Make the list. Every name you can remember. Write "unknown" for the ones you can't, and be specific about the context.

Name / description	Type of tie	Date cut

Name / description	Type of tie	Date cut

The prayer, said for each one by name:

PRAYER

"Father, I come before You. I acknowledge the tie between me and [name].

[If it was your sin:] I confess my part and receive Your forgiveness. [If it was done to you:] I acknowledge this was done to me. It was not my sin. I still take authority over it now.

In the name of Jesus Christ and by the power of His blood, I release my hold on [name] and ask You to loosen every unhealthy bond between us — spirit, soul, and body.

I return to [name] everything of theirs I have carried: their shame, their sin, their words, their judgments, their hold. **It goes back. I do not keep it.**

And I call back to myself everything of mine they took or held: my body, my innocence, my voice, my name, my peace, my mind, my future, my sexuality, my identity. **In Jesus' name, it comes home to me now.**

Holy Spirit, fill the place where that tie was. Seal it with the blood of Jesus. Amen."

Physical acts help. Bodies need markers. Burn the letters. Throw out the jewelry. Delete the photos. Give away the clothes. Change the sheets. Move the bed. Clean the room. **Do something your body can witness.**

6. Words That Bind

Scripture takes words seriously. God created by speaking. Jesus healed by speaking. Blessings are spoken. Vows are spoken. **Your words carry weight.**

*"Death and life are in the power of the tongue, and those who love it will eat its fruits." —
Proverbs 18:21*

THE FIVE KINDS OF WORDS THAT BIND

- 1. Vows** — a binding self-promise. "I will never..." (Numbers 30; Matthew 5:34–37, where Jesus says stop swearing oaths at all — partly because **you cannot deliver on them and they bind you.**)
- 2. Curses** — a declaration of harm over a person. Real, and real when spoken by parents, leaders, and those with authority. Proverbs 26:2 says a causeless curse "does not alight." Words spoken against you by people with authority can wound deeply, but Scripture gives no reason to think a causeless curse has power over someone who belongs to Christ.
- 3. Oaths and pacts** — agreements sworn, sometimes with blood, sometimes in a ritual, sometimes in a gang, a lodge, a fraternity, a marriage to the wrong person, a pact with a friend at fourteen.
- 4. Agreements** — the quiet ones. "Yeah, that's just me." Every time you nod along to a lie about yourself, you strengthen it.
- 5. Declarations and prophecy** — words spoken with spiritual weight over your future. **True prophecy builds. False prophecy binds.** If a "word" over you produced fear, obligation, or dependence on the speaker, it was not from God.

THE FULL BREAKING — SAY IT OUT LOUD

PRAYER

"Father, I take responsibility for my words and I ask You to deal with the words of others.

I break every vow I have made: [list each one out loud — "I will never trust anyone," "I will never need help," "I will never cry," every one you found in Chapter 4.] I renounce them. They are broken in Jesus' name.

I break every curse spoken over me by parents, family, leaders, teachers, partners, enemies, or strangers — every declaration of failure, death, poverty, worthlessness, or shame. [Say the specific ones.] I return those words to the ground they came from. They will not land on me. They have no ground here.

I renounce every oath and pact I entered — spoken, sworn, written, sealed in blood, or entered in ritual. [Name them.] I revoke them all. They are canceled by the blood of Jesus.

I break every agreement I made with a lie about who I am. [Name them.] I withdraw my signature.

I renounce every false prophecy and manipulative word spoken over me in God's name that was not from Him. It falls to the ground.

And I curse no one. Where I have spoken death over another person — my parents, my abuser, my children, myself — I repent and I retract it. I bless where I cursed.

Now let my mouth be an instrument of life. Set a guard over it. In Jesus' name. Amen."

BUILDING THE REPLACEMENT VOCABULARY

You have decades of practice speaking death. You need practice speaking life.

Ten declarations — say these out loud daily for 30 days. This is not positive thinking. It's putting your words to work on the right side.

1. I am bought with a price and I belong to God. (1 Cor 6:20)
2. There is no condemnation for me. (Rom 8:1)
3. I am a new creation. The old is gone. (2 Cor 5:17)
4. No weapon formed against me shall succeed. (Isa 54:17)
5. God gave me a spirit not of fear but of power and love and self-control. (2 Tim 1:7)
6. He who is in me is greater than he who is in the world. (1 John 4:4)
7. I am seated with Christ in heavenly places. (Eph 2:6)
8. I overcome by the blood of the Lamb and the word of my testimony. (Rev 12:11)
9. What was meant for evil, God is turning for good. (Gen 50:20)
10. I choose life. (Deut 30:19)

7. Blood, Bodies, and Why What Happened Physically Mattered Spiritually

Nobody talks about this and survivors need it.

YOUR BODY IS NOT A CONTAINER. IT'S A TEMPLE.

"Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit within you, whom you have from God?" – 1 Corinthians 6:19

Which means what was done to your body was not done to an object. **It was a desecration of a holy place.** That's why it feels like sacrilege. It was.

And it means: God does not consider your body ruined. A desecrated temple in Scripture doesn't get demolished. **It gets cleansed and rededicated.** That's Hezekiah. That's Josiah. That's Nehemiah. The consistent biblical response to a defiled holy place is not abandonment — it's restoration and reconsecration.

Your body is not ruined. It is a temple awaiting rededication.

BLOOD MATTERS

Blood carries covenant in Scripture — "the life of the flesh is in the blood" (Leviticus 17:11). This is why blood rituals exist in the occult; it's a counterfeit of something real.

Which means if blood was involved in what happened to you — your blood, ritual, injury, a pact, a cutting, a painful loss, a violent assault — **it mattered, and it was seen.** That's not something to be terrified of. It's something to bring to the One whose sprinkled blood speaks a better word (Hebrews 12:24).

And there is only one answer, and it outranks everything:

"How much more will the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself without blemish to God, purify our conscience from dead works." – Hebrews 9:14

The blood of Jesus is the highest covenant blood there is. Every other blood claim is subordinate. Every ritual, every pact, every violence done in blood is answered and outranked by Calvary. Not equaled. **Outranked.**

THE REDEDICATION OF THE BODY

Do this out loud. Stand if you can. Put your hands on yourself — head, throat, chest, stomach, hips, hands, feet — as you go.

PRAYER

"Father, this body is Yours. You formed it in secret and You called it fearfully and wonderfully made, and You have not changed Your mind.

What was done to this body was done against Your temple and against Your will. I put it in Your hands and not in the hands of anyone who took it.

I renounce every claim any person has made on this body. I renounce every ownership spoken over it. I renounce every name given to it that was not from You. I renounce the word 'ruined,' 'used,' 'dirty,' 'worthless,' and 'damaged goods.'

By the blood of Jesus Christ I cleanse this temple. I rededicate every part of it to You:

My head — my mind is Yours. **My eyes** — what they saw, and what they see now. **My mouth** — what was forced and what I said, and what I'll say now. **My throat** — my voice comes back. **My hands** — what they did and what they'll build. **My chest** — my heart is Yours to guard. **My stomach** — where I hold the dread. Take it. **My womb / my sex / my body** — the place they went. It is Yours, it is holy, and it is not theirs. **My legs and feet** — where I go from here. **My skin** — every mark, every scar, every place I hurt myself. Yours.

This is a temple. It is clean. It is Yours. It is not for sale and it never was.

In Jesus' name. Amen."

Then do something physical. Shower deliberately. Anoint yourself with oil. Put on something new. Eat something good. **Let your body have evidence.**

8. Generational Curses: The Full Mechanics

THE APPARENT CONTRADICTION, RESOLVED

Verses that say it transfers:

"I the LORD your God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children to the third and the fourth generation." — Exodus 20:5 "Our fathers sinned, and are no more, and we bear their iniquities." — Lamentations 5:7

Verses that say it doesn't:

"The soul who sins shall die. The son shall not suffer for the iniquity of the father." — Ezekiel 18:20 "Everyone shall die for his own sin." — Jeremiah 31:30 "Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us." — Galatians 3:13

Both are true. Here is the resolution, and it's the most practically important theology in this entire book:

Guilt does not transfer. Terrain does.

You are not guilty of your grandfather's sin. You will not be judged for it. **But you inherited the ground it was committed on** — the pattern, the wound, the modeling, the biology, the poverty, the open door, and the unrevoked agreement.

Think of it like a house. Your great-grandfather made a deal and left the back door unlocked. You didn't make the deal. You're not guilty of the deal. **But you live in the house, and that door is still unlocked, and things have been walking in for four generations because nobody went and shut it.**

"Third and fourth generation" is not a sentence. It's a description of how long a pattern runs when nobody intervenes. And Exodus 20:6 — the very next verse — says His steadfast love reaches **thousands** of those who love Him (Deuteronomy 7:9 says a thousand generations). The mercy outruns the consequence by a wide margin.

THE FOUR TRANSMISSION LAYERS — ALL REAL, ALL AT ONCE

LAYER 1 — BEHAVIORAL (you learned it) You absorbed conflict style, coping, emotional regulation, relational patterns, what "normal" is. A child raised in chaos has chaos as their baseline nervous-system setting. You do not have to be taught this — you have to be *untaught* it.

LAYER 2 — BIOLOGICAL (epigenetics) This is an active area of research. Studies of Holocaust survivors' descendants and other groups suggest severe stress can leave marks on stress-hormone regulation that show up in the next generation. Scientists are still working out how much, and how, and it is not destiny. **Your baseline may have been shaped by more than your own story.** You may have inherited a nervous system already on alert.

This is why "just decide to be different" fails. You're not fighting a choice. You're fighting installed hardware. It's changeable — the brain is plastic and so is expression — but it changes at the speed of practice, not the speed of decision.

LAYER 3 — SYSTEMIC (the walls are real) Poverty, incarceration, no education, no assets, no networks, geography, addiction-dense environments, CPS involvement. These are not spiritual failures. They're structures, and they compound. Naming them keeps you from blaming yourself for physics.

LAYER 4 — SPIRITUAL (unrevoked access) A covenant, oath, dedication, occult practice, curse, or unrepented pattern that granted legal ground and was never canceled. Some believers point to this layer to explain why the same thing shows up in a family **even when circumstances change completely** — the cousin raised in a good home who ends up the same way. Behavior and biology explain a lot of that. Whether there is also a spiritual layer, and how it works, is something Christians discuss, and Scripture gives us less detail than we may want. Hold it with humility.

THE COMMON BLOODLINE PATTERNS — CHECK YOURS

- ☐ Addiction (any form)
- ☐ Alcoholism specifically
- ☐ Sexual sin, promiscuity, incest, molestation running in the line
- ☐ Physical violence / rage
- ☐ Abandonment — fathers who leave, mothers who check out
- ☐ Early or violent death
- ☐ Suicide
- ☐ Mental illness
- ☐ Chronic poverty / inability to keep money
- ☐ Infidelity
- ☐ Incarceration
- ☐ Occult or "family gifts"
- ☐ Religious control or extremism
- ☐ Betrayal — family members turning on each other
- ☐ Secrets — the family that doesn't talk
- ☐ Trafficking or exploitation in the line
- ☐ Children removed by the state, generation after generation

Illness, infertility, pregnancy loss, and accidents are griefs to be carried with comfort — not proof of a curse, and not anyone's failure.

THE BLOODLINE MAP — FILL THIS IN

	Addiction	Abuse	Sexual	Death/suicide	Mental illness	Poverty	Abandon	Occult	Rage	Prison	Secrets
My children											
ME											

	Addiction	Abuse	Sexual	Death/suicide	Mental illness	Poverty	Abandon	Occult	Rage	Prison	Secrets
Siblings											
Mother											
Father											
Mat. grandmother											
Mat. grandfather											
Pat. grandmother											
Pat. grandfather											
Great-grands											

Patterns with 3+ generations marked:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Patterns that have already reached the generation after me:

That's why this is worth doing — for you, and for whoever comes after you.

IDENTIFICATIONAL REPENTANCE — THE BIBLICAL BASIS AND THE ACTUAL PRAYER

This is a practice many believers have never heard of.

Biblical precedent:

- **Daniel 9** — Daniel confesses Israel's sins across generations, using "we," for sins he personally did not commit. He was righteous. He still stood in the gap.
- **Nehemiah 1:6** — "I and my father's house have sinned."
- **Leviticus 26:40** — "they shall confess their iniquity **and the iniquity of their fathers.**" It's a command with a built-in mechanism.
- **Ezra 9, Isaiah 6:5, Ezekiel 22:30** — "I sought for a man among them who should build up the wall and stand in the breach before me for the land."

You are not taking on their guilt. You are agreeing with God about what is true, as someone who belongs to that family, and asking Him to do what only He can do. Many believers find this meaningful. It is not a requirement for your freedom, and it is not a magic formula. If it does not sit right with you, skip it and talk with a pastor you trust.

Pray this once per pattern, out loud, by name:

PRAYER

"Father God, I come before You as a member of the [family name] bloodline, through the blood of Jesus Christ.

I stand in the gap for my family line. I do not defend us. I do not excuse us. I do not hide us anymore.

I confess and agree with You that [pattern] has run in this bloodline for generations. I confess the specific sins connected to it: [name what you know — the violence, the using, the abandonment, the occult, the abuse, the silence].

I confess my own agreement with it and my own participation in it: [be specific].

On the basis of the blood of Jesus Christ, which is enough, I ask Your forgiveness for this bloodline.

Now I take authority. In the name of Jesus Christ: — I bring to the cross every covenant, vow, oath, pact, dedication, and agreement made by anyone in my bloodline that has shaped us for harm. Known and unknown. I ask You to cancel their hold. — I renounce every word curse spoken in and over this family. — I break the power of [pattern] over my life, my body, my mind, my marriage, my finances, my home, and my children. — I nail this whole thing to the cross of Jesus Christ, and I declare it canceled — Colossians 2:14.

Jesus, I place myself, my children, and my family line under Your protection. Anything that is not from You — any lie, pattern, or influence that has run through [pattern] — I resist in Your name. Do not let it pass on to my children.

Holy Spirit, fill this line. Establish a new pattern starting with me. Let it be recorded in heaven that it **stopped here.**

In Jesus' name. Amen."

Pattern	Date renounced	What changed after

AND THEN — THE PART NOBODY DOES

Prayer closes the door. It does not build the house.

You must replace the behavior, because you still don't know how to do the thing you were never shown. **This is where people who "did deliverance" end up back in the same place a year later and conclude it didn't work.** It worked. They just never learned the new behavior.

Pattern	The behavior I inherited	The new behavior	Who will model it for me	Practice this week

You cannot imagine your way into a pattern you have never seen. Find someone who does it right — money, marriage, parenting, anger, rest, boundaries — and get close enough to watch. That's discipleship. That's the missing half.

9. Territorial, Institutional, and Corporate Bondage

Not everything attached to you is about you. Some of it is about **where you are and what you're part of.**

Territorial — Daniel 10:13,20 names "the prince of Persia" and "the prince of Greece," spiritual entities associated with regions. Ephesians 6:12 names "cosmic powers over this present darkness." This is why certain towns, certain buildings, certain neighborhoods have a *feel*. Why a particular area has generational patterns that don't track with the individuals in it.

Institutional — systems can be captured. A church, a family business, a rehab, a police department, a court, a school. When a system's operating agreement is built on control, secrecy, or exploitation, it develops a spiritual character. **That's how good individuals inside a bad institution can still produce harm.** And it's why leaving an institution sometimes produces immediate relief you can feel in your body.

Corporate — what happened to a whole people. Slavery, genocide, displacement, the reservation, the famine, the war, the camp. This is real inherited trauma at scale, with all four transmission layers running.

WHAT YOU DO ABOUT IT

You're not called to fight a principality over a city by yourself, and anyone who tells you to is going to get you hurt.

What you DO have authority over:

- Your own person
- Your home and property
- Your family and children
- What you agree with
- What you participate in

The practical work:

- ☐ **Dedicate your home out loud.** Walk every room. Anoint the doorframes if you want a marker. "This house belongs to Jesus Christ. Nothing here has permission to stay that He did not invite."
- ☐ **Remove objects with ties.** Occult items, things from the old life, gifts from an abuser, anything you kept as a trophy or a talisman, anything you can't explain why you still have. **If you hesitate, that's information.**
- ☐ **Renounce your participation** in any institution or system you agreed with that was corrupt. "I renounce my agreement with [it]. I withdraw my consent."
- ☐ **Change your inputs.** What you watch, hear, scroll, and replay is a diet, and diets build bodies.
- ☐ **Know when to leave.** Sometimes the deliverance is a U-Haul. Some places you will never get free inside of. That is not failure. Lot was told to leave and not look back, and the looking back is what killed his wife.

10. The Things Nobody Will Talk About

You asked for everything. Here's everything.

1. SOME OF WHAT HAPPENED TO YOU WAS DONE BY PEOPLE WHO WILL NEVER BE PUNISHED ON EARTH.

They will die comfortable. People will speak well of them at the funeral. **That is real and it is not the end of the story** — Chapter 26 handles it. But nobody should lie to you and say earthly justice is coming. Sometimes it isn't.

2. YOU MAY HAVE LIKED PARTS OF IT.

The attention. The specialness. The high. The power you had in one moment. The relief. **The body can respond to what the soul is horrified by, and that does not make you complicit.** Arousal is not consent. Enjoyment of a groomer's attention is not participation. A nine-year-old who liked being chosen was a nine-year-old who needed to be chosen by somebody. **The adult exploited that need. The need was not the sin.**

3. YOU DID THINGS TOO.

Some of you hurt people. Some of you were the dangerous one for a while. Some of you brought your children into it. Some of you did things to survive that you cannot say out loud. **This is real guilt, not false guilt, and it is forgivable — completely.** Not excused. **Paid for.** Paul persecuted believers and approved of their deaths, and went on to write much of the New Testament. David had a man killed to take his wife and is still called a man after God's heart. **The blood covers actual crimes, or it covers nothing.**

4. SOME OF YOUR FAMILY KNEW AND DID NOTHING.

And that is often worse than the abuser, and nobody validates it. The bystander wound is its own wound. **Name it.**

5. YOU MAY NEVER GET THE APOLOGY.

They may be dead. They may be lying. They may genuinely not remember. They may gaslight you until you die. **Your freedom cannot be contingent on their confession, because that hands them the key one more time.**

6. HEALING IS NOT LINEAR AND YOU WILL "LOSE" THINGS YOU ALREADY WON.

You'll be fine for eight months and then flatten for a week. **That's not relapse of the soul. That's healing in layers,** and each pass goes deeper than the last. You are not back at the start. You're on a spiral, not a circle.

7. SOME PEOPLE PREFER YOU BROKEN.

Your role was load-bearing for somebody. When you heal, they will resist — and it won't look like malice, it'll look like concern. "You've changed." "You've gotten cold." "You think you're better than us."

8. GOD DOES NOT ALWAYS REMOVE THE THING.

Paul asked three times. He got "my grace is sufficient" and a thorn he kept. **Sometimes the deliverance is strength to carry it, and that is not a lesser answer**, though it will not feel that way for a long time.

9. YOUR MEDICATION IS NOT A LACK OF FAITH.

Anyone who tells you to come off psychiatric medication as a spiritual act is giving dangerous advice. Luke was a physician. **Deliverance does not cancel dosage.**

10. YOU MIGHT BE ANGRY AT GOD FOR YEARS.

And He can take it. Job accused God to His face for 37 chapters and God's verdict at the end was that **Job had spoken rightly** about Him — and that his pious friends with the correct theology had not. **God prefers your honest rage to polite distance.**

11. DELIVERANCE WITHOUT DISCIPLESHIP IS A REVOLVING DOOR.

Luke 11:24–26. The house swept and empty gets reoccupied, worse. **This is why people get delivered at a conference and are worse in six months.** They were emptied and never filled. Never skip the filling.

12. SOME "SPIRITUAL WARFARE" IS A THYROID, A TRAUMA LOOP, OR A MARRIAGE.

Binding a spirit that is actually a vitamin D deficiency will exhaust you and then convince you God doesn't answer. **Discernment is love. Sort it.**

13. YOU MAY HAVE BEEN THE PERPETRATOR OF THE VERY THING DONE TO YOU.

It's one of the most common and most silenced realities there is. Hurt cycles. **It can stop, it can be forgiven, and it must be told to someone safe. If a child is currently at risk, protecting them comes before your privacy — always, no exceptions.**

14. LOSING SOMEONE TO ADDICTION OR SUICIDE HAS ITS OWN HELL.

It's grief plus guilt plus rage plus the horror of having seen it coming. And the people around you will say the exact wrong thing forever. **You did not kill them. You were not their God. That job was never yours and was never in your hands.**

15. THE ENEMY'S BEST MOVE IS TO MAKE YOU THINK YOU'RE THE EXCEPTION.

That grace has a line and you're past it. That everybody else can be free. **That thought is not conviction. It's the accuser doing his only job, and he's been doing it in your voice.**

16. BEING CHOSEN DOES NOT MEAN BEING PROTECTED FROM CONSEQUENCES.

You can be called and still wreck your life. Moses didn't enter the land. David's family never recovered. **Calling is not immunity. Obedience still matters at 40 as much as at 20.**

17. CHURCH WILL HURT YOU AGAIN.

Probably. **And you still need people**, because isolation is the enemy's whole endgame. The answer isn't no church. It's discernment about which one, with boundaries, with your eyes open, and with a willingness to leave without losing God.

18. SOME DOORS YOU CLOSED WILL GET KNOCKED ON FOR THE REST OF YOUR LIFE.

Not because you failed. Because it's the known address. **A knock is not a break-in. You don't have to answer the door.**

19. WHAT WAS DONE TO YOU MAY HAVE BEEN LITERALLY RITUAL.

Some of you have memories that don't fit the accepted categories — robes, chanting, multiple people, symbols, things done to you on a date. This is spoken about so rarely that survivors conclude they're insane. **You're not automatically insane, and you're also not required to resolve every memory to be free.** Get a trauma-trained therapist who will not lead you, work slowly, and know this: **you do not need to remember everything perfectly to pray or to heal.** "Everything done to me, known and unknown, I bring to You" is enough. God knows what your memory cannot hold.

20. YOU ARE GOING TO WANT TO QUIT THIS WORKBOOK.

Right about the middle. That urge is common, and it often means you have reached something that matters. **Slow down instead of quitting: rest, then come back.**

BOOK TWO

The Enemy's Complete Playbook

THE HOLY R3UP

11. Who He Is and What He Actually Can't Do

Before the plan, the limits. **Fear is his main currency, and accurate information is how you stop paying.**

WHAT HE IS

A created being. Christian tradition reads Isaiah 14:12–15 and Ezekiel 28:12–17 (originally oracles against the kings of Babylon and Tyre) as also echoing the fall of a proud angel; the clearest New Testament glimpses are Luke 10:18 and Revelation 12:9. Either way: created, limited, already judged, waiting for the sentence to be carried out.

His names tell you his methods:

- **Satan** — adversary, opponent
- **Devil** (*diabolos*) — slanderer
- **The accuser** — Revelation 12:10
- **The father of lies** — John 8:44. "When he lies, he speaks his native language."
- **The thief** — John 10:10. Steal, kill, destroy. That's the whole job description.
- **The tempter** — Matthew 4:3
- **The deceiver of the whole world** — Revelation 12:9
- **Angel of light** — 2 Corinthians 11:14. **His most effective costume is a good one.**
- **The prince of the power of the air** — Ephesians 2:2
- **A roaring lion seeking to devour** — 1 Peter 5:8. Roaring. Noise. Intimidation.

WHAT HE CANNOT DO — MEMORIZE THIS LIST

He cannot	Because
Be everywhere at once	He's a creature, not God. He's not omnipresent. His organization is, in a limited way; he is not.
Read your thoughts	Only God knows the heart — 1 Kings 8:39, Jeremiah 17:10. Scripture never says he can — though anyone who has watched a life for years can guess at patterns. That's one more reason to build healthier ones.
Create anything	He can only counterfeit, corrupt, and pervert what God made. Every single thing he offers is a knockoff of something real.
Act outside God's permitted limits	Job 1:12, 2:6 — explicit boundaries, twice. He asked. He was restricted. He obeyed the restriction.
Take you from God's hand	John 10:28–29. "No one will snatch them out of my hand."
Separate you from God's love	Romans 8:38–39 — not angels, not rulers, not powers, not anything.
Win	Revelation 20:10. The end is written. He's read it.
Forgive, heal, or give life	He has no positive capacity whatsoever. Everything he offers costs more than it gives.

He cannot	Because
Force you	He can tempt, deceive, pressure, and exploit. He cannot make you agree. The agreement is always the hinge, and the agreement is always yours.

WHAT HE CAN DO — BE SOBER ABOUT IT

- Tempt and deceive
- Accuse — to God, to others, and inside your own head in your own voice
- Exploit existing wounds and open doors
- Afflict the body within limits (Job; the woman bent over 18 years, Luke 13:11)
- Oppress, harass, torment
- Influence systems, institutions, and cultures
- Blind minds to the gospel — 2 Corinthians 4:4
- Send counterfeit spiritual experience, including miracles and "peace"
- Organize. There's structure and strategy. **He's patient and he plays long.**

THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT STRATEGIC FACT

He is not fighting to win. He already lost. Colossians 2:15, past tense, disarmed and publicly humiliated.

He is fighting to make the win cost you everything, and to take as many with him as he can on the way to the pit.

That reframes your whole situation. You are not in a war whose outcome is undecided. **You are in a mop-up operation against an enemy who knows he's finished and is burning the countryside out of spite.**

12. The Twelve-Stage Plan – From Your Birth to Your Grave

A note before this chapter: this is a pattern-recognition tool, not a revealed schedule. Scripture says we are not to be ignorant of the enemy's designs (2 Corinthians 2:11), and it also says much of our trouble comes from our own hearts, other people, and a broken world. The stages are drawn from what Scripture warns about and from what survivors report. They are interpretation. Use them to notice patterns — never to decide that every hard thing in your life was a scripted attack, and never to blame yourself for what was done to you.

Here are twelve patterns that keep showing up in the lives of people who have been hurt and stuck. Read them and see where you recognize yourself — seeing a pattern on paper takes some of its power.

STAGE 1 — INTERCEPT BEFORE ARRIVAL

Goal: prevent you from existing or being received.

Tactics: attempts on the pregnancy. Being unwanted. Being a "mistake," an "accident," the result of assault. Chaos surrounding your birth. Illness. Being born into active addiction, incarceration, or violence. Being told the story of how inconvenient your arrival was.

Biblical pattern: Pharaoh's order to kill the Hebrew infants when Moses was born. Herod's slaughter of the infants when Christ was born. **Both times, a mass attack on a generation because one child was coming.** That's the template.

What got installed: "I shouldn't be here." "My existence is a problem." "I have to justify taking up space."

☐ This happened to me. How: _____

STAGE 2 — BREAK THE FOUNDATION

Goal: damage you before you can defend yourself, so the damage is structural, not cosmetic.

Why early: a wound at twenty-five is in the walls. A wound at four is in the **foundation** — it bends every floor above it.

Tactics: abuse before memory. Neglect in infancy. An absent or terrifying father, which pre-loads your view of God. A mother who couldn't attach. Chaos as your baseline. Being the family's scapegoat from the crib. Molestation by someone trusted. Watching violence.

What got installed: the world is unsafe, love is conditional, adults will not protect me, my needs are dangerous, and **I am alone.**

☐ Applies. What happened before I was ten: _____

STAGE 3 — STEAL IDENTITY AND ASSIGN A FALSE NAME

Goal: make you believe you are something you are not, because everything downstream flows from identity.

This is his central play. **If he can get your identity, he doesn't need to manage your behavior — you'll manage it for him.**

Tactics: labels from family. Being compared. Being named after the pattern ("you're just like your father"). Being defined by your worst moment. Being called the bad one, the crazy one, the slut, the burden, the strong one, the problem. Being assigned a role — scapegoat, golden child, caretaker, invisible one.

Biblical counter: God renames people constantly. Abram → Abraham. Jacob (deceiver) → Israel (wrestles with God). Simon → Peter (rock). Gideon, hiding in a winepress, is greeted as "mighty man of valor." **God's name for you is spoken to who you will be, not who you've been.** Satan's name for you is spoken to your worst hour and frozen there.

What he wants: you to introduce yourself with his name.

- ☐ Applies. The name I was given: _____
 - What I believe God calls me:** _____
-

STAGE 4 — ISOLATE

Goal: remove every witness, protector, and reality check.

Isolation precedes almost every serious harm. Abusers isolate. Traffickers isolate. Addiction isolates. Cults isolate. **A lion cuts one animal out of the herd. Same tactic, same reason.**

Tactics: discredit you to your family so nobody believes you. Make you the difficult one. Move you. Take your phone, your car, your money. Convince you nobody will understand. Shame you into silence. Give you a secret. Make your only community the one that's harming you. And later — make you push away everyone who tries to help, so the isolation looks like your choice.

The genius of it: by the end, **you enforce your own isolation.** He doesn't have to hold the door anymore.

Counter: Ecclesiastes 4:9–12. Two are better than one, and a cord of three strands isn't easily broken. Hebrews 10:25. **Community is not a nice-to-have. It's armor.**

- ☐ Applies. Who I lost or pushed away: _____
-

STAGE 5 — INSTALL THE COPING MECHANISM

Goal: hand you a solution that becomes the next problem.

This is the most elegant move in the whole plan. **He doesn't tempt you with evil. He offers you relief.**

How it goes: you're in unbearable pain. Nobody's coming. Something takes the edge off — a drink, a pill, a person, a knife, food, sex, work, control, rage, achievement, religion-as-performance. **It works.** Genuinely. The first time, it is the first relief you've had in years.

And that's the hook: it worked. You are not stupid for going back. You went back **because it worked.** Then the price started climbing and by the time it cost more than it gave, you weren't choosing anymore.

What he gets: a self-sustaining problem. He can walk away. The coping mechanism does his job on salary.

- ☐ Applies. What I was handed: _____
 - **What it was actually medicating:** _____
-

STAGE 6 — CREATE THE SHAME LOOP

Goal: make the solution to the pain generate more pain, so the cycle runs on its own fuel forever.

The mechanism: Pain → cope → temporary relief → consequences → **shame** → more pain → cope harder →

Notice: **shame is the engine.** Pain alone would eventually push you toward help. Shame pushes you away from help. Shame says *don't tell anybody, you're disgusting, they'll leave, you deserve this.*

Why it's his best work: it converts your own conscience into a weapon. Your desire to be good becomes the thing that keeps you bad. **He uses your best quality against you.**

Counter: 1 John 1:7,9 and James 5:16. **Confession breaks the loop at the shame link** — the one place it's breakable. That's why telling one person the truth is Step 1 of every roadmap in this book.

- ☐ Applies. Where my loop spins: _____
-

STAGE 7 — GET AGREEMENTS AND SIGNATURES

Goal: convert your pain into legal ground.

Now that you're isolated, coping, and ashamed, you'll start signing. He's been waiting for this.

What he collects: the survival vows. The self-curses. The death wish. The identity agreements. Bitterness against God. The sexual ties. The occult contact you reach for because nothing else answered. The "I'll never" and the "I'll always."

Why now: a person in pain will sign anything. **He doesn't ask you for your soul when you're well. He asks in the worst hour of your life, and he asks in a voice that sounds like your own conclusion.**

Every contract in Chapter 3 is collected here.

- ☐ Applies. What I signed and when: _____
-

STAGE 8 — NORMALIZE

Goal: make it invisible.

A visible prison gets escaped. **A prison you think is a house gets decorated.**

Tactics: everyone around you lives the same way. This is just how our family is. This is the neighborhood. Everybody drinks. Everybody's like this. You compare yourself to worse and feel fine. You develop dark humor about it. You build an identity on it — and then defending the prison feels like defending yourself.

How you know you're here: you get offended when someone suggests it's not normal.

- ☐ Applies. What I've normalized: _____

STAGE 9 — MULTIPLY AND RECRUIT

Goal: get you carrying the plan for him, to the next generation.

How: your children learn what you model. Your unhealed wound becomes your parenting style. You reproduce what was done to you — usually in a modified, "better" form that's still the same shape. You bring people into your addiction. You become the abuser, or you marry one and give your kids the same childhood you had.

This is where a family pattern gets passed on. It doesn't automatically continue. **It continues when it goes unnamed and untreated — and it can stop when someone names it and gets help.**

The grief of this stage is the worst grief in the book. Looking at your kid and seeing your mother. It's also the most powerful motivator to break it, so don't look away.

- ☐ Applies. What I've passed on: _____
- This is what I'm stopping.**

STAGE 10 — ATTACK THE CALLING SPECIFICALLY

Goal: neutralize the assignment.

If you're carrying something — and you are, or you wouldn't have gotten this far into this book — the attack gets **targeted**. Full treatment in Chapter 13.

Tactics: destroy your credibility before you have a platform. Get you disqualified. Sexual sin. Money. Pride. Burnout. Make you famous before you're formed. Make you bitter at the church. Make you correct and unbearable. Isolate you in the gap between healed and polished. Make you quit right before the turn.

- ☐ Applies. How my calling is being attacked: _____

STAGE 11 — RUN OUT THE CLOCK

Goal: if he can't destroy you, waste you.

This is the stage nobody names and the one that gets the most people. **He doesn't need you to fall. He needs you to spend forty years processing and never build anything.**

Tactics: endless healing that never becomes usefulness. Perpetual "not ready yet." Conferences instead of obedience. Journaling the same wound for a decade. Waiting for a feeling. Waiting for the family to apologize. Waiting to be fully healed before you help anybody. Comfort. Distraction. Scrolling. Being busy with things that don't matter.

Why it works so well on survivors: it looks like humility and it feels like wisdom.

The counter is brutal and simple: do it wounded. Paul had the thorn the whole time. **You will never be fully healed before you're useful, and being useful is part of how you heal.**

☐ Applies. What I'm waiting for that's never coming: _____

STAGE 12 — TAKE THE TESTIMONY

Goal: if you get free anyway, keep you quiet.

His last move, and his most desperate.

*"And they have conquered him by the blood of the Lamb and by the word of their testimony." —
Revelation 12:11*

Two weapons. He cannot touch the blood. **So everything comes down to your mouth.**

Tactics: shame ("if they knew"). Fear ("they'll come after you"). Family loyalty ("you'll destroy your mother"). False humility ("it's not about me"). Perfectionism ("wait till I have it all together"). Legal threats. The internal voice that says **nobody wants to hear it, it's not that bad, others had it worse, who are you to speak.**

Understand what this means: the intensity of the pressure on you to stay silent is a direct measure of how dangerous your voice is. **He is not afraid of your healing. He's afraid of your report.**

Which is exactly why this book exists, and why 7HE HOLY R3UP exists, and why you're going to open your mouth.

☐ Applies. What keeps me quiet: _____

THE PLAN, IN ONE LINE

Intercept → break early → rename → isolate → medicate → shame → get signatures → normalize → multiply → target the calling → waste the years → silence the testimony.

AND HERE'S WHAT'S TRUE ABOUT ALL TWELVE

Every stage grows in secrecy and silence. Read that again. Not because you failed — because being seen, known, and supported is what interrupts it. A pattern you can see is a pattern you can work on.

You just read the frame.

Which stage am I in right now? _____ Which stages have I already come out of? _____ Where is he working on me this week? _____

13. The Specific Plan Against the Called

If you feel called to something, watch for these common ways a calling gets derailed. Some may be the enemy; many are simply human. You do not have to decide which in order to guard against them.

1. Attack the gift at the source. Whatever you're called to carry, he attacks that exact capacity in childhood. Called to speak? Your voice gets taken — silenced, mocked, not believed, made to keep a secret. Called to protect? You were unprotected. Called to build family? Your family was destroyed. Called to worship? Music got attached to something terrible. **Go back and look at what hurt earliest and hardest. That may point toward where you are meant to help — or it may simply be where you were hurt. Hold it loosely.**

2. Disqualify before you launch. Get something on you. A record, a scandal, a pregnancy, an addiction, a video, a reputation. So that when you finally stand up, the first thing anyone says is *who does she think she is*.

3. Make the wound the identity, not the credential. Keep you as the girl who went through that, rather than the woman who came out and came back. **Stage 11 with a personal touch.**

4. Give you the platform too early. The most effective destruction of a called person is premature success. Unformed character plus visibility equals a public collapse that takes others down with you. **Joseph got thirteen years first. Scripture doesn't say why, but it may have been preparation rather than punishment.**

5. Use the church. Get you wounded by leadership so you conflate God with the people who used His name. Chapter 16.

6. Offer a shortcut. This is what he did to Jesus in the wilderness, and it's what he'll do to you. All three temptations were **legitimate destinations by illegitimate routes** — bread (Jesus would feed thousands), a sign (He would be vindicated), the kingdoms (they're already His). **The temptation is never "do something else." It's "get your actual calling faster, without the cross."** Watch for that. It's the most sophisticated offer you'll get.

7. Attack the marriage, the kids, the money, the body. Everything load-bearing. Not because he cares about your finances, but because a person in crisis at home has no capacity for assignment.

8. Bitterness at the delay. Make you resent God for the wilderness so you arrive at your assignment with a poisoned root. **Hebrews 12:15 — a bitter root defiles many.** A bitter deliverer produces bitter disciples.

9. Isolate in the gap. Too healed for the old crowd, too raw for the polished crowd. Most called people quit in the gap. **You are not supposed to survive the gap. You're supposed to build in it.** That's what THE HOLY R3UP is — a building in the gap.

10. Make you unbearable. Correct and cruel. Right and loveless. This is his favorite outcome for survivors who got free, because a person who is right and harsh will hurt more people than a person who is wrong and kind. **Truth without compassion is his counterfeit of prophecy.**

11. Exhaust you. Overcommit you until you collapse and call it faithfulness. Elijah's crash came **right after** the greatest victory of his life. Read 1 Kings 19 and notice God's response: food, water, sleep, sleep again, then a whisper, then a new assignment and a partner. **No rebuke. Not one word of it.** God's remedy for burnout was a nap and a meal, and then company.

12. Make you do it alone. Because a solitary soldier dies. **Every deliverer in Scripture had people. Every one.**

14. Counterfeit Everything

He can't create. He can only copy. **So every good thing God offers, there's a knockoff — and knowing the pairs is how you stop getting sold.**

God gives	He counterfeits with	How to tell
Peace	Numbness	Peace is present and awake. Numbness is absent.
Rest	Escape	Rest restores. Escape costs.
Joy	A high	Joy survives the morning.
Love	Possession	Love releases. Possession consumes.
Intimacy	Sex without covenant	One builds. One extracts.
Identity	A label	One grows. One freezes you.
Family	A gang, a cult, a codependent system	One sends you out. One won't let you leave.
Covering	Control	One protects your agency. One removes it.
Conviction	Condemnation	Conviction names one thing and shows a door. Condemnation indicts your whole self with no exit.
Prophecy	Divination	One comes from God freely. One you go get, and often pay for.
Power	Manipulation	One serves. One uses.
Deliverance	Distraction	One frees. One entertains you while nothing changes.
Discipline	Punishment	One trains toward something. One just hurts.
Justice	Revenge	One restores. One consumes the avenger.
Forgiveness	Denial	One faces it fully and releases. One pretends it never happened.
Humility	Self-hatred	One is free of self. One is obsessed with self.
Confidence	Pride	One rests in being loved. One needs to be above.
Hope	Fantasy	One acts. One waits.
Surrender	Passivity	One hands the outcome to God and moves. One does nothing and calls it faith.
Communion	Ritual	One meets a Person. One performs a sequence.
Fasting	Self-punishment / eating disorder	One seeks God. One seeks control.
Grace	Permissiveness	One transforms. One excuses.
Truth	Facts weaponized	One heals. One wins.

THE MOST DANGEROUS COUNTERFEIT: FALSE PEACE

"Satan disguises himself as an angel of light." — 2 Corinthians 11:14

He can give you peace about something destructive. That is real and it is why "I felt peace about it" is not sufficient confirmation for anything. Test it against Scripture, against fruit, and against wise people who have nothing to gain.

What is your most persistent counterfeit?

What's the real thing it's imitating, and how do I get that instead?

15. His Tactics by Name – The Field Manual

ACCUSATION — the running commentary. Uses your voice. Speaks in absolutes: always, never, everyone, nobody. *Counter:* Romans 8:1. Answer once with Scripture; do not debate. Debating is engagement and engagement is his win.

CONDEMNATION — indicts your whole self. No door out. *Counter:* learn the difference from conviction and refuse the counterfeit by name.

DECEPTION — mixes truth with a lie so you swallow both. "You did do that" (true) "so you're worthless" (lie). *Counter:* separate the clauses. Agree with the true part, reject the false part.

INTIMIDATION — noise, threat, fear, nightmares, dread, "a roaring lion." **Roaring is what an animal does when it can't bite.** *Counter:* 2 Timothy 1:7. Don't negotiate with volume.

ISOLATION — see Stage 4. His most reliable tool. *Counter:* one honest person. Weekly. Non-negotiable.

DISTRACTION — keeps you busy with nothing. Scrolling, drama, other people's crises. *Counter:* one thing that matters, done today.

DELAY — "later," "when you're ready," "after this season." *Counter:* smallest possible step, now.

DIVISION — splits families, churches, friendships, marriages. He works the seam. *Counter:* go directly to the person. Refuse to carry messages. Matthew 18.

OFFENSE — the trap most Christians die in. A real wound, held, becomes a root. *Counter:* forgive fast and specifically. Hebrews 12:15.

LEGALISM — gets you performing so you never receive. *Counter:* Galatians 5:1.

LICENSE — the opposite move. "Grace covers it, keep going." *Counter:* Romans 6:1–2.

FALSE COMFORT — offers relief that costs more than the pain did. *Counter:* price it out. Play the tape forward.

COUNTERFEIT SPIRITUALITY — real supernatural experience from the wrong source. Feels amazing. Costs everything. *Counter:* test the fruit and the source. 1 John 4:1.

EXHAUSTION — attrition. Wear you down until you have no capacity to resist anything. *Counter:* sleep. Actually. Sleep is warfare. Psalm 127:2 — He gives His beloved sleep.

TIMING — hits you when you're weakest. After a victory. On the anniversary. At 2 a.m. During a crisis. Right before a breakthrough. *Counter:* know your calendar and your vulnerable hours, and pre-plan them.

FAMILIAR PATTERNS — the same thing, generation after generation, person after person. Some believers understand this as a spiritual pattern; whatever you call it, it knows your house. *Counter:* close the specific door, break the specific pattern, change the terrain.

SELF-RELIANCE — the quietest one. Get you doing it all in your own strength until you break, then convince you God failed. *Counter:* John 15:5. Apart from Him, nothing.

16. How He Uses the Church

The hardest chapter for a lot of you. It has to be here.

What gets done in God's name:

- Scripture used to keep women in dangerous marriages
- "Forgive and move on" deployed to protect abusers and silence victims
- "Touch not the Lord's anointed" used to shield predators
- Purity culture that makes a girl responsible for what was done to her body
- Trauma diagnosed as a demon and medication called faithlessness
- Tithing enforced under threat while leadership lives differently
- Prophecy used to manipulate and to control decisions
- Shunning and disfellowshipping as punishment for telling the truth
- "Covering" and "submission" as mechanisms of control
- Abuse reported to elders instead of police

Why it's so devastating: it corrupts the well. Now you have to go to the only source of healing through the door that cut you. **That is the enemy's masterstroke, and it should be named as his work, not God's.**

What Jesus actually said about it:

Read Matthew 23 when you can stand it. The whole chapter. **The angriest recorded words of Jesus on earth are not aimed at prostitutes, addicts, tax collectors, or the demon-possessed. They are aimed at religious leaders who used God's name to burden people.** "Woe to you." Seven times. "Whitewashed tombs." "You shut the kingdom of heaven in people's faces."

And Matthew 18:6: "Whoever causes one of these little ones to sin, it would be better for him to have a great millstone fastened around his neck and to be drowned in the depth of the sea."

He is not neutral about what they did. He is not calm about it. He is not asking you to be either.

THE SEPARATION WORK

You have to separate three things that got fused:

Thing	Verdict
God	Good. Not the one who did this.
The church (people, institution)	Human, fallible, sometimes captured, sometimes evil
What was done to you	A crime and a desecration

Pray it:

PRAYER

"Lord, I separate You from what was done to me in Your name. I renounce every lie about You that was installed by people who misused You. They are not You. What they did was not Your will, and You are angrier about it than I am. I refuse to let them keep You from me. I come to You directly, without their permission, without their mediation, and without their approval. Amen."

GOING BACK — IF AND HOW

You need people. Isolation is his endgame. But you get to be smart.

Green flags: leadership is accountable to someone outside itself. Finances are open. They report abuse to police. Questions are welcome. Therapy and medication are supported. You can leave without being punished. Women are safe. Children have protection policies. The pastor can be told no.

Red flags: one unquestionable leader. Criticism is called rebellion. Secrecy about money. Trauma treated only as demonic. Leaving is treated as betrayal. Abuse handled "in house." Love-bombing new people. You feel worse about yourself after every service.

And permission you may need: you can take years. You can sit in the back. You can leave in the middle. You can watch online. You can have church with three people at a kitchen table. That counts. Matthew 18:20.

17. How He Uses Your Own Body Against You

This is practical warfare that sounds unspiritual and wins more battles than shouting does.

Sleep deprivation — destroys emotional regulation, impulse control, and discernment. It is one of the strongest relapse risks there is. **Protecting your sleep is spiritual warfare.** Psalm 127:2.

Blood sugar — a crash reads identically to a craving, to anxiety, and to despair. Half your 4 p.m. crises are a missed meal.

The startle system — your alarm is set to toast. He uses that to keep you in a state where your reasoning is offline and your reactions run the show.

Chronic pain — depletes everything. Legitimate pain management is not weakness.

Hormones and cycles — real chemistry, real mood shifts, and accusation tends to hit harder at those times.

Know your calendar. If day 24 is always your worst day, that's not spiritual failure, that's information — plan for it.

Substances — alter the mind and remove the gatekeeper. Nothing opens a door faster.

Isolation of the body — no touch, no sun, no movement. Humans deteriorate without all three.

Dissociation — your own defense mechanism turned against you. It saved you then; now it makes you miss your own life.

THE UNGLAMOROUS WARFARE CHECKLIST

- ☐ 7–9 hours of sleep attempted, same bedtime, phone out of the room
- ☐ Protein and water before caffeine
- ☐ Sunlight in the first hour awake
- ☐ Movement 20+ minutes daily — one of the best-supported ways to ease a craving in real time
- ☐ Eat every 4 hours
- ☐ Treat the medical thing. See the doctor.
- ☐ Take the medication as prescribed
- ☐ Human touch — safe, chosen, regular
- ☐ Get outside
- ☐ Know your vulnerable hours and pre-plan them

Say it plainly: you cannot win a spiritual war in a body you are starving, exhausting, and isolating. God made you a body on purpose. Stewarding it is obedience, not vanity.

18. How He Recruits You to Finish His Work

His endgame is efficiency. Eventually he wants you doing it yourself, and here's how he hands off:

- 1. You become your own accuser.** His voice in your accent. You narrate your own failures better than he ever could.
- 2. You self-sabotage.** He doesn't need to take the good thing. You'll wreck it, right when it starts working.
- 3. You isolate yourself.** He doesn't have to keep you alone; you'll decline the invitation.
- 4. You enforce the silence.** You protect the family secret. You call it loyalty.
- 5. You reproduce it.** Your kids get a version of your childhood.
- 6. You become the abuser.** Not because you're evil. Because it's the only model of power you were given.
- 7. You defend the prison.** Someone offers help and you get offended.
- 8. You use the truth as a weapon.** You get free and then you're right, loud, and merciless — and you wound more people than the liars do.

THE SELF-AUDIT

Where am I doing his work for him?

What would change this week if I stopped?

BOOK THREE

Exactly How God Is Involved

THE HOLY R3UP

19. The Question You're Actually Asking

You didn't ask "what is the theological relationship between divine sovereignty and human evil."

You asked: **Where were You, and why didn't You stop it, and am I safe with You now.**

That's the real question and it deserves a real answer, not a verse and a pat on the head. This book gives you the honest answer including the parts that are hard, because **you have already been lied to enough and you can smell it.**

Write your question in your own words, right now, exactly as it sits in you:

Hold onto that. We're coming back to it at the end of this Book.

20. What God Does Not Do

Clear the ground first. These are lies, and they may have been taught to you by people who meant well.

God did not do it to you.

"Let no one say when he is tempted, 'I am being tempted by God,' for God cannot be tempted with evil, and he himself tempts no one." – James 1:13 "Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above." – James 1:17 "God is light, and in him is no darkness at all." – 1 John 1:5

Not one bit of darkness. Whatever happened to you did not originate in Him.

God did not need it to teach you. He can redeem it. He did not require it. **Those are completely different claims and people collapse them constantly.** The cross means God brings good out of atrocity. It does not mean God authored the atrocity to get the good.

God was not punishing you. Jesus killed this idea directly. John 9:2–3 — the disciples ask whose sin caused the man's blindness. Jesus: "It was not that this man sinned, or his parents." Luke 13:1–5 — He is asked whether disaster victims were worse sinners. "No, I tell you." **Twice, explicitly, He refuses the equation.**

God was not absent. Chapter 22.

God is not disappointed in you.

"As a father shows compassion to his children, so the LORD shows compassion to those who fear him. For he knows our frame; he remembers that we are dust." – Psalm 103:13–14

He remembers what you're made of. **He is not surprised by your weakness. He built the frame.**

God does not hold what Christ paid for.

"As far as the east is from the west, so far does he remove our transgressions from us." – Psalm 103:12 "There is therefore now no condemnation." – Romans 8:1

God is not indifferent to what was done to you.

"Vengeance is mine, I will repay." – Romans 12:19 "You have kept count of my tossings; put my tears in your bottle. Are they not in your book?" – Psalm 56:8

Your crying was recorded. Not ignored. Filed.

21. Sovereignty, Free Will, and the Gap Where Evil Operates

Here's the honest framework. Not a tidy one. An honest one.

GOD MADE A WORLD WITH REAL AGENCY IN IT

He made beings who can actually choose. Not simulations — agents. And **love requires that**. A person who cannot refuse cannot love; they can only comply. A world of compliant beings is a world without love in it.

So God accepted a horrifying cost when He made that choice: real agency means real capacity for atrocity. He did not merely permit the possibility of a hug. He permitted the possibility of a fist. **You cannot have one without the other and have either one be real.**

AND THAT'S THE GAP

There's a space between what God wills and what happens. Scripture says it outright:

"The Lord is patient toward you, not wishing that any should perish." — 2 Peter 3:9

Not wishing. And yet. **So His will is not automatically executed in the present order.** Jesus taught us to pray "Your will be done **on earth as it is in heaven**" — which is only a meaningful prayer if it currently **isn't**.

In that gap, evil operates. Human evil. Spiritual evil. The wreckage of a fallen creation.

WHAT GOD DOES IN THE GAP

He doesn't sit outside it.

1. He enters it. The incarnation. God did not send a memo into human suffering; He got in it. Hungry, homeless, betrayed by a friend, abandoned by His people, falsely accused, stripped naked, tortured, executed. **There is no category of your suffering He did not personally enter.**

2. He limits it. Job 1:12 and 2:6 — explicit boundaries, twice, and they hold. **It could have been worse and it was not, and that was not luck.** You may never know what was stopped. There are things that did not reach you.

3. He is present in it. Chapter 22.

4. He redeems it. Genesis 50:20 — "you meant evil against me, but God meant it for good." Not "it was actually good." Two intentions on the same event. **Theirs was evil. His was redemption. Both real.**

5. He will end it. Revelation 21:4. Every tear, wiped. Every account, settled. **The gap closes.** There's a date.

THE PART I WILL NOT PRETEND TO

Why He permits the specific amount and kind of evil He permits, in your specific case, I cannot tell you. Nobody can, and anyone who claims to is selling something.

Job asked. He got no explanation — he got God Himself, and he said it was enough. That's not a satisfying answer and Scripture doesn't offer a more satisfying one, which is, strangely, a mark of its honesty. **A religion inventing comfort would have invented a better answer than that.**

Here is what I can tell you, and it's enough to build on: it was not from Him, He was not absent, He is not indifferent, it will be answered, and He got into it Himself rather than watch from a distance. **A God who stayed out of it would be open to the charge you want to make. A crucified God is not.**

22. Where God Was – The Specific Answer

This is the chapter. Read it slow.

HE WAS IN THE ROOM

"The LORD is near to the brokenhearted and saves the crushed in spirit." – Psalm 34:18
"When you pass through the waters, I will be with you." – Isaiah 43:2 "Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for you are with me." – Psalm 23:4

Notice what Isaiah 43 does **not** say. It doesn't say "I will keep you out of the waters." It says **through**, and **with**. That's a different promise than the one you were told you had, and it's the one that was actually kept.

He was in the room. Not stopping it — which is the thing you cannot forgive Him for — but in it. Closer to you than the person doing it.

HE KEPT THE RECORD

"You have kept count of my tossings; put my tears in your bottle. Are they not in your book?" – Psalm 56:8

Every night you cried and nobody came, **something was being written down**. When you tell your story now and people doubt you, understand: **there is already a complete, accurate record, and it does not depend on your memory or their testimony**. You have never needed to prove it to Him.

HE WAS GRIEVED

"In all their affliction he was afflicted." – Isaiah 63:9 "Jesus wept." – John 11:35

He wept at a grave He was about to empty. **He knew the resurrection was four minutes away and He cried anyway**. That's not a God who merely tolerates grief. **That's a God who grieves with you even when He knows the ending**.

HE DID NOT THINK IT WAS OKAY

"Vengeance is mine, I will repay, says the Lord." – Romans 12:19

That is not a verse telling you to be quiet. **It's a verse telling you the case has been taken by a higher court**. You are not being asked to drop the charges. You are being asked to hand them to a prosecutor who cannot be bribed, cannot be deceived, and never loses.

HE WAS THE ONE WHO GOT YOU OUT

Whatever kept you alive — the person who showed up, the door that was unlocked, the night you decided not to, the overdose that didn't take, the ride that came, the thing you can't explain — **look at it again**. You are reading this. **Something kept you**.

HE WAS ON A CROSS

This is the answer that actually holds.

You want to know how God can be good and let this happen. Here's what He did about it: **He came and got in it with you, and He took the worst of it Himself**.

- Betrayed by someone He ate with
- Abandoned by every friend
- Falsely accused, in a rigged trial
- Beaten by men with authority
- **Stripped naked and publicly humiliated** — if you are a survivor of sexual violation, sit with that. Scripture doesn't dwell on it but crucifixion was done naked, deliberately, as part of the degradation. **He knows the specific shame of being exposed by people who enjoyed it**.
- Mocked while dying
- And He cried out "**My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?**" — Matthew 27:46

Jesus Christ asked your exact question, out loud, from a cross.

Not rhetorically. Not as a teaching illustration. **He experienced the felt absence of God**. That means when you scream "where were You" — you are not being faithless. **You are quoting Him**.

WORK — WHERE WAS HE

The worst moment of my life:

What I have believed about where God was in it:

Now ask Him directly. Write it as a question and then sit in silence for ten minutes. Write anything that comes:

If nothing comes, that's normal and it's not rejection. Ask again next week. Some answers take a year. Some come as a memory you'd forgotten — a moment of unexplained calm, someone who showed up, the fact that you're here. **Those are answers.**

23. Why He Didn't Stop It – Every Honest Answer There Is

You deserve the full list, including the ones that don't satisfy, because being handed only the pretty ones is how you learn not to trust the source.

1. Because He made the world with real freedom in it, and freedom that can't be misused isn't freedom.

(Real, and it does not warm you at 3 a.m.)

2. Because we're in the gap between the cross and the consummation. The verdict is in; the sentence isn't executed. We live in the interval, and the interval has casualties.

3. Because stopping every evil act would mean ending human agency entirely — which is a real answer to "why doesn't He stop all evil" and a cold one applied to your specific night.

4. Because He did stop some of it, and you'll never know the list. Job's limits were explicit. There are things that never reached you. **This is genuinely true and genuinely unverifiable, which is its own kind of hard.**

5. Because He works through people, and the people failed. God's ordinary method of protecting a child is adults. **When the adults are the danger or the cowards, the method breaks — and the failure is theirs, not His design's.** This is the answer nobody gives and it's often the truest one. *Somebody knew. Somebody didn't come.* That is a human crime, not a divine decision.

6. Because the enemy is real, and some of the harm in a fallen world was made possible by human choices upstream of you.

7. Because we do not see the whole. Romans 8:28, 1 Corinthians 13:12. **This is true and it must never be used to shut a survivor up.** "You'll understand someday" is not pastoral care. It's a door being closed.

8. Because — and here is the honest bottom — I don't know, and neither does anyone else. Job got no answer. He got a Person, and he said that was enough. **You are allowed to not be there yet.**

AND HERE'S WHAT YOU'RE ALLOWED TO DO WITH ALL THAT

You are allowed to be angry at God.

Not as a concession. As a biblical practice.

- Job accused God to His face for 37 chapters. **God's final verdict: Job "has spoken of me what is right" — and his friends with the correct theology had not.** (Job 42:7) **God preferred the raging accusations of the wounded man to the tidy defenses of the comfortable ones.**
- Psalm 88 is a lament that ends in darkness. No resolution. Last word: "darkness is my closest friend." **God put it in the book and did not fix the ending.**
- Habakkuk 1:2 — "How long, O LORD, must I call for help, and you will not listen?"
- Lamentations 3 — the writer says God has become like an enemy to him, has walled him in, has shot him with arrows. **Then, in the middle of that, verse 22: "the steadfast love of the LORD never ceases."** **Both, in the same chapter, by the same man.**

- Jesus. On the cross. "Why have you forsaken me."

God is not fragile. He would rather have your fury than your politeness. Polite distance is the only thing He can't work with, because it isn't a relationship.

WORK — THE LETTER TO GOD

Write it. Unedited. No theology. No softening. Cuss if you need to — Scripture has rougher material than whatever you're about to write.

Start: **"God, what I hold against You is..."**

Now, whenever you can — not today if not today:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I don't understand and I may never understand. I'm not saying it was okay and I'm not saying I'm done being angry. But I'm not leaving. I'm staying in the room with You. Help me."

That's it. That's all He's asking. Stay in the room.

24. The Cross As God's Answer to Your Specific Trauma

Map it. Point by point. This is where it stops being abstract.

What was done to you	What was done to Him
Betrayed by someone close	Judas. Ate with him. Kissed him.
Nobody believed you	Called a liar, a blasphemer, demon-possessed, illegitimate
Abandoned by everyone	Every disciple ran. Peter denied Him three times.
Violated physically	Beaten, flogged, pierced, nailed
Stripped and exposed	Crucified naked in public on purpose
Shamed in front of people	Mocked, spit on, a crown made to humiliate Him
Falsely accused	A rigged trial, paid witnesses, a coerced verdict
Failed by the system	Both religious and civil authority chose to destroy Him
Failed by the church	The religious leadership orchestrated it
Cried out and nothing happened	"Let this cup pass" — and it did not pass
Felt God had abandoned you	"My God, my God, why have you forsaken me"
Wanted to die	Sweat like blood in Gethsemane, "sorrowful unto death"
Alone at the worst moment	Alone at the worst moment

There is no part of your trauma that is outside of His experience. Not one.

"For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but one who in every respect has been tempted as we are." — Hebrews 4:15

And the words that most survivors have never had applied to them:

"He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows and acquainted with grief." — Isaiah 53:3

Acquainted with grief. Not informed about it. On a first-name basis with it.

"Surely he has borne our griefs and carried our sorrows... he was wounded for our transgressions, crushed for our iniquities... and with his wounds we are healed." — Isaiah 53:4–5

Two things in that passage that matter enormously for you:

One: "He has borne our **griefs**." Not just our sins. Our griefs. **He carried the grief too.** You have been carrying something He already took.

Two: "**With his wounds** we are healed." Not with His power. Not with His perfection. **With His wounds.** The mechanism of your healing is somebody else's scars.

Which tells you something about yours.

THE RESURRECTION DETAIL NOBODY MENTIONS

He kept the scars.

He had a glorified, resurrected body that could pass through walls — and He kept the holes in His hands. **He showed them to Thomas.** He used His wounds as evidence.

Your scars are not going to be erased. They're going to be evidence.

25. What "All Things Work Together for Good" Actually Means

Romans 8:28 has been used to hurt more survivors than almost any verse in Scripture. Let's get it right.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"And we know that for those who love God all things work together for good, for those who are called according to his purpose."

What it does NOT say:

- ❌ All things **are** good
- ❌ It happened **for** a good reason
- ❌ God **did** it for your good
- ❌ You should **feel** good about it
- ❌ It'll all make sense **soon**
- ❌ Your pain was **necessary**

What it DOES say: God is actively working — present tense, ongoing labor — to weave good out of a pile of material that includes genuine atrocity. **He's a redeemer working with wreckage, not an architect who ordered the wreckage.**

And read verse 29, the very next line, because nobody ever does: the "good" is defined right there — "to be conformed to the image of his Son." **The good is not a happy outcome. The good is you becoming like Christ.** Which, notice, includes bearing scars and coming back for other people.

And verse 26, right before it: "the Spirit helps us in our weakness... the Spirit himself intercedes for us **with groanings too deep for words.**" **Romans 8 does not describe a tidy universe. It describes God groaning inside the mess with us.** That's the context of verse 28. It's not a slogan. It's a promise made in a groan.

THE JOSEPH TEMPLATE — THE RIGHT WAY TO HOLD IT

"As for you, you meant evil against me, but God meant it for good." — Genesis 50:20

Both halves. Never one.

- He does not say "it wasn't that bad."
- He does not say "you were part of God's plan so you're forgiven of nothing."
- He names it as evil. **He names them as the ones who meant it.**
- And he says God had a different intention running on the same event.

Two authors. Two intentions. One event. Theirs was evil and it was real. His was redemption and it was also real.

And Joseph wept. Genesis 45:2, "he wept aloud" — so loud the Egyptians heard him. Genesis 50:17, he wept again when they asked forgiveness. **Thirteen years in, a whole nation saved, and he still cried about it.** Redemption did not delete the grief. **Both, forever.**

Never say Romans 8:28 to a bleeding person. And never let anyone say it to you as a way of closing the subject.

26. The Reckoning – Judgment, Justice, and What Happens to Them

You need this chapter. Nobody preaches it to survivors and it is the thing that lets you put the weapon down.

THERE WILL BE AN ACCOUNTING

"For we must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ." – 2 Corinthians 5:10 "Nothing is covered up that will not be revealed, or hidden that will not be known." – Luke 12:2 "God will bring every deed into judgment, with every secret thing." – Ecclesiastes 12:14

Every secret thing. Everything done to you in the dark, in a locked room, with no witnesses, that they still deny — **it is on record and it will be read out.**

JESUS ON THOSE WHO HURT CHILDREN

"Whoever causes one of these little ones who believes in me to sin, it would be better for him to have a great millstone fastened around his neck and to be drowned in the depth of the sea." – Matthew 18:6

That is Jesus. Talking about a stone and the bottom of the ocean. He is not calm about what was done to you.

GOD AS AVENGER — AND WHY THAT'S MERCY FOR YOU

"Vengeance is mine, I will repay." – Romans 12:19 "The LORD is a God of vengeance... rise up, O judge of the earth; repay to the proud what they deserve." – Psalm 94:1-2 "He will by no means clear the guilty." – Nahum 1:3

Understand what this verse is doing for you. "Vengeance is mine" is not a gag order. **It's a transfer of custody.** The case is being taken by a court that has all the evidence, cannot be lied to, cannot be charmed, and has never lost.

Why you should want this: because as long as you're the prosecutor, you have to stay in the courtroom. You have to keep the evidence fresh. You have to keep the wound open so the case stays alive. **You cannot heal and prosecute at the same time.** Handing it over is not letting them off. **It's getting out of the building.**

BUT THEY MIGHT NEVER FACE ANYTHING ON EARTH

True. Some die comfortable. Some are eulogized. Some are in ministry. Some are still walking around with your childhood in their pocket.

And that is not the end of the story, and it is also not something anyone should minimize for you. You are allowed to be furious about earthly injustice. **Imprecatory psalms exist for exactly this.** Read Psalm 10, 35, 55, 69, 94, 109 when the rage is high. God printed prayers asking Him to break the teeth of the wicked. **He made room for your worst prayer.**

AND THE PART THAT WILL BE HARDEST

Some of them may repent and be forgiven.

Paul persecuted and killed believers and wrote a third of the New Testament. **There were people in the early church who had to sit in a room and worship next to the man who had their family killed.**

If that makes you furious, that fury is legitimate and you should say it out loud to God rather than swallow it. It is one of the hardest things about grace: it's scandalous when it's applied to someone who hurt you. **That same scandal is what covers what you did.** Both edges of the same sword.

WORK — HANDING OVER THE CASE

Who am I still prosecuting?

What am I waiting for them to admit?

What is it costing me to keep the case open?

The transfer, said out loud:

PRAYER

"God, You are the judge and I am not. I hand You this case — all of it, every piece of evidence, every year of it. I am not dropping the charges. I am transferring them to a court that cannot be corrupted.

I release myself from the job of collecting this debt. I am not their jailer and I am not their judge. You are.

I will not carry this into my next twenty years. Amen."

27. When God Feels Absent, Silent, or Complicit

The last thing in this Book, because you'll need it repeatedly.

THE SILENCE IS DOCUMENTED

You are not the first. It's in the book:

- **Psalms 13:1** — "How long, O LORD? Will you forget me forever?"
- **Psalms 22:1–2** — "Why have you forsaken me? ...I cry by day, but you do not answer."
- **Psalms 88** — ends with "darkness is my closest friend." **No resolution. God left it in.**
- **Habakkuk 1:2** — "How long must I call for help, and you will not listen?"
- **Job** — 37 chapters of no answer.
- **Lamentations 3:8** — "though I call and cry for help, he shuts out my prayer."
- **Jesus** — Matthew 27:46.

If the felt absence of God disqualified people, half of Scripture would be unpublishable.

WHAT'S ACTUALLY HAPPENING IN THE SILENCE

Sometimes it's a season of formation — Jesus went into the wilderness and God said nothing for forty days. **The silence was part of the preparation, not a withdrawal of favor.**

Sometimes it's exhaustion — Elijah, suicidal under the broom tree. God's response: food, water, sleep, more sleep, **then** the whisper. **If you can't hear God, ask when you last slept and ate.** That's not a joke; it's 1 Kings 19.

Sometimes it's trauma — if your nervous system can't feel safety, you cannot feel presence. **That's a body problem, not a spiritual verdict.**

Sometimes there's noise — accusation drowning the whisper.

And sometimes, honestly, **you don't get told why.**

WHAT TO DO

Keep showing up. Faithfulness in the dark is worth more than ecstasy in the light. Anybody can worship on a good day.

Stand on what's written, not on what you feel. "Never will I leave you" (Hebrews 13:5) was written to be true on the days you can't feel it. **That's the entire point of writing it down.**

Let other people carry you. The paralyzed man didn't get himself to Jesus. Four friends took a roof apart. **Sometimes the faith that heals you is somebody else's.**

Say it out loud anyway. "I can't feel You. I'm still here. I'm not leaving."

Go back to your question from Chapter 19.

Read what you wrote.

Has anything shifted?

What do you still need from Him?

Ask. Out loud. Then go do Book Five.

BOOK FOUR

The Chosen One, Complete

THE HOLY R3UP

28. Chosen: The Full Doctrine

"Chosen" in Scripture never means favorite. It means sent.

*"You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you that you should go and bear fruit."
— John 15:16 "You are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for his own possession, that you may proclaim the excellencies of him who called you out of darkness into his marvelous light." — 1 Peter 2:9*

Both verses have a **purpose clause**. Chosen *that you should go*. Chosen *that you may proclaim*. **Chosen is always followed by an assignment, never by a throne.**

And who gets picked:

"God chose what is foolish in the world to shame the wise; God chose what is weak in the world to shame the strong; God chose what is low and despised in the world, even things that are not, to bring to nothing things that are — so that no human being might boast." — 1 Corinthians 1:27-29

"Things that are not." That's the recruiting criteria. Not the qualified. **The discounted.**

Look at the roster: a shepherd boy, a murderer with a stutter, a prostitute, a teenage girl, a tax collector, a persecutor, fishermen, a woman with five failed marriages who became the first evangelist to a city, a guy hiding in a winepress who got called "mighty man of valor."

Not one of them was the obvious pick. That's not a coincidence. That's the method.

AND CHOSEN DOES NOT MEAN PROTECTED FROM CONSEQUENCES

Moses was chosen and did not enter the land. David was chosen and his family never recovered from what he did. Samson was chosen and died blind in an enemy temple. **Calling is not immunity. Obedience matters at every stage.** Chapter 34.

29. The Twelve Marks of the Called

These marks describe patterns seen in Scripture and among survivors. They are not a test that proves you are "chosen," and not having them does not mean you are any less loved or useful. Suffering alone is not a sign of calling.

Not a personality test. A pattern. Check what's true.

- ☐ **1. Attacked early and disproportionately.** The intensity was weird. It was more than the situation warranted.
- ☐ **2. Marked by a specific wound** that matches what you'd later carry.
- ☐ **3. Isolated** — never fully belonged anywhere, even in your own family.
- ☐ **4. Misunderstood by good people**, not just enemies.
- ☐ **5. A hunger for God you can't fully explain**, that survived everything including your own rebellion.
- ☐ **6. Discernment** — you read rooms and people, and you're usually right and often unable to explain how.
- ☐ **7. Holy anger** at injustice that isn't about you personally.
- ☐ **8. People bring you their real stuff**, including strangers, even when you feel unqualified.
- ☐ **9. You survived what should have killed you.** More than once.
- ☐ **10. Repeated attack at the same fault line.** It comes back with a new face every time you step up.
- ☐ **11. Delay** — long gaps between promise and fulfillment. Years of nothing.
- ☐ **12. You can't quit.** You've tried to walk away from God and couldn't stay gone.

How many did I check? _____

Caution, and take it seriously: these marks describe the called AND they overlap with trauma symptoms. Hypervigilance can read as discernment. Isolation can be avoidance. **Don't build a whole identity on this list alone.** Real calling is confirmed by fruit, by time, and by mature people who have nothing to gain from flattering you. Chapter 32 covers the counterfeits.

30. The Seven Seasons of a Chosen Life

Every one of them goes through these. Find where you are.

SEASON 1 — THE MARKING. Early. Usually a wound, not a celebration. Something gets attacked that will later be your assignment. You don't know anything is happening.

SEASON 2 — THE SURVIVING. The years of just getting through. Coping mechanisms, contracts signed, damage taken. This is the season the enemy's twelve-stage plan runs hardest. **Nothing is wasted here even though it feels like everything is.**

SEASON 3 — THE AWAKENING. Something breaks open. A moment, a crisis, a conversion, a rock bottom, a sentence somebody says. You realize there's a bigger frame. **This is often the most disorienting season, not the most joyful — because now you can see, and what you see is the wreckage.**

SEASON 4 — THE WILDERNESS. The long, silent, humiliating middle. Chapter 31. **This is where most people quit.**

SEASON 5 — THE BREAKING. A specific, targeted breaking in the exact place your assignment requires humility. It is not punishment. **It's the removal of the thing that would have made you dangerous with power.** Jacob's hip. Paul's blindness and then his thorn. Peter's three denials — he had to fail at loyalty before he could be trusted with the church.

SEASON 6 — THE COMMISSIONING. The turn. Doors open that were shut. What you've carried becomes what you offer. It rarely looks like you pictured and it's usually smaller and slower at first. **Frequently it starts with one person.**

SEASON 7 — THE MULTIPLYING. Others get free through you. You reproduce. You raise up people who'll outlast you. And you keep being pruned the whole time, because there's no graduation.

Which season am I in? _____ What is this season actually asking of me?

What am I trying to skip?

31. The Wilderness, Decoded

How long it's been for others: Joseph, 13 years — slavery, false accusation of rape, prison, forgotten by a man who promised to remember him. Moses, 40 years on the back side of a desert after a killing. David, years hunted by the king who was supposed to bless him, hiding in caves, pretending to be insane to survive. Paul, years in Arabia and Tarsus that Scripture barely mentions. Jesus, 40 days, and 30 years of obscurity before that.

What the wilderness is FOR — and this is the whole reason to endure it:

- 1. Killing the thing in you that would have made you dangerous.** Pride, hurry, need for approval, need for credit, self-reliance. **Power in an unformed person destroys everyone around them.** The wilderness is protective.
- 2. Removing your false supports** so you find out what actually holds. You learn God is real when He's the only thing left.
- 3. Teaching you to hear.** The whisper isn't audible over the crowd.
- 4. Building capacity.** You cannot carry other people's weight until you've carried your own for a while.
- 5. Exposing what you actually believe.** Not what you say — what comes out when there's nothing.
- 6. Establishing your identity before your function. This one is critical.** At Jesus' baptism, God says "You are my beloved Son, with whom I am well pleased" — **before a single miracle.** Then comes the wilderness. Then ministry. **Identity, then testing, then function.** If you get function before identity, you will spend your ministry trying to earn what you were already given, and it will eat you alive.

What the wilderness is NOT: punishment. Abandonment. Evidence you missed it. Evidence you're not called. Proof God forgot.

SURVIVING IT

- **Write down the promise.** You will not remember it in month fourteen. **Write it with a date and read it out loud when you can't feel it.** Habakkuk 2:2 — write the vision down.
- **Do the next small obedience.** Not the vision. The next thing. David went back to the sheep after being anointed king. **He got anointed and then went back to the sheep.** Sit with that.
- **Find your two or three.** Not a crowd. Two or three who know everything.
- **Serve where you are.** Joseph ran the prison. Do the thing in front of you excellently and unseen.
- **Let it finish.** An early exit means repeating it. **You will go around this mountain again if you leave before it's done.**
- **Expect the forgetting.** The cupbearer forgot Joseph for two full years. Being forgotten by people who owed you is part of the standard curriculum.

How long have I been in it? _____ What is it killing in me? _____ What's the next small obedience? _____

32. The Specific Temptations of the Chosen

- 1. THE SHORTCUT.** All three wilderness temptations of Jesus were **legitimate destinations by illegitimate routes**. Bread — He would feed thousands. A sign — He would be vindicated. The kingdoms — they're already His. **Satan never offered Him something wrong. He offered Him the right thing early and cheap.** That's the offer you'll get. Watch for it.
- 2. SPECIALNESS.** Mistaking "chosen" for "superior." It shows up as: unteachable, above correction, exempt from ordinary rules, contemptuous of normal believers, building an identity on being the one who sees.
- 3. NEEDING TO BE NEEDED.** Ministry as a way to be indispensable. You'll build dependence instead of freedom, because free people leave.
- 4. BITTERNESS AT THE COST.** Resenting God for the price. **Hebrews 12:15** — a bitter root defiles many. **A bitter deliverer makes bitter disciples.** This is the most common ruin of survivor-ministers.
- 5. IDENTITY IN THE WOUND.** If who you are is what you survived, **your abuser still holds the deed to your identity.** Steward it, don't be it.
- 6. USING THE PAST AS A PASS.** "I'm like this because of what happened." True, and not a permit. **Your trauma explains your behavior; it does not excuse your impact.**
- 7. MARTYR COMPLEX.** Needing to suffer to feel valid. Sabotaging good seasons. Choosing the hard road when an easier one was God's provision.
- 8. PROPHETIC HARSHNESS.** Right and cruel. **1 Corinthians 13:2** — **you can have all knowledge and prophetic power and be nothing without love.** Truth without compassion is a counterfeit of prophecy.
- 9. BURNOUT AS PROOF.** Exhaustion worn as a badge. Jesus withdrew constantly. **Sustainability is obedience.**
- 10. PLATFORM ADDICTION.** Needing the response, the numbers, the impact metric. If you'd stop if nobody watched, it was never the assignment.
- 11. SPIRITUALIZING AVOIDANCE.** "I'm waiting on God" as cover for fear. Praying about the thing you've already been told to do.
- 12. GOING BACK TO FIX THEM.** Trying to make your family see, understand, or apologize. **This will consume decades. They may never. Grieve it and go forward.**

Which three are mine?

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

Who has permission to call me out on them? _____

If the answer is nobody, that is this month's entire assignment. A chosen person who can't be corrected is the most dangerous person in any room, and there are a lot of them with microphones.

33. What It Costs and What It Pays

THE COST, HONESTLY

- **People.** Some you'll grieve for years. Some of it is attack; some of it is God clearing a table so He can seat the right people. **Both feel identical to abandonment.**
- **Being misunderstood by people who love you.** They'll call your calling pride, your grief drama, your boundaries bitterness, your urgency instability.
- **Delay that looks like denial.** You'll get a promise and watch the opposite happen for years.
- **A brutal season.** It does not mean you are cursed, and it does not prove you are carrying something special. Ask for help either way.
- **Repeat temptation at the same fault line.** Forever. It's the known address.
- **Carrying it without credit.** Sometimes you do the thing and someone else gets thanked. **If you need the credit, you can't carry the weight.**
- **The loneliness of the gap.**
- **Grief on a schedule.** Anniversaries, songs, smells. **Being chosen does not exempt you from missing who you lost.** It gets carried better, not smaller.
- **Never being finished.** No graduation. Pruning continues in the fruitful season — **John 15:2, He prunes the branches that ARE bearing fruit.**

WHAT IT PAYS

- **You get to be the answer to a prayer you once prayed with nobody listening.**
- **Your worst thing stops being only a wound and becomes a door** somebody else walks through.
- **You know God in a register comfortable people never access.** That's not a consolation prize; ask anyone who has it.
- **Freedom that can't be taken,** because it wasn't built on circumstances.
- **Your bloodline changes.** Generations you'll never meet.
- **Somebody lives** who would not have.
- **"Well done."** Matthew 25:21. From the only one whose opinion is final.

WORK

What it has cost me so far:

What I'm still unwilling to pay:

What I'm demanding as a condition:

Is it worth it? Answer honestly, today's honest answer:

34. Chosen and Broken – The Ones Who Fell

You need this chapter because someone told you calling is a guarantee. It isn't.

Saul — genuinely anointed. Lost it to insecurity, disobedience, and jealousy. Died consulting a medium.

Anointing is not character.

Samson — supernatural strength, a lifetime Nazirite call, and no boundaries whatsoever. Told the secret to the woman who was selling him. Died blind, in chains, in an enemy temple. **God used his death. It still cost him his eyes and his life.** Gifting without discipline is a countdown.

Solomon — the wisest man alive, who ended up with a thousand women and a temple full of foreign gods. **Wisdom you don't apply to yourself is decoration.**

David — man after God's own heart. Also: abused his power to take a woman and had her husband killed. Forgiven, restored, still wrote psalms — **and his family never recovered. Rape and murder and rebellion among his own children.** Forgiveness is real. Consequences are also real.

Moses — forty years of faithfulness and one act of anger at the rock. Did not enter the land. **God let him see it and not enter it.** That's hard and it's in the book.

Judas — chosen by Jesus Himself, personally. Three years of miracles. Ended it in a field.

Demas — Paul's coworker, named three times, "in love with this present world" and gone (2 Timothy 4:10). **Some people just drift out. No scandal. They get comfortable.**

WHAT TOOK THEM DOWN

Who	What did it
Saul	Insecurity → jealousy → disobedience
Samson	No boundaries, appetite, told the secret
Solomon	Compromise by increments
David	Idleness + power + no accountability
Moses	Unprocessed anger at the people
Judas	Money, and disillusionment with the actual plan
Demas	Comfort

Notice: not one of them fell because the calling was fake. Every single one fell at the level of character, appetite, or accountability.

THE SAFEGUARDS — BUILD ALL SEVEN

- ☐ **People who can tell me no**, who have nothing to gain. Named: _____
- ☐ **Financial transparency.** Someone sees my money.
- ☐ **Sexual accountability.** Specific, not vague. Someone asks me real questions.

- ☐ **Anger processed somewhere legitimate**, not on the people I serve.
- ☐ **Rest that's scheduled**, not earned. My day off is: _____
- ☐ **My own healing continuing**. I'm still in my own work.
- ☐ **Willingness to be small**. I'll do it if nobody sees.

My weakest safeguard is: _____ **What I'm doing about it this week:** _____

BOOK FIVE

The Unraveling: Step by Step

THE HOLY R3UP

Thirty-three steps. Four phases. About twelve months. Nothing skipped.

35. Before You Begin

THE THREE SAFETY GATES — PASS THESE FIRST

GATE 1 — Am I physically safe? If someone is currently harming you, get safe first. **National Domestic Violence Hotline 1-800-799-7233**, or text START to 88788. Deliverance work while living in a fire is not the right order.

GATE 2 — Am I safe from myself? If you're thinking about ending your life: **call or text 988**. Now, before Step 1.

GATE 3 — Is my withdrawal dangerous? Alcohol, benzos, and barbiturates can kill you in withdrawal. **SAMHSA 1-800-662-4357**. Get a medical opinion. MAT is legitimate. Medication is not faithlessness.

WHAT YOU NEED BEFORE STEP 1

- ☐ **One safe human** who knows you're doing this. Name: _____
- ☐ **A therapist or counselor** if you can access one — trauma-informed. This work opens things.
- ☐ **A notebook** that's just for this.
- ☐ **A time and place** that's yours. Same time daily if possible.
- ☐ **Something that grounds you** ready to hand — the resets from Volume I.
- ☐ **A decision made in advance:** what I do if this gets too big. Written here: _____
- ☐ **Your Bible.**
- ☐ **A calendar** — this is 12 months, not a weekend.

EXPECT THE PUSHBACK

It will come. Old contacts texting out of nowhere. Nightmares. A sudden crisis. An old craving wearing a new face. Somebody dying. An illness. The urge to quit right in the middle.

That is not proof it is failing, and it is not proof it is working — it is proof you have touched something real. Sleep, eat, stay near your people, and tell your counselor or one safe person. Not every hard day is a spiritual attack, and you do not have to decide what caused it before you ask for help. Write it down when it happens — naming it makes it easier to face.

Phase 1 – Excavation (Steps 1–7)

YOU CANNOT BREAK WHAT YOU HAVEN'T NAMED.

STEP 1 – TELL ONE PERSON THE TRUTH

Not a version. The truth. What happened, what you did, what you're carrying.

Why first: everything in Book Two runs on secrecy. Stage 6 (shame loop) and Stage 12 (silence) are his primary infrastructure. **Confession cuts the oxygen.** James 5:16 — confess to one another **and be healed.** The healing is attached to the telling.

Who: _____ By when: _____ Done: ☐

STEP 2 – THE FULL TRAUMA INVENTORY

Every event. Titles only, not narratives. Ages. In order if you can.

Then circle the one you skipped. **That's the keystone.**

Done: ☐ The one I skipped: _____

STEP 3 – THE CONTRACT INVENTORY

Work all twenty-two in Chapter 3. Every one. Out loud if you can.

Number identified: _____ Done: ☐

STEP 4 – THE INNER VOW EXCAVATION

Chapter 4. Find every survival vow. Ages, moments, exact words. Expect 3–9.

Number found: _____ Done: ☐

STEP 5 – THE SOUL TIE LIST

Chapter 5. Every name. "Unknown" where you don't know. Every category.

Number listed: _____ Done: ☐

STEP 6 – THE BLOODLINE MAP

Chapter 8. Three to four generations, both sides, all eleven columns.

Patterns with 3+ generations: _____ Done: ☐



STEP 7 — THE STAGE AUDIT

Chapter 12. Walk all twelve stages. Mark what applies. Notice which pattern is loudest **this week**.

Current stage: _____ Done: ☐

PHASE 1 COMPLETE. Date: _____

Rest here for a week. Do not go straight into Phase 2. You just excavated your entire life. Sleep, eat, be with someone, do something with your hands.

Phase 2 – Praying It Through (Steps 8–17)

REVOKING EVERY GROUND. OUT LOUD, SPECIFICALLY, ONE AT A TIME.

A note before Phase 2: these are prayers, not a formula. Scripture invites us to confess, forgive, and resist the devil (James 4:7; 5:16), but it does not hand us a script, and nothing here replaces a doctor, a counselor, or a pastor who knows you. You may skip any step that stirs up more than you can hold. Do these with one trusted believer present if you can. Out loud helps. Specific helps — "anything and everything" is hard to mean.

STEP 8 — GET UNDER COVER

Before you revoke anything, submit. **James 4:7 — submit to God, THEN resist. That order is not optional. Resisting without submitting is how people get hurt.**

PRAYER

"Father, I come through Jesus Christ who died for me and rose again. I am Yours — my body, my mind, my memory, my will, my future. I cannot do this in my own strength. Cover me in the blood of Jesus. Holy Spirit, lead me through every step and show me what I can't see."

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 9 — CONFESS WHAT'S YOURS

Specifically. Not what was done to you — your part. **Specific confession, specific freedom.**

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 10 — FORGIVE, BY NAME

One person at a time. Out loud.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I choose to forgive [name] for [specific thing]. Not because it was okay — it was not okay. I release them out of my hands and into God's. I cancel the debt I have been trying to collect. I refuse to be their jailer and their prisoner at the same time. I take back the access I gave them to my mind, my body, my peace, and my future."

This will not feel true the first time. Do it anyway. Feeling follows obedience — sometimes by months. And forgiving is not the same as trusting them again or letting them back in.

Person	Specific offense forgiven	Date

Include on this list: the ones who did it, the ones who watched and said nothing, the ones who didn't believe you, the ones who sent you back, the institution, the church, and the family. **And yourself.**

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 11 — FORGIVE YOURSELF, OUT LOUD

The one nobody does. You cannot walk free while you are still the warden.

PRAYER

"Jesus, I did [name it specifically]. It was real. It was mine. It hurt people. You paid for it. I am not going to keep collecting a debt You already settled. I forgive myself, not because I deserve it, but because You decided it. I take myself out of my own prison. I am not going to spend the rest of my life paying for what You already bought."

1 John 1:9 — He is faithful and just to forgive AND to cleanse. Two things. Forgiven removes the guilt; cleansed removes the residue.

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 12 — RELEASE YOUR BITTERNESS AGAINST GOD

Contract 10. This one has to go or nothing else holds, because as long as you have a case against God you cannot receive from Him.

PRAYER

"God, I have been angry at You. I blamed You. I decided You weren't safe, or weren't good, or weren't there. I said [whatever you said]. I am bringing it to You instead of holding it against You. I renounce the agreement I made that You are not good. I don't understand what You allowed, and I am choosing to trust You anyway, without understanding. I take my case out of court. Be my Father again."

You don't have to stop having questions. You have to stop having a verdict.

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 13 — BREAK EVERY INNER VOW

Your list from Step 4. One at a time, out loud, every single one.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I made a vow when I was [age], in [situation]. I said: '[the vow]'. I made it to survive and it worked then. It is killing me now. In the name of Jesus Christ I renounce that vow. I break it. I release myself from it. It has no more authority over my life. Holy Spirit, replace it with the truth: [the truth]."

Vow	Age made	Date broken

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 14 — RENOUNCE EVERY CONTRACT

Your list from Step 3. All 22 categories — whichever you marked.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"In the name of Jesus Christ I renounce the [name of contract]. I break every agreement I made with it, knowingly or unknowingly, as a child or as an adult. I revoke all permission. I cancel every clause. I nail this contract to the cross of Jesus Christ, where every accusation against me was already settled (Colossians 2:14). It is void. It has no claim. Done."

Contract	Date renounced

Contract	Date renounced

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 15 — RELEASE EVERY HOLD ("SOUL TIES")

Your list from Step 5. Name them, or say "the one whose name I don't know" — **God knows the name.**

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"In the name of Jesus Christ I release my hold on [name] and ask You to loosen every unhealthy bond between us. I return to them everything of theirs I have been carrying — their shame, their blame, their voice in my head, their version of me. I call back to myself everything of mine they took or I gave: my body, my mind, my peace, my identity, my innocence, my future, my voice. What God did not join, I do not keep. Lord, restore to me everything scattered, and make me whole and undivided."

Name (or description)	Date cut

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 16 — REPENT FOR THE BLOODLINE

Chapter 8, identificational repentance. One pattern at a time. Daniel 9. Nehemiah 1:6. Leviticus 26:40.

Bloodline pattern	Date renounced

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 17 — RESIST AND SEAL THE DOORS (OPTIONAL)

This step is optional. If you believe something spiritual has been pressing on you, talk it over with a pastor or counselor you trust first, and skip it if it stirs up more than you can hold. Scripture's instruction is simple: submit to God, resist the devil, and he will flee (James 4:7).

PRAYER

"Jesus, I belong to You. Anything that is not from You — any lie, fear, or influence that took hold through what I have named — has no place in my life, my home, or my family. In Your name I resist it, and I ask You to send it away. I am not its house. I am bought, sealed, and occupied by the Holy Spirit. Stay with me. Amen."

Then seal every door:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I close every door I have named and I seal it with the blood of Jesus. I post the cross over every entrance — my eyes, my ears, my mouth, my mind, my memory, my body, my dreams, my home, my bloodline, and my children. Nothing enters here without His permission."

Notice: no screaming required. Jesus rebuked with a sentence. Loud is for your own fear, not for their ears. Authority is not volume.

Done: ☐ Date: _____

PHASE 2 COMPLETE. Date: _____

Write down what happened in your body during this. Write down what came at you in the three days after. Naming what comes up makes it easier to face.

Phase 3 – Filling and Rebuilding (Steps 18–26)

LUKE 11:24–26 IS JESUS' PICTURE OF A SWEEPED HOUSE LEFT EMPTY. DO NOT SKIP THIS PHASE — WHEN SOMETHING LEAVES YOUR LIFE, SOMETHING GOOD HAS TO MOVE IN.

STEP 18 — FILL EVERY EMPTIED PLACE, IMMEDIATELY

Same day as Step 17. Not next week.

PRAYER

"Holy Spirit, fill every place that just emptied. Fill it with Your presence, Your peace, Your truth, Your love, Your power. Where fear lived, put love. Where shame lived, put belonging. Where craving lived, put satisfaction. Where the lie lived, put the truth. Where the accuser spoke, speak. Occupy every single room. Leave nothing vacant."

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 19 — REPLACE EVERY VOW WITH A TRUTH

Every vow you broke in Step 13 left a hole where a rule used to be. **A person without a rule is not free, they're unsteered.** Write the new rule.

Old vow	New truth I am living by
"I will never need anyone."	"I was built for people. Needing is not weakness."
"I will never be weak again."	"His strength shows up in my weakness. I don't have to be armored to be safe."
"I'll always be the strong one."	"I am allowed to be held."

Say each new one out loud every morning for 30 days. **You are not affirming — you are re-installing.**

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 20 — REDEDICATE YOUR BODY

Chapter 7. Out loud, and take your time.

PRAYER

"Father, this body was made by You and for You. It was used, hurt, invaded, and misused — by others and by me. I do not hate it anymore. I am not going to punish it for what happened to it.

I give it back to You. Every part. My eyes, my mouth, my hands, my skin, my womb, my sex, my blood, my mind, my voice, my feet. I dedicate every part to Your purpose.

I renounce every claim anyone else made on this body. I take my body back from every person who acted like they owned it. It was never theirs. It is Yours, and it is mine to steward.

Make it a temple again. Wash it. Live in it. Teach me to care for it like something You made on purpose."

Then do something physical to mark it. Communion. Baptism or re-affirmation. Anointing oil on your head and hands. A long bath. A haircut. New clothes. **Bodies need markers. Rituals are not superstition — they are how a body records a decision.**

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 21 — TREAT THE BODY MEDICALLY

Chapter 17. Deliverance does not replace a doctor and it never did.

- ☐ Full physical and bloodwork — thyroid, iron, B12, vitamin D, hormones, blood sugar
- ☐ Mental health evaluation — depression, anxiety, PTSD/C-PTSD, ADHD, bipolar
- ☐ Sleep assessed. **Sleep is the #1 predictor of relapse, rage, and hopelessness.** Fix it first.
- ☐ Dental, pain, and anything you've been ignoring for years
- ☐ Nutrition — protein and water are not optional in recovery

Your medication is not a lack of faith. Insulin isn't either.

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 22 — GET A THERAPIST OR TRAUMA-TRAINED COUNSELOR

Look for **EMDR, somatic experiencing, IFS (internal family systems), or trauma-focused CBT**. Ask directly: "Do you have training in complex trauma?" If they say no, keep calling.

A therapist is not a replacement for God and God is not a replacement for a therapist. He made the field. Use it.

Therapist: _____ First session: _____ Can't afford it? Look for: sliding scale, community mental health, 211, county services, church counseling centers, victim-of-crime compensation funds (these pay for therapy in most states if there was a police report).

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 23 — BUILD THE DAILY STRUCTURE

Freedom is architecture, not willpower. Write your version and put it on the wall.

Time	Practice	Why
Wake — same hour	Feet on floor, sunlight in first hour	Circadian reset; the whole day rides on it
First 10 min	Prayer out loud + the armor	Set the day before it sets you
Morning	Protein and water before caffeine	Blood sugar crashes read as cravings and despair
Midday	Move the body 20+ min	The only thing that shifts a craving in real time
Afternoon	HALT check + text one person	Hungry, Angry, Lonely, Tired — breaks the chain early
Evening	Meeting, call, or group	Isolation is what kills people, not the substance
Night	Same bedtime, phone out of the room	Protect the sleep or lose the war
Before sleep	Three things out loud you're grateful for	Rewires the groove
Daily, 2–15 min	Silence with God	Chapter on silence — start at 2 minutes

Weekly: one recovery or support group, one check-in with your person, one therapy session, one act of anonymous service, one full rest day.

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 24 — BUILD THE PEOPLE

You cannot do the rest of this alone and you were never supposed to. **Isolation makes almost every other harm worse, and being known by safe people is one of the strongest protections there is.**

You need five roles filled. They can't all be the same person.

Role	Who	Have them?
The one who knows everything — no edited version		
The one who's further ahead — sponsor, mentor, elder		
The one who's behind you — someone you're helping		
The one who's just a friend — nothing to do with your trauma		
The one who can correct you and you'll receive it		

If **"the one who can correct you" is blank, that's the most urgent assignment in this book.** A chosen person who can't be corrected is the most dangerous person in any room, and there are a lot of them with microphones.

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 25 — SET EVERY BOUNDARY IN THE ACTUAL WORLD

Boundaries that exist only in your heart are wishes.

Person	Boundary	Enforced in the real world how	Done
		Block, mute, change lock, stop relaying	

When they reach out — and they will, usually right when you get peaceful — what I will do:

Decide it now. Deciding in the moment is how you get pulled back in.

Done: ☐ Date: _____

STEP 26 — LEARN THE NEW BEHAVIOR FROM SOMEONE WHO HAS IT

You cannot imagine your way into a pattern you have never seen. Deliverance closes the door. Discipleship builds the house.

What I never learned	Who I'm going to watch and learn it from
How a healthy marriage works	
How to handle money	
How to parent without rage or collapse	
How to rest without guilt	
How to be angry without destroying something	
How to receive help	

Done: ☐ Date: _____

PHASE 3 COMPLETE. Date: _____

Phase 4 – Walking It Out (Steps 27–33)

THE PART THAT TAKES THE REST OF YOUR LIFE, AND THE PART THAT MAKES IT STICK.

STEP 27 — KNOW YOUR RE-ENTRY POINTS AND WATCH THEM

The doors you closed will get knocked on again. **That is not failure. It's a familiar pull, and you can meet it with a plan.**

My known door	The early warning sign	What I do the moment I see it

Monthly self-check — first of every month:

- Am I isolating?
- Am I lying about anything, even small?
- Am I sleeping?
- Am I in the Word or just talking about it?
- Am I secretly keeping a door propped open?
- Is anybody actually allowed to ask me hard questions right now?
- Am I building, or just surviving?

STEP 28 — LEARN TO FIGHT IN REAL TIME

When it comes at you — and it will:

1. **Identify** — body, wound, flesh, or spirit? (Usually more than one.)
2. **Refuse the agreement** — "I don't receive that. That's not mine."
3. **Answer with Scripture out loud** — not feelings. Jesus answered every temptation with "it is written," three times, and did not debate once.
4. **Enforce, don't negotiate** — you're not asking permission.
5. **Tell a person** — same day. Secrecy keeps shame alive.
6. **Worship anyway** — 2 Chronicles 20: they sent the singers out in front of the army.

My three Scriptures I have memorized for attack:

1. _____

2. _____
3. _____

STEP 29 — THE RELAPSE AND SETBACK PLAN

Written in advance. **Having a plan is not permission — not having one gives the fall a runway.**

"The righteous falls seven times and rises again." — Proverbs 24:16. The identity is in the rising, not the never-falling.

1. I stop at the first one. **The fall is the first act; the ruin is the decision afterward.**
2. Within one hour I tell: _____
3. I go to: _____
4. I do not hide it. I do not declare myself a failure. I do not throw away 90 days over one day.
5. If substances: **tolerance drops during sobriety — that's how people overdose after a clean stretch.**
Narcan in the house if opioids are in your history, free at most pharmacies.
6. I find the link I missed, write it down, and adjust the plan.

What I will NOT do after a fall:

STEP 30 — GRIEVE PROPERLY, ON PURPOSE

Freedom does not make the losses smaller. It makes them carryable. **Grief that is not given a place will take one.**

- ☐ I have named every loss (people, years, the childhood I didn't get, the body I had, the person I would have been)
- ☐ I have a place and a way to grieve on purpose — not just when it ambushes me
- ☐ I know my anniversary dates and I plan for them instead of getting hit by them
- ☐ I have someone who will sit with me in it without trying to fix it
- ☐ I have stopped calling grief a relapse

My dates to plan for:

STEP 31 — MAKE AMENDS WHERE IT'S SAFE, LIVE THEM WHERE IT ISN'T

What I did	Who	Direct amends possible?	How, or the living amends instead

When direct amends would harm them, endanger you, or reopen something — you make living amends. You become someone who doesn't do that anymore, and you serve where that damage lives.

STEP 32 — START STEWARDING IT

"Who comforts us in all our affliction, so that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction." — 2 Corinthians 1:4

The "so that" is the entire point. You were not comforted so you'd feel better. You were comforted so you'd know the road.

- ☐ I have told my story out loud to at least one person who needed it (**Revelation 12:11 — they overcame by the blood of the Lamb AND the word of their testimony. Your story is a weapon.**)
- ☐ I am helping one person who is earlier than me
- ☐ I have written down what I know that only someone who's been there could know
- ☐ I am building something, not just maintaining something

Wait on this one until you have some ground under you. Ministering out of an open wound bleeds on people. Scar tissue can hold weight. An open wound can't.

STEP 33 — RE-RUN THIS WHOLE THING ANNUALLY

Once a year, pick a date. Walk all five phases again. You will find new things — not because you failed, but because **you can only see the next layer from the ground you've already taken.**

My annual date: _____

PHASE 4 COMPLETE. Date: _____

BOOK SIX

The Unanswered Questions

The ones you've been carrying without permission to ask

THE HOLY R3UP

36. *Why These Questions Never Got Answered*

Not because there are no answers. Because you were surrounded by people who were **scared of the questions**.

Every time you asked, somebody flinched. So you learned to stop asking out loud and started asking at 3 a.m. with nobody there to answer. And a question asked in the dark with no answer doesn't stay a question. **It hardens into a verdict.** That's how "why didn't God stop it" becomes "God doesn't care," and nobody ever notices the moment it converted.

So here they are. Asked plainly. Answered plainly. Where there's no answer, I'm going to say there's no answer instead of handing you a verse like a napkin over a hole in the floor.

Read this whole chapter slowly. This is the section your spirit has been asking for.

37. The Forty Questions, Answered Straight

ON WHAT HAPPENED

- 1. Was it my fault?** No. Not the part that was done to you. A child cannot consent. A person being coerced is not choosing. A person in survival is not strategizing. **What you did to survive is not the same category as what was done to you,** and the fact that you can't always tell them apart is itself part of the injury.
- 2. Why didn't I fight back / leave / tell?** Because your nervous system chose the option most likely to keep you alive, and it did not consult you. Freeze and fawn are not decisions. They're reflexes, like a knee. **You did not fail to fight. Your body fought by not fighting, and it worked — you're reading this.**
- 3. Why do I miss them?** Because trauma bonds are chemically real. Intermittent reinforcement — cruelty, then tenderness, on an unpredictable schedule — creates a stronger attachment than steady kindness does. It's the same mechanism as a slot machine. **Missing your abuser is not a character flaw. It's proof the bond was engineered.**
- 4. Why did my body respond?** Because bodies respond to stimulation regardless of consent, and this is the single most weaponized fact in the history of abuse. **Arousal is not agreement. A physical response does not retroactively make it your choice.** Shame has built entire cities on this one lie. Tear it down.
- 5. Why do I remember it wrong / in pieces / not at all?** Because the hippocampus — your filing clerk — goes offline under extreme threat. So the memory never got filed as "past." Fragmented memory is **evidence of severity**, not evidence of fabrication. The gaps are not you lying. The gaps are the size of the wound.
- 6. Why did I go back?** Because it was familiar, because you had no other options, because you loved them, because leaving is statistically the most dangerous moment, because you thought you could fix it, because the devil you know is at least mapped. **Going back is the norm, not the exception.** It took most people seven times. You're not slow. You were in a trap.
- 7. Why does it still hurt when it was so long ago?** Because you didn't finish it — you survived it, and those are different. The body keeps an unfinished response running. **Time does not heal. Time plus the right work heals. Time alone just adds layers on top of something still bleeding.**

ON THE ONES WHO DID IT

- 8. Why did they do it?** Because they were broken, or evil, or both, and because they could. **Some of them were victims first and that explains it without excusing it. Some of them just wanted to.** You will probably never get a satisfying answer, and part of healing is stopping the search for a reason big enough to make it make sense. There isn't one. Evil is stupid at its core. It doesn't have a good reason.
- 9. Did they love me?** Possibly, in the damaged way they were capable of. **And it doesn't matter as much as you need it to.** Love that harms you is not a category you have to keep negotiating with. You can accept that they loved you and still refuse them access.

10. Why did nobody stop it? Because families protect secrets over children. Because institutions protect themselves. Because some people genuinely didn't know and some people absolutely did and chose comfort. **That second group is its own betrayal and you're allowed to grieve it separately.** The bystanders hurt you too. Put them on the forgiveness list as their own entry.

11. Will they ever pay? Yes. Not necessarily here. **"Vengeance is mine, I will repay, says the Lord"** (Romans 12:19). That is not God letting them off — that is God taking the case out of your hands because carrying it is killing you. Hebrews 4:13: nothing is hidden. Luke 8:17: everything covered will be uncovered. **There is no version of this where they walk away and nobody ever knows.**

12. Do I have to forgive them? Yes — and not for the reason you've been told. Not because it was okay. Not because they deserve it. **Because unforgiveness is a contract that keeps them in the room.** Matthew 18:34–35 — the unforgiving servant is handed to the jailer. The jailer is not a metaphor for their punishment. It's yours. Forgiveness is you firing yourself as their jailer so you can finally leave the prison you've been guarding.

13. Does forgiving mean letting them back in? No. Absolutely not, and anyone who told you that was either lying or hadn't read it. **Forgiveness is between you and God. Reconciliation requires two people and repentance.** You can be fully forgiving and permanently unavailable. Paul named people and said avoid them (2 Timothy 4:14–15, Romans 16:17). Jesus withdrew constantly.

ON GOD

14. Where was God? In the room. Not outside it. Psalm 34:18 — near to the brokenhearted, near to the crushed. Not arriving after. **Near, during.** That's a harder truth than absence, because it means He saw. And it's a better one, because it means you were never alone in there, even when you felt completely alone.

15. Why didn't He stop it? Here is the honest answer in full: He made a world with real agency, because love that can't be refused isn't love. Real agency means people can genuinely choose evil, and He does not routinely override the will He gave. **He did not cause it, want it, or approve it.** He hated it. He wept over it (John 11:35 — He wept at a grave He was about to open; grief wasn't optional for Him either).

And that is an explanation, not a comfort, and I'm not going to pretend it's the same thing. There is a part of this that has no answer this side of eternity. Anyone who gives you a tidy one is selling something. **"Now we see in a mirror dimly" (1 Corinthians 13:12) is in the Bible for a reason. Some things are not answered. They are outlasted.**

16. Is He punishing me? No. Romans 8:1 — there is **no** condemnation, not less. **John 9:1–3** — the disciples asked whose sin caused a man's blindness and Jesus said neither, and rejected the whole premise of the question. Your suffering was not invoiced to you. Jesus paid the bill and God does not double-bill.

17. Did He allow it for a reason? Careful here, because two things get jammed together. **He allowed it in the sense that He did not override the free will of the person who did it.** He did not author it as a lesson plan. God does not need your rape, your beating, your childhood to accomplish something. **He is not that poor at logistics.** What He does is refuse to let it be wasted — which is not the same as arranging it.

18. Then what does "all things work together for good" mean? Romans 8:28 — read it exactly. It does not say all things are good. It says God works **in** all things **toward** good, and verse 29 defines "good" as being made like Christ. **It is not a promise that your story will have a satisfying plot. It's a promise that nothing in it is unusable in His hands.** Never say this verse to someone in fresh grief. It's true and it's not medicine for that hour.

19. Why does He feel silent? Because silence is documented, not exceptional. Psalm 13: "How long will you hide your face?" Psalm 22: "Why have you forsaken me?" — quoted by Jesus Himself from the cross. **God's own Son experienced God's silence.** Whatever the silence means, it does not mean rejection. And notice 1 Kings 19: God came to Elijah in a whisper **after** He fed him and let him sleep twice. Food, sleep, then the whisper. Sometimes the silence is because you're exhausted, and He's feeding you first.

20. Am I allowed to be angry at Him? Yes. The whole book of Lamentations is a man accusing God to His face and God kept it in the canon. Job accused Him for 37 chapters and God said Job spoke rightly of Him, not the friends with the clean theology (Job 42:7). Jacob wrestled Him and got a new name and a limp. **God can handle your rage. What He can't work with is your silence and your distance.** Bring it to Him, not against Him.

21. Can He still use me after everything I did? Paul held the coats at a stoning and hunted believers, and wrote a third of the New Testament. David was an adulterer and effectively a murderer, and wrote the songs you cry to. Rahab was a prostitute and is in Jesus' genealogy. Moses killed a man. Peter denied Him three times to His face and got the keys. **God's résumé requirement is not a clean record. It's a broken and honest one.**

22. Why do I still want to die sometimes? Because pain that lasts long enough starts looking for an exit, and your brain offers the only one it can think of. **It's a symptom, not a truth, and not a sin to have.** Elijah asked to die (1 Kings 19:4), Jonah asked twice, Job asked, Moses asked. Every one of them was in the middle of an assignment. **God's response to Elijah was food, sleep, a whisper, and a new job — not a rebuke.** If that thought has teeth right now: **988**, before you read another page.

23. Does God love me or just tolerate me? Romans 5:8 — while you were still in it, not after you cleaned up. Luke 15 — the father ran. That's the only time God is described as running in the whole story, and He's running toward the one who wasted everything and came back smelling like a pig pen with a rehearsed speech he never got to finish. **He was watching the road. That means He'd been looking for a while.**

ON THE ENEMY

24. Why me? Two answers and you need both. **First: it wasn't personal at the start — evil moves through openings, and your childhood had openings you didn't make.** Second: some of it may have been aimed at you, and I cannot know which. **Those aren't contradictory.** A brutal childhood is not evidence of a curse, and it is not proof of a special assignment either — it is something that deserves care.

25. Is it my fault for what I opened? Some doors you opened. Most were opened for you before you could spell. **And everything you carry comes to the same place — the cross, where the price was already paid.** The inventory is for bringing things to Jesus, not for prosecuting you.

26. Can he read my mind? No. Only God searches hearts (1 Kings 8:39, Jeremiah 17:10). **He studies your patterns, not your thoughts.** This is why pattern is everything, why the same trigger keeps appearing, and why changing a pattern is genuinely a strategic act of war.

27. Can he make me do something? No. He cannot override your will. He can tempt, deceive, pressure, exhaust, accuse, and arrange circumstance. **He can build a hallway. He cannot make your legs walk down it.** That's why he specializes in making you believe you have no choice, because the belief is the only thing he can actually install.

28. Why does it come back when I'm doing well? Because he fights hardest where he's losing most. **The attack after a breakthrough is not a sign you did it wrong. It's a sign it worked.** Read the order in Matthew 3–4: baptism, heaven opens, "this is my beloved Son," and **immediately** into the wilderness to be tempted. The attack came right after the affirmation, and it opened with "IF you are the Son of God" — going straight at the thing that had just been said out loud.

29. Is my sin demonic or just me? Usually just you, honestly. **Galatians 5 lists the works of the flesh, not the works of demons.** Most of what people try to cast out, they need to crucify. You cannot rebuke a habit you keep feeding. Ask: is this a stronghold, or is it a routine I like?

ON HEALING

30. Why does it take so long? Because it took years to build and it's built into your body, your reflexes, and your beliefs. **Deliverance can be instant. Discipleship is not.** The Israelites left Egypt in a night and it took forty years to get Egypt out of them. You are not slow. You are being rebuilt while you're still living in the house.

31. Will I ever be normal? No. You will be something better and stranger than normal. **You will be someone who has seen the bottom and come back with the map.** Normal people can't do what you're going to be able to do. Thomas kept the holes in his hands. Jesus kept His. **The resurrected body kept the scars — they were the proof of identity.** Glorified doesn't mean erased.

32. Why do I sabotage good things? Because good is unfamiliar and unfamiliar reads as unsafe. Because you have a vow like "I won't be caught off guard again" and peace feels like letting your guard down. Because on some level you believe you're going to lose it anyway, so you'd rather be the one who ends it. **Control over the loss feels better than being ambushed by it.** Name that out loud and it loses most of its grip.

33. Is healing even possible or am I just managing? Both, in different areas, and that's not defeat. Some things fully heal and leave a scar. Some things become a limp you learn to walk on. **Jacob wrestled God and limped for the rest of his life, and it was the best night of his life.** Paul asked three times for the thorn to be removed and got "my grace is sufficient" instead (2 Corinthians 12:9). **God does not always remove the thing. He does always meet you in it.** Both are answers. Only one is the one we want.

34. What if I do everything right and lose anyway? Then you'll be in the company of every faithful person in Hebrews 11:36–39 who was sawn in two, destitute, and commended by God. **The Bible has a whole section for the ones who did it right and it still went badly, and God's comment is "of whom the world was not worthy."** Faithfulness is not a vending machine. It's a covenant.

ON WHAT'S NEXT

35. What if I fail again? You will. Proverbs 24:16 — seven times. **The identity is in the rising.** Peter denied Him publicly three times and was restored over breakfast on a beach with three questions and a commission (John 21). **Note what Jesus did not do: bring up the failure to shame him, or reduce the assignment.**

36. How do I know it's God and not me? Test it: Does it line up with Scripture? Does it produce fruit (Galatians 5:22)? Do mature people confirm it? Does it require you to violate character to obey? **And the fastest test: God convicts, the enemy condemns.** Conviction is specific, has a way out, and moves you toward Him. Condemnation is global, hopeless, and moves you away. **"You lied to her, go fix it" is God. "You're a liar, you always will be, don't bother" is not.**

37. What if I'm not actually chosen and I made all this up? The fact that you're still asking after everything that has tried to kill you is itself part of the answer. **And here's the safety net: if you're wrong about being chosen for something big, and you just spend your life honest, free, and useful to hurting people — you have lost nothing.** The work is right either way. That's how you know it's not ego.

38. What if I'm too late? Too old? Too far gone? Moses was 80 at the burning bush. Abraham was 75 when he was called and 100 when the promise landed. Sarah was 90. Joseph lost 13 years. **Joel 2:25 — "I will restore to you the years that the swarming locust has eaten."** Not replace. **Restore.** God has a documented category for giving back stolen time, and it's the specific promise for people whose years got eaten.

39. Will the pain ever be worth it? It will never be **worth** it. That's the wrong frame and it quietly blames you for not being grateful enough. **What happened to you was not a fair trade and it never will be.** What's true instead: **it will not be wasted.** Revelation 21:4 — He wipes every tear. Not explains them. Wipes them. Somebody has to be close enough to touch your face to do that.

40. What do I do with the questions that have no answer? Write them down. Put them in a sealed envelope with a date on it. **Habakkuk stood on the watchtower and said he'd wait for an answer (Habakkuk 2:1) — and God's answer was "the righteous shall live by faith," which is not an explanation, it's a handhold.** You can walk with unanswered questions. You cannot walk with a verdict. **Keep the questions open and refuse to let them close into a conviction about God's character.**

WORK — MY OWN UNANSWERED QUESTIONS

Write the ones I didn't answer. The real ones. The ones you've never said out loud.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Now, for each: **is this a question, or have I already given it a verdict?**

Prayer for the unanswerable:

PRAYER

"God, I have questions I don't think I'm going to get answers to on this side. I'm bringing them to You instead of using them as evidence against You. I'm going to hold them open. I'm choosing to trust Your character where I can't trace Your hand. Don't let my unanswered questions harden into a verdict about who You are. And where You can tell me — tell me. I'm listening."

BOOK SEVEN

Brandi Renee

*What her passing means, what it doesn't, and what it is not
allowed to become*

THE HOLY R3UP

38. *The Thing You've Never Been Able to Put Down*

You built a movement because of a sister who didn't make it. You have said, out loud, that you wish she'd had a place like the one you're building — somewhere to reach when she knew something was wrong. No one can say whether it would have changed her outcome.

We have to deal with that sentence carefully, because it's carrying two things: one true, one lethal.

The true part: gaps kill people. The distance between "I know something is wrong" and "I know where to go" is where people die, and it is a real, fixable, criminal gap. Building a bridge across it is a legitimate calling and it will save lives. That instinct is right.

The lethal part: the word "if." Because **"if that had existed"** has a shadow attached to it, and the shadow is **"and I didn't build it in time."** That is the thought that's been quietly running underneath the work, and it needs to be dragged out into the light and killed, because it will burn you to the ground and call it ministry.

So hear this directly:

You were not her savior. You were her sister.

You did not lose her because you were too slow, too broken, too late, or not enough. You lost her because addiction is lethal, and because she was sick, and because the world she was in was built to fail people exactly like her — and none of those three things were yours to control.

39. What You Actually Could and Could Not Do

Fill this in. Slowly. Out loud if you can.

Responsible for	Who
Her choices	
The people who hurt her	
The people who sold to her	
The systems that turned her away	
The disease itself	
The family patterns she was born into	
My choices	

Look at that list. Count how many lines have your name on them. Now look at how many don't.

What I did do for her:

What I keep telling myself I should have done:

Was that actually in my power? _____

Was it in my power at the age and condition I was in at the time? _____

That second question is the one that matters, and almost nobody asks it. You judge your past self with resources your past self did not have. **The version of you that could have helped her is the version this workbook is building. She did not have access to that woman, and neither did you.**

40. The Questions About Her You've Been Afraid to Ask

Where is she?

I'm not God and I will not pretend to be. I don't know her heart and neither does anyone who told you they did. **What I can tell you is what Scripture actually says, and it is more merciful than what people have said to you.**

- **Addiction is not the unforgivable sin.** Nowhere is it listed as such. A person dying of a disease that hijacked their brain chemistry is not the same as a person renouncing God.
- **God judges the heart, not the manner of death** (1 Samuel 16:7). He knows what was mental illness, what was captivity, what was chemistry, and what was actually a will freely turned against Him. **You do not have that information and neither do her judges.**
- **Romans 8:38–39** — nothing in death or life separates us from the love of God in Christ. **Death is specifically listed. It's the first item on the list.**
- **A cry does not have to be eloquent to be heard.** The thief on the cross got in with one sentence, at the last minute, with no restitution, no baptism, and no clean-up (Luke 23:42–43). **"Today you will be with me in paradise" was said to a criminal mid-execution.** That's the precedent. That's how low the bar is, and how wide the door.
- **Psalms 139:8** — "If I make my bed in Sheol, you are there." There is nowhere she went that He wasn't already.

So: I don't know, and here's the honest posture — you can hope, legitimately, biblically, without lying to yourself. And hope is not the same as certainty and you do not need certainty to stop torturing yourself. **You can put her in the hands of a God who is kinder than the church that scared you and more just than the family that failed her, and leave her there.**

Did she know I loved her?

Ask yourself what you'd have said if she'd walked in the door. That answer has been sitting in you for years. **I can't tell you what she knew. But love that was real does not vanish because it could not be received.** People in that condition often can't take it in, and that is not the same as it never mattering.

Was she in pain at the end?

You don't know, and your imagination has been filling that gap for years with the worst available footage. **That's not memory. That's torture dressed as loyalty.** You are allowed to stop screening it.

Why her and not me?

This is the one. And the answer is not "because you were better" and it's not "because God picked you" in a way that makes her disposable. **The honest answer is that survival in addiction is often brutally arbitrary — timing, who was in the room, which batch, whether someone had Narcan, whether a bed was open that day.**

You did not survive instead of her. You survived, and she didn't, and there was no exchange. Her death did not buy your life. **You do not owe your life as payment for hers.** If you build this whole movement as restitution for being the one who lived, you will never be able to stop and it will never be enough, because guilt is a creditor that does not close accounts.

Build it because it's right. Build it because you love her. Do not build it as bail.

41. What Her Passing Is Allowed to Be – And What It Isn't

IT IS NOT:

- **Your fault.** Not by action, not by omission, not by timing.
- **A debt you're paying.** She is not collecting. God is not collecting. Only guilt is collecting, and guilt is not a creditor you owe.
- **The engine of the work.** If grief and guilt are the fuel, you will burn out, because guilt does not refill. It only drains.
- **A reason you're not allowed to be happy.** Your joy does not dishonor her. Your misery does not honor her. **Nobody grieving you would want your life stopped in the year you lost them.**
- **Evidence that God failed.** God did not kill your sister. Addiction did, and people did, and a broken world did.
- **Something you have to be "over."** You will carry her forever. That's not unresolved grief. That's love with nowhere to put itself, and it's allowed to stay.

IT IS:

- **A real death worth real grief,** for as long as it takes, on no schedule.
- **A witness.** You know exactly what the gap looks like because you watched someone fall through it. **That's not a metaphor for you. That's field experience.**
- **A name that goes on the work.** Not as a debt. As a dedication. There's a difference, and the difference is whether you feel free.
- **Part of why you build.** Her absence shapes the thing you are building — **a place to reach when you know something is wrong and don't know where to go.** That's a wound becoming a door, a little like Joseph, starved of family and later put in charge of feeding families.
- **Proof that this is not theoretical for you.** When you tell someone "I know where that road goes," **you are not quoting a statistic. And they will feel the difference, and it will be the thing that keeps them on the phone.**

42. The Work – Laying Her Down Without Letting Her Go

These are not the same act, and confusing them is why you can't set it down.

LETTER ONE: TO BRANDI

Say everything. The love, the rage, the "why didn't you call me," the "I'm sorry," the things you never said, the last conversation you wish you'd had, and the thing you've never told anyone about the last time you saw her.

LETTER TWO: THE INDICTMENT AGAINST YOURSELF

Write the case you've been prosecuting against yourself for years. **Every count. Be thorough — this is the only way to get it out of the basement.**

Now read it out loud and answer each count with one of three verdicts:

1. "That was not in my power."
2. "That was in my power, I did it, it's forgiven, and I'm making living amends."
3. "That was the disease, not me and not her."

Then burn it. Physically. Outside. Watch it go.

THE RELEASE

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"Brandi. I love you. I'm not letting you go — I'm putting you down.

I am taking you out of my hands and putting you in God's, and His hands are better than mine ever were.

I am not your savior. I never was. I was your sister, and I loved you, and I did what I knew how to do with what I had at the time.

I am not paying for your death with my life. You would not want that and God does not require it.

I am going to build the place you needed. Not to buy you back. Because I love you, and because the next person is on their way to the same cliff, and I know where it is.

Your name goes on it. Not as a debt. As a dedication.

God, I hand her to You. I don't know everything and I'm not going to pretend I do. I know You are kinder than the people who scared me about her and more just than the ones who failed her. She's Yours. I'm leaving her there.

And God — give me back the years the locust ate. Mine and hers. Amen."

Date I did this: ____ / ____ / ____

THE ONGOING PRACTICE

- ☐ I know her dates and I **plan** for them — I don't get ambushed
- ☐ I have one person I can call on those dates
- ☐ I talk about her out loud, by name, to living people
- ☐ Her name is on the work, visibly
- ☐ I have stopped using her death as evidence against myself
- ☐ **I am allowed to have a good day**

BOOK EIGHT

The Two Futures

What happens if nothing changes, and what happens if it does

THE HOLY R3UP

43. Why You Need to Look at This

Because the enemy's single most effective move is **Stage 11 — running out the clock**. Not destroying you. **Delaying you**. A person who is going to change "soon" for thirty years causes him no problems at all.

So we're going to do something uncomfortable: **play the tape forward**. Not to scare you. To make the cost of not changing as vivid as the cost of changing, because right now only one of those has a face on it.

Read this section once. Do not live in it. If it starts pulling you down instead of forward, skip to Book Nine and come back with someone else in the room.

44. The First Future – If Nothing Changes

This is not a prophecy. **It is a projection of the trajectory you are on if the contracts stay signed, the doors stay open, the vows stay in force, and the plan in Chapter 12 runs uninterrupted.** It's what the pattern does on its own, without intervention.

SIX MONTHS OUT

Mostly it looks fine, and that's the danger. **The tell is not collapse. It's the maintenance.** Energy going into holding the shape instead of building anything. The work slows. The writing dries up. Drafts you don't finish. A version of the ministry that exists mostly as intention.

You're still isolating and calling it focus. You're still tired in a way sleep doesn't fix. **The old comfort has gotten one step closer and gotten permission to sit near the door.**

TWO YEARS OUT

The mission has become identity instead of assignment. That's the shift that matters. When it's an assignment you can rest from it. When it's identity you can't, because stopping feels like dying.

The pattern of the bloodline has surfaced in a relationship or in your parenting, and you recognized it, and you told yourself it's not the same thing. **The vow is running the show — "I don't need anyone" has cleared the room. Nobody is allowed to correct you now, and it's been long enough that nobody tries.**

Grief has gone underground. It comes out as rage or shutdown instead of tears. Your body has started sending the bill: sleep, stomach, pain, teeth, hormones, whatever your weak system is.

And you are talking about freedom to other people while living something else in private, and the gap between the two has become the thing you manage most. That gap is the exact place the enemy sets up shop in a called person, and he's patient.

FIVE YEARS OUT

One of three roads, and you can usually tell which one is yours:

Road A — The relapse. Not dramatic. A slow return through a side door that didn't look like the old door. The thing you closed got knocked on for years and one night you were tired and alone and it was already in the house before you noticed. **And this time it's worse, because tolerance dropped and shame is higher and you have a platform to lose.** Luke 11:26 — the last state worse than the first. That verse is not a threat. It's a warning about vacancy.

Road B — The hollow ministry. You never fell. You just calcified. **You became someone who teaches freedom from a memory of it.** Correction-proof. Surrounded by people who need you and can't challenge you. Every critic is "the enemy." The fruit slowly goes bitter and the last person to notice is you. This road is more common than Road A among the called, and nobody writes workbooks about it.

Road C — The quiet quit. You didn't fall and you didn't harden. **You just stopped.** Told yourself it was a season. Told yourself you'd get back to it. The thing you were built to build sits half-made in a drawer, and the people who needed it went looking somewhere else and found nothing, and you never found out their names.

TEN YEARS OUT

The bloodline pattern has passed to the next generation intact. **Not because you wanted it to. Because nobody stood in the gap and the lease renewed automatically.** Your children or the kids in your orbit are running the same script with different clothes on, and you can see it, and now you're grieving it from the other side of the table.

The years are gone. Not dramatically — **spent.** On managing, on hiding, on surviving, on almost.

TWENTY YEARS OUT, AND THE HONEST END OF IT

Here's the part nobody says out loud: untreated addiction, untreated trauma, and untreated despair do shorten lives. That is not a scare tactic. It is why getting help matters. If that sentence is loud for you today, call or text 988 before you read another page.

And if there is a twenty years, the worst version is not hell or disaster. **The worst version is a life that was almost. A woman who knew exactly what she was made for, could describe it in detail, told other people about it — and didn't do it.** The bridge she was supposed to build never got built, and the people who would have crossed it went looking somewhere else.

Read Chapter 12, Stage 12 again. His final move isn't your death. It's taking the testimony. Making sure the story that would have freed a thousand people gets buried in the same box you do.

WORK — THE HONEST PROJECTION

What is the specific thing I keep almost changing?

If I'm honest, which road am I closest to — A, B, or C? _____

What does my life look like in five years if this exact week repeats 260 times?

Who else pays for it if I don't change? (Name them. By name. This is the question that moves people.)

Who is the person who will fall through the gap that I was supposed to build across?

Now close this chapter. You've looked at it. You don't live here.

45. The Second Future – If You Do the Work

Same woman. Same history. Same wounds. **Different choices.** Here is what *can* happen, on a realistic timeline, because this part deserves detail too. It is a picture of what is possible, not a promise.

NINETY DAYS

The single biggest change is not how you feel. It's that you're no longer alone in it. Five roles filled (Step 24). At least one person who knows everything with no edited version.

The contracts are renounced out loud and dated. The vows are broken and replaced. You have a written relapse plan and a written craving protocol and you've used them. **Sleep has started to come back, and when sleep comes back, hope does.**

The silence practice is at ten minutes and it no longer feels like standing in a dark room. **You've heard something. Small. Specific. Not a voice from the sky — a knowing that didn't come from you.**

And this: you have had a full day that was just a day. Not a battle. A day. The first one of those in years will undo you.

ONE YEAR

The bloodline repentance is done, dated, signed, and posted where your family can see it. The pattern that ran four generations has one generation where it stops and the paperwork exists.

The body has been treated — bloodwork, sleep, mental health, the things you'd ignored for a decade. **You found out that some of what you thought was spiritual warfare was a thyroid, a deficiency, and untreated PTSD, and you're not ashamed of that, you're relieved, because now it's treatable.**

Boundaries exist in the actual world — blocked numbers, changed locks, ended arrangements. **The people who only wanted access to the broken version have left. That grief is real and the room is quieter and cleaner.**

You are helping one person who is earlier than you, and it is **steadying you more than it costs you.**

And the work has started to look like something. Not a plan anymore. A thing with a name and a shape that somebody has actually used.

THREE YEARS

You can be corrected, and you've proved it more than once, and that single fact is why you're still standing when others fell.

The wound has become the credential. **You say things to people in the dark that nobody with a normal life could say, and they stay on the phone because they can hear that you're not reading from a script.**

Somebody has told you that what you built is the reason they're still here. **You will not know what to do with that sentence when it comes. Nothing else in the world sounds like it.**

You've had a setback and it didn't take you out, because you'd written the plan in advance and you told someone within the hour.

You have joy that isn't fragile. Not manic, not performed. The kind that can sit in a room with grief and not be evicted by it.

TEN YEARS, AND THE FAR END

A structure exists that outlives you. The gap you fell through and watched your sister fall through has a bridge over it with her name on it, and people cross it who will never know either of your names, and that's fine.

The bloodline pattern is not in the next generation. **They will grow up thinking the way you live is normal, and they will have no idea what it cost, and that is what a broken pattern looks like.**

And the far end of it: you stand in front of God with the years the locust ate restored, and the testimony not buried, and a list of names that made it because you didn't quit. **Not a life that was almost.**

THE COMPARISON — READ THIS OUT LOUD

	If nothing changes	If you do the work
The agreements made in pain	Still running, still charging interest	Named, released, brought to the cross
The vow	Running your life from age 9	Broken, replaced with truth
The bloodline	Passes on intact	Stops with you, in writing
The body	Sends the bill with interest	Treated, cared for, dedicated
The people	Isolated, uncorrectable, surrounded by dependents	Five roles filled, correctable, actually known
The work	Almost. In a drawer.	Built, used, outlives you
Brandi	A debt you pay forever	A dedication you carry free
The testimony	Buried in the box with you	Spoken, and it frees people
You	The woman who knew what she was for	The woman God chose

Now put your finger on the column you want and read Book Nine.

BOOK NINE

Becoming the Woman God Chose

The roadmap. The identity. The rule of life. The commission.

THE HOLY R3UP

46. First – She Is Not Someone Else

Get this or the rest won't work.

The woman God chose is not a better, cleaner, different woman waiting for you to qualify. She is not the version without the history. **She is you, with the contracts broken and the wound turned into a door.**

*"Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I consecrated you." –
Jeremiah 1:5*

Consecrated before formed. Before the abuse, before the addiction, before the family, before the loss. **The assignment predates the damage.** Which means the damage never disqualified it — it was aimed at it.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I praise you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made... my frame was not hidden from you when I was being made in secret." — Psalm 139:14–15

"We are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, **which God prepared beforehand**, that we should walk in them." — Ephesians 2:10

Prepared beforehand. The work is already made. You're not inventing a calling. **You're walking into one that's been sitting there the whole time.**

And the scars stay. **Jesus kept His.** The resurrected, glorified body had holes in it, and He used them as identification (John 20:27). **Glorified does not mean erased.** The woman God chose has scars, and they are load-bearing.

47. Who She Is – The Twelve Marks

Not aspirations. **Descriptions of what the work produces.** Rate yourself 1–10 on each, honestly, and date it.

#	Mark	What it looks like in real life	Score	Re-score in 1 yr
1	Unhidden	No secret life. Nothing she'd die if it came out. One person knows everything.		
2	Correctable	Can be told she's wrong and receive it without spinning. Has someone allowed to do it.		
3	Anchored in identity, not performance	Knows who she is when she's producing nothing. Can rest without guilt.		
4	Bounded	Says no. Enforces it in the actual world. Doesn't explain it forty times.		
5	Whole in her body	Cares for it, doesn't punish it, doesn't dissociate from it, treats it medically.		
6	Free of the debt	Not paying for her past, her sister, or her survival. Receives without earning.		
7	Grieved, not frozen	Has felt it, still feels it, doesn't manage it by numbing. Grief has a place.		
8	Discerning	Can tell body from wound from flesh from spirit. Knows conviction from condemnation.		
9	Rooted in the Word	Answers attack with Scripture out loud, not feelings. Knows what's written.		
10	Silent with God	Can sit still with Him with no agenda and not panic.		
11	In real community	Five roles filled. Not a following. People who know her.		
12	A steward, not a victim or a survivor	"This happened, I'm here, it belongs to God, and it's for somebody else."		

Total: _____ / 120. **Date:** _____

The two that matter most: #2 and #11. Every called person who crashed had those two at zero. **Every one.** Go read Chapter 34 again if you need convincing.

My lowest three scores — these are this year's work:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

48. The Identity Work – Trading the Names

The enemy's Stage 3 was assigning you a false name. **Becoming her is largely the work of answering to the right one.**

Cross out the left. Say the right one out loud. Daily, for thirty days.

What I was called	What God calls me	Where it's written
Too much	Chosen, holy, beloved	Colossians 3:12
Not enough	His workmanship	Ephesians 2:10
Damaged goods	A new creation — the old is gone	2 Corinthians 5:17
The family's problem	A daughter, an heir	Romans 8:15–17
Dirty	Washed, sanctified, justified	1 Corinthians 6:11
Forgotten	Engraved on His palms	Isaiah 49:16
Guilty	No condemnation	Romans 8:1
Alone	Never forsaken	Hebrews 13:5
Cursed	Redeemed from the curse	Galatians 3:13
Weak	Strong in His strength; grace sufficient	2 Corinthians 12:9
Unwanted	Chosen before the foundation of the world	Ephesians 1:4
Ruined	Beauty for ashes, oil of joy for mourning	Isaiah 61:3
Silenced	An overcomer by the word of her testimony	Revelation 12:11
Late	Given back the years the locust ate	Joel 2:25

The name I have answered to longest: _____ **The name I am choosing instead:**
_____ **Say it every morning for 30 days. This is not affirmation. It's re-installation.**

49. The Twelve-Month Roadmap

Concrete. Sequenced. **Do not skip ahead — each month is built on the one before it.**

MONTH 1 — TELL THE TRUTH

- ☐ Tell one person everything, unedited
- ☐ Medical picture started — doctor, bloodwork, mental health eval
- ☐ Trauma inventory + contract inventory written
- ☐ Silence practice: 2 minutes daily
- ☐ Find a trauma-trained therapist and book the first session
- **Milestone: nothing about me is secret from at least one person.**

MONTH 2 — EXCAVATE

- ☐ Inner vow list finished (Step 4)
- ☐ Soul tie list finished (Step 5)
- ☐ Bloodline map finished (Step 6)
- ☐ Stage audit — which of the twelve is running on me right now (Step 7)
- ☐ Silence: 5 minutes
- **Milestone: I know what I'm actually dealing with, on paper.**

MONTH 3 — REVOKE

- ☐ Phase 2 in full, with a believer present: Steps 8–17
- ☐ Every date recorded
- ☐ Phase 3 Step 18 the same day — fill it, don't leave it empty
- ☐ Silence: 10 minutes
- **Milestone: the lease is torn up and the house is occupied.**

MONTH 4 — REBUILD THE BODY

- ☐ Body rededication (Step 20), with a physical marker
- ☐ Sleep protocol locked in — same hours, phone out of the room
- ☐ Movement 20+ min, 5x/week
- ☐ Protein and water daily
- ☐ All medical follow-ups done
- **Milestone: I live in my body and I take care of it.**

MONTH 5 — BUILD THE PEOPLE

- ☐ All five roles filled (Step 24), including the one who can correct me

- ☐ One group I attend weekly without fail
- ☐ Every boundary enforced in the real world (Step 25)
- **Milestone: I am not alone and I am correctable.**

MONTH 6 — LAY HER DOWN

- ☐ Book Seven in full — both letters, the burning, the release
- ☐ Her name on the work as a dedication, not a debt
- ☐ Her dates planned for, with a person on call
- ☐ Silence: 15 minutes, holding
- **Milestone: I carry Brandi free.**

MONTH 7 — ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

- ☐ Book Six worked through
- ☐ My own unanswered questions written and sealed with a date
- ☐ Bitterness against God released out loud (Step 12)
- ☐ The letter to God written (Chapter 23)
- **Milestone: I have questions, not a verdict.**

MONTH 8 — LEARN WHAT I WAS NEVER TAUGHT

- ☐ Pick ONE: money, parenting, anger, rest, or marriage
- ☐ Find someone who does it well and get close enough to watch (Step 26)
- ☐ Practice it badly on purpose — badly is how new things start
- **Milestone: I am building a pattern I've never seen.**

MONTH 9 — LEARN TO FIGHT

- ☐ Three Scriptures memorized cold for attack
- ☐ Armor out loud every morning, 30 days straight
- ☐ Trigger chain mapped; I intervene at link 3 or 4, not link 7
- ☐ Relapse and setback plan written and given to my people
- **Milestone: I fight in real time instead of after.**

MONTH 10 — START STEWARDING

- ☐ Tell my story out loud to one person who needs it
- ☐ Help one person who is earlier than me
- ☐ Write down what I know that only someone who's been there could know
- **Milestone: the wound is a door.**

MONTH 11 — BUILD THE THING

- ☐ One concrete piece of the mission that exists in the real world — a resource, a page, a group, a document, a phone number that rings
- ☐ Give it to one real person and watch it work
- **Milestone: it's not a plan anymore.**

MONTH 12 — REVIEW AND RE-RUN

- ☐ Re-score the twelve marks. Compare to Month 1.
- ☐ Walk all five phases again — find the next layer
- ☐ Write the testimony of the year
- ☐ Set next year's three assignments
- **Milestone: I am a year free and I can prove it on paper.**

50. The Daily Rule of Life – The One Page

Everything in this book collapses into this. **Put it on the wall. This is what becoming her actually looks like on a Tuesday.**

SAY IT OUT LOUD

THE RULE

MORNING 1. Feet on the floor at the same hour. Sunlight in the first hour. 2. Out loud: "I belong to God. I am forgiven. I am free. I am not going back." 3. The armor, out loud. Thirty seconds. 4. Silence with Him. 15 minutes. No agenda. 5. Protein and water before caffeine.

THROUGH THE DAY 6. Move the body. 20 minutes minimum. 7. HALT check twice — Hungry, Angry, Lonely, Tired. 8. Tell somebody the truth about one real thing. 9. Refuse every agreement: "I don't receive that. That's not mine." 10. Do one thing for the mission. One. Even small.

NIGHT 11. Nothing hidden from the person who knows everything. 12. Three things out loud I'm grateful for. 13. Same bedtime. Phone out of the room. 14. "I am not paying for anything today that was already paid for."

WEEKLY One group. One check-in. One therapy hour. One anonymous act of service. One full rest day.

MONTHLY The seven self-check questions (Step 27). First of the month, no exceptions.

ANNUALLY All five phases again. Re-score the twelve marks.

51. The Commission

Read this out loud. Standing up. Out loud helps — **saying it makes it real to you.**

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I am not who they said I was.

I am not what was done to me, and I am not what I did to survive it.

Every agreement I made in pain, I bring to the cross, where the record of debt was nailed and canceled.

Every vow I made to stay alive, I release. It kept me here. It does not run me now.

Every tie I did not choose is cut. What I gave away, I have called back. What was theirs, I have returned.

The pattern that ran in my family for generations can stop with me. I am choosing to be the pivot. I am working to keep it from passing to my children, and I have the date written down.

God was in the room. He saw it. He hated it. He did not author it, and He has not wasted it.

I have questions I may never get answered, and I am holding them open, and I refuse to let them harden into a verdict about who He is.

I love my sister. I was never her savior. I am not paying for her death with my life. I carry her name forward as a dedication, not a debt.

I am not going to be the woman who knew what she was for and didn't do it.

God knew me before I was formed, and what was done to me never canceled what He had in mind for me. The harm does not get the final word.

My wound does not have to stay a wound. I can reach back into the gap, because I have been in the gap, and I know the way out by name.

I will stay unhidden. I will stay correctable. I will stay in community. I will stay in my body. I will stay in the Word. I will stay silent with God.

What tried to end me can become a testimony that helps somebody else.

I am the woman God chose. Not someday. Today. Starting now.

In the name of Jesus Christ. Amen.

Signed: _____ **Date:** ____ / ____ / ____

Witnessed by: _____

52. The Last Page

You asked for the whole story. Every painful thing. Nothing left out, so you could finally know there is no more.

Here's the truth about that: there is always one more layer, and that is not bad news. You can only see the next thing from ground you've already taken. The reason you couldn't see this year's work last year is that you were standing too low to see it. **That's not failure. That's altitude.**

So what you can actually have — and what you now have — is this:

There is nothing in your story that has not been named in this book. There is nothing named in this book that does not have a step attached to it. There is nothing in your life that the blood of Jesus Christ does not reach. And there is nothing you are carrying that God did not see happen and grieve at the time.

That's the "no more" you were looking for. **Not the end of growth. The end of the unnamed.**

The rest is not more information. **The rest is Tuesday, and the Rule, and the phone call, and the fifteen minutes of silence, and one person who is earlier than you and needs to hear it from somebody who actually went through it.**

Go build the place you wish had existed.

For Brandi Renee.

And for the one who is going to find this at 3 a.m. and finally understand that somebody wrote it down for them.

You are not crazy. You are not cursed beyond reach. You are not too far in.

The line stops here.

APPENDIX

Scripture Arsenal by Need

Memorize the bolded ones. **You answer attack out loud with what is written, not with how you feel. Jesus answered all three temptations with "it is written" and never once debated.**

WHEN YOU FEEL GUILTY OR CONDEMNED

- **Romans 8:1** — "There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- 1 John 1:9 — faithful to forgive AND to cleanse.
- Psalm 103:12 — as far as the east is from the west.
- Micah 7:19 — He hurls our sins into the depths of the sea.
- Isaiah 43:25 — "I blot out your transgressions for my own sake."

WHEN YOU FEEL DIRTY OR USED

- **1 Corinthians 6:11** — "You were washed, you were sanctified, you were justified."
- 2 Corinthians 5:17 — new creation; the old has passed away.
- Isaiah 1:18 — though your sins are like scarlet, they shall be as white as snow.
- Hebrews 10:22 — draw near with a true heart, hearts sprinkled clean.

WHEN YOU FEEL WORTHLESS

- **Psalm 139:14** — fearfully and wonderfully made.
- Ephesians 2:10 — His workmanship, works prepared beforehand.
- Ephesians 1:4 — chosen before the foundation of the world.
- Isaiah 49:16 — engraved on the palms of His hands.
- Luke 12:7 — the hairs of your head are numbered.

WHEN YOU'RE AFRAID

- **2 Timothy 1:7** — not a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and a sound mind.
- Isaiah 41:10 — "Fear not, for I am with you."
- Psalm 27:1 — the Lord is my light and salvation; whom shall I fear?
- Psalm 91:1–7 — the shelter of the Most High.
- 1 John 4:18 — perfect love casts out fear.

WHEN YOU'RE IN SPIRITUAL ATTACK

- **Luke 10:19** — authority to tread on serpents and scorpions.
- **James 4:7** — submit to God, then resist; he will flee.
- 1 John 4:4 — greater is He in you.
- Colossians 2:14–15 — He canceled the record of debt and disarmed the powers publicly.
- **Revelation 12:11** — overcame by the blood of the Lamb and the word of their testimony.
- Isaiah 54:17 — no weapon formed against you shall prosper.

- 2 Corinthians 10:4–5 — demolishing arguments and taking thoughts captive.

WHEN YOU'RE CRAVING

- **1 Corinthians 10:13** — with the temptation, a way of escape.
- Galatians 5:16 — walk by the Spirit and you will not gratify the flesh.
- Titus 2:11–12 — grace trains us to renounce.
- Philippians 4:13 — strength through Him.
- Jeremiah 2:13 — the broken cistern. (Read it when the craving is lying about what it can deliver.)

WHEN YOU'VE FALLEN

- **Proverbs 24:16** — the righteous falls seven times and rises.
- Lamentations 3:22–23 — new every morning.
- Micah 7:8 — "when I fall, I shall rise."
- Psalm 51 — the whole psalm. Read it out loud.
- John 21:15–17 — Peter restored, commission intact.

WHEN YOU'RE GRIEVING

- **Psalm 34:18** — near to the brokenhearted, saves the crushed in spirit.
- **Psalm 56:8** — He keeps count of your tossings and puts your tears in a bottle.
- Matthew 5:4 — blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted.
- Revelation 21:4 — He will wipe away every tear.
- John 11:35 — "Jesus wept." At a grave He was about to open.
- 1 Thessalonians 4:13 — grieve, but not as those without hope.

WHEN GOD IS SILENT

- Psalm 13 — "How long will you hide your face from me?"
- Psalm 22:1 — quoted by Jesus from the cross.
- 1 Kings 19:11–12 — food, sleep, then the whisper.
- Lamentations 3:26 — it is good to wait quietly.
- Habakkuk 2:1–4 — stand at the watchpost; the righteous shall live by faith.

WHEN YOU'RE ANGRY AT GOD

- The book of Job — all of it, especially 42:7 where God vindicates the honest one.
- Lamentations — the whole book is a complaint God preserved.
- Psalm 88 — ends in darkness and God printed it anyway.
- Genesis 32:24–30 — Jacob wrestled and got a new name and a limp.

WHEN YOU DOUBT YOU'RE CALLED

- **Jeremiah 1:5** — consecrated before you were formed.
- John 15:16 — "You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you."
- 1 Corinthians 1:27 — God chose the foolish, weak, and despised things.
- 1 Timothy 1:15–16 — Paul, the chief of sinners, made an example of mercy.
- 2 Corinthians 12:9 — power perfected in weakness.

WHEN IT FEELS TOO LATE

- **Joel 2:25** — "I will restore to you the years that the swarming locust has eaten."
- Isaiah 43:18–19 — behold, I am doing a new thing.
- Isaiah 61:1–3 — beauty for ashes, oil of joy for mourning, garment of praise for a spirit of heaviness.
- Ezekiel 37 — dry bones, and the question "can these live?"
- Luke 15:20 — the father ran.

WHEN YOU NEED TO REMEMBER THE ASSIGNMENT

- **2 Corinthians 1:3–4** — comforted, **so that** we can comfort others.
- Genesis 50:20 — "You meant evil against me, but God meant it for good."
- Romans 8:28–29 — He works in all things toward being made like Christ.
- Esther 4:14 — "for such a time as this."
- Isaiah 61:1 — sent to bind up the brokenhearted and proclaim liberty to the captives.

THE DAILY ARMOR

- Ephesians 6:10–18. Out loud, every morning, thirty seconds. **Note there is no armor on the back — you are not built to run.**